

A Commentary on the Praise Known as 'The One Hundred and Fifty'

Śatapamcāsatikānāmasya Stotraṭikā · Toh 1148 · Derge Tengyur

བར་ལྷན་བཅུ་ལྷན་ཞེས་བརྒྱུ་བའི་སྐོར་པའི་འགྲེལ་པ།

Toh 1148 in the Tengyur is a Sanskrit and Tibetan commentary known in Sanskrit as the Śatapaṃcāśatikānāmasya Stotraṭīkā and in Tibetan as the Brgya Inga bcu pa zhes bya ba'i bstod pa'i 'grel pa, meaning "A Commentary on the Praise Known as 'The One Hundred and Fifty.'" It is a scholastic commentary on the celebrated hymn of one hundred and fifty verses in praise of the Buddha composed by the Indian master Candragomin, unpacking its wondrous meaning by organizing its praises according to the perspectives of cause, result, and application as medicine. The text was translated into Tibetan by Ravamma and the translator Śākya Lodrö, who revised and finalized the rendering. As a commentary on a devotional hymn, it belongs to the broader category of stotra literature within the Tengyur, sitting alongside other explanatory and laudatory works that illuminate the qualities of the Buddha for practitioners devoted to that tradition.

Translated by Ravamma and the translator Śākya Lodrö, revised and finalized.

In Sanskrit: Śatapamcāśatikānāmasya Stotraṭīkā.

In Tibetan: A Commentary on the Praise Known as "The One Hundred and Fifty."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

The profound nearby explanation of the praise composed by Candragomin,
drawing out the wondrous meaning of The One Hundred and Fifty —
a monk of pleasant speech, devoted to the Victor,
who delights in reverence —
through faith in that tradition,
shall here be thoroughly expounded.

In this text, the following matters are addressed: first, the praise that constitutes the introductory occasion; then praise through the perspectives of cause and result; and praise through the perspective of application as medicine — these are set forth in thirteen clearly presented sections, as follows. The introductory praise, and then the praise of cause — these are counted as one because they share in the uncommon cause of the six perfections. The praise of result has three divisions, distinguished by headings

such as "the incomparable" and so on: the praise of the incomparable, the praise of the wondrous, and the praise of the body. The praise that constitutes the application as medicine has eight divisions, distinguished by headings such as compassion and so on: praise of compassion, praise of speech, praise of the teaching, praise of aspiration, praise of entering the path, praise of austere practice, praise of wisdom, and praise of freedom from debt. The summary verses for these are as follows:

The introductory praise and the cause,
six aspects; the result — the incomparable,
the wondrous, and likewise the body;
the application as medicine in eight aspects, which are:
compassion, speech, the teaching,
aspiration, entering the path,
austere practice, wisdom,
and freedom from debt — thirteen in all.

A complete explanation of each of these thirteen praises will be given later. Here, what is called the "introductory occasion" is treated first. In that introduction, it will be fully explained what meaning is conveyed and by what means, and likewise, in the praise of cause and what follows, it will be thoroughly explained which verses convey which meaning.

First, then, the meaning of the words of the introductory praise is as follows: it presents the Tathāgata's worthiness of offerings such as taking refuge in him, the fact that one can infer from his being the Tathāgata that he is entirely free from all faults, and — since even those who do not know the full extent of his qualities should praise and pay homage to the Blessed One — it sets out just a portion of the qualities that make him worthy of praise. This, in brief, is expressed in the following summary verse:

The Teacher is worthy of offerings such as refuge;
faultlessness is to be inferred;
even though qualities are boundless, one is equipped to praise —
in this praise, a direction of homage.

In order to elaborate on the phrase "to that one in every respect," two verses are composed:

That one in whom all faults
have utterly and forever ceased,
and in whom, in every respect and in every dimension,

all qualities have come to abide —
if there be a mind that is wise,
it is fitting to take refuge in that very one,
to praise him, to honor him,
and to remain in his teaching.

With regard to the words "that one in whom all faults," they are connected with the following words: "it is fitting to take refuge in that very one" and so on. The word "that one" is a common expression, but in its meaning it applies solely to the buddha, the Blessed One. Because there is no other who possesses both the complete exhaustion of all faults and all qualities without exception, the text states accordingly:

In the omniscient one who possesses every quality,
and yet who does not possess their diminishment —
faults together with their habitual tendencies:
these do not exist in the sole protector.

So it is said. The word "faults" refers to attachment and the like, because they are what produce fault. Alternatively, whatever produces fault in the continuum of body, speech, and mind renders one an unworthy vessel — and that is what "faults" means. The phrase "does not possess" means "does not have," because what would constitute a blemish has not been acquired. The word "yet" serves to highlight the wonder of the Blessed One's perfect abandonment. Alternatively, it is a grammatical particle used to complete the meter. Thus, the one who does not possess faults is the fitting object of taking refuge and so forth.

Now, someone might object: those non-Buddhists who are free from attachment and those adepts who are still in training are also without faults, so it would follow that they too are fitting objects of taking refuge and so forth. In order to remove that objection, the text states: the word "all" carries the meaning "without exception." Even if those non-Buddhists free from attachment and those in training do have no faults in a certain sense, they have nonetheless not definitively abandoned the faults of the peak of existence, and among the trainees, those who have attained one, two, or all three realms through gradual practice have not yet abandoned what must be abandoned through the cultivation of meditative equipoise. Therefore they do not qualify.

Someone might then object that arhats also have no faults pertaining to the three realms, and so they too would follow as fitting objects of taking refuge and so forth. In reply to that, the text states: the word "utterly" means "at all times." The meaning is this: even if arhats are without all faults, this does not apply at all times, for such absence of faults existed at the time of complete abandonment, and there are phenomena the arhats have not yet completely abandoned. Therefore they also are not fitting objects of taking refuge and so forth.

Someone might further object: pratyekabuddhas too are entirely and permanently without all faults, so they as well would follow as fitting objects of taking refuge. In order to distinguish the Blessed One from them also, the text states: the phrase "in every respect" means "in all respects whatsoever." The reason is that pratyekabuddhas, in every respect, have not abandoned attachment and the like, because they have not abandoned their habitual tendencies. Therefore they too are not fitting objects of taking refuge and so forth.

As for the Blessed One, however, he is permanently and in every respect without all faults. Therefore, precisely because the Blessed One is entirely and supremely without faults without exception, it is the Blessed One alone who is the fitting object of taking refuge and so forth. This is what the text declares.

As for the verse line "who does not possess all faults," if one reads it according to the order of the explanation, this verse will not accord with it. Therefore, in order to accord with the verse, the words "utterly" and "in every respect" are to be read in their natural sequence. Since the phrase "in every respect" also applies to the external matter of mountains and the like — for those too are permanently and in every respect without faults, and so it would follow that they too are fitting objects of taking refuge and so forth — in order to negate that, the text explains: "utterly, in every respect" is to be connected with "all qualities." What then are all those qualities? Those shared with śrāvakas — the absence of afflictions — and the wisdom of aspiration and so forth. Those not shared include the unmingled qualities, the powers, the fearlessnesses, and so on. And these are not to be divided into small, middling, and so forth, but rather they abide in greatness. Thus the phrase "in every respect" carries the meaning "in every distinguishing respect." As it is said in verse:

In you there has never been
any deficiency in exalted qualities —

and so in you those very qualities
are indivisible, summit upon summit, beyond all grade.

This is what will now be explained. The phrase "in whom" is, by its meaning, applied exclusively to the Blessed One. The particle "also" serves to make the reason for the distinction clear. Because all faults without exception have been exhausted, and because the one in question possesses every distinguishing quality without exception, it is fitting to take refuge in that one alone — this is the elaboration of the phrase "worthy of refuge." The phrase "abides transformed" means "truly and perfectly abides," for it is so by virtue of mere resolution, and because it is a capacity that has become manifest. The qualities are those already described, for they are to be counted as antidotes to faults and then habituated. The explanation is this: the mere absence of faults, without the presence of qualities, is not capable of providing refuge. The meaning of refuge is expressed in the phrase "the meaning of refuge" — and that is the concluding point.

Mountains and the like also lack qualities. The Blessed One, by contrast, is without faults and endowed with qualities. Therefore it is the Blessed One alone who is worthy of refuge-going and veneration, and not mountains and the like — this is what is being said.

For this very reason, the taking of refuge by the many is addressed in the words spoken by the Blessed One:

Mountains and forests,
groves and the roots of trees —
these are the refuges to which
people flee when seized by fear.
Yet this refuge is not supreme.
This refuge is not holy.
By going to such a refuge
one is not freed from all suffering.

Now, if one were to say that because the Blessed One, having qualities established in every respect, is thereby distinguished from śrāvakas and the rest, and is therefore worthy of refuge-going and veneration, then in the same way the Blessed One could also be praised on account of a perfection of abandonment — to this the verse beginning "Never, in every respect" and so forth gives the answer.

The word "that" refers to what was already described: the absence of all faults and the possession of all qualities together. The word "very" indicates what is definitively to be held. And what is definitively to be held? Going for refuge and so forth. Anything other than what has come to be in that way is not a vessel for going for refuge and the like — this is the meaning.

The phrase "going for refuge" means having accepted and avowed refuge. The meaning of refuge is as already explained — "the meaning of refuge" — and this gives rise to enthusiasm for the activity of mind. Praising that one means praising the genuine and authentic qualities. The phrase "of the class of beings" applies to all without distinction, and this gives rise to enthusiasm for the activity of speech. The phrase "with veneration" is understood to mean: veneration is to be performed by joining the palms together and the like, and this gives rise to enthusiasm for the activity of body. The phrase "abiding in his teaching" means that through body, speech, and mind one refrains from what that one has prohibited and accomplishes what that one has permitted. One who acts in this way comes to abide in the teaching of the Blessed One, and this gives rise to enthusiasm for the practice.

The phrase "what is fitting" means not going beyond what is fitting — it carries the sense of being in accord with what is fitting. The verse "If one has a mind at all" means: one must take hold of a mind that benefits oneself, for this is paramount — it means "thinking of benefit to oneself." Otherwise, even animals have minds, yet they, having but meager capacity to examine faults and qualities, do not think of benefit to themselves. Therefore, whoever thinks of benefit to themselves is here shown: take refuge in the one who is without all faults and endowed with all qualities, and abide in that one's teaching.

Thus these two verses demonstrate that the Teacher is worthy of refuge-going, veneration, and the rest.

The intent — that the master himself made clear with such reasoning that the Teacher is worthy of refuge-going and the rest — is now to be explained. Here too the master Dignāga indicated it in passing. Some, not understanding why the Teacher is worthy of refuge-going and the rest, speak as follows: "In whom shall I take refuge today? As long as I have a mind at all, in whose teaching shall I abide, whom shall I praise, to whom shall I pay honor?" For that reason, the master explained at length the verse beginning "In every way and at all times." Here too, wishing to explain it as follows: because those worldly beings who are endowed with fear seek one worthy of refuge-going and the rest,

those who fear something — it is on account of that very fear that this is declared. And the elaboration of this as further commentary was explained by the elder Śākyabodhi thus:

Minds terrified of hell, where blazing, burning desire and other fires
consume the body and harm every sense base —
"In whom shall I take refuge today?"

That is the elaboration. The explanation is this: with reference to those who, having been terrified of hell — where one has a body tormented by the fires of desire and the rest and where all faculties are harmed — seek one worthy of refuge-going and the rest, the verse "In every way and at all times" is explained at length.

Now, what is it that is equally worthy of refuge-going and the rest? Since it has not been stated directly, it is explained here. The verse runs:

Endowed with omniscience and all qualities,
yet not possessed of deterioration in those qualities —
not possessed of faults together with their habitual tendencies —
to him alone, the Protector, do I resort.

Regarding the phrase "faults together with their habitual tendencies," "engaging with habitual tendencies" means faults accompanied by habitual tendencies. Now, what is a habitual tendency? On this point, some who are learned in scripture say: just as sesame seeds kept together with flowers — even when the flowers are removed, a similar fragrance still arises — so it is with habitual tendencies. Or again: just as a person who has been freed from a chain of fetters, on account of long habituation, still walks in a manner similar to their former bound gait — in the same way, even when faults are abandoned, what remains in the stream of a noble śrāvaka as an unexplained residue of mind and mental factors — something comparable to faults in the way that charcoal resembles what was produced by the low fire of acacia wood, because the fuel of faults in the noble ones' continuum has been shown, and because the fire of the noble path is not swift — that residue not explicitly taught by scripture is called a habitual tendency.

Why is this so? It is because of something such as the habitual tendency of attachment in the noble Śāriputra. The account is as follows: once, when the elder Mahāmaudgalyāyana's relatives, a brahmin who had gone forth under the name Udāyī of the topknot, beat him and thrashed him with a staff until he was like a sugarcane stalk, King Ajātaśatru (Bimbisāra's son, the

Enemy-at-Birth) thereupon entrusted him to the physicians, saying: "Heal him within seven days, or else I will strip you of all your provisions." Yet the master, being aged and having been beaten so severely, could not be healed, and it was feared he would pass into complete nirvāṇa. When the noble Śāriputra perceived that the elder's intention was to pass into complete nirvāṇa, he — the noble Śāriputra, whose stream of being from beginningless time still bore residual habitual tendencies — entered complete nirvāṇa in the early morning, surrounded by a retinue of seventy thousand monks. Unable to bear the death of that one, the elder Mahāmaudgalyāyana — together with seventy-six thousand monks — also passed into complete nirvāṇa. Moreover, the river Gaṅgā on that day swept away a vihāra, whereupon the son of the elder Pilinda spoke to the river Gaṅgā, saying: "May the form of a courtesan not appear again!"

In a former life he had been a brahmin, and so that was the habitual tendency of his pride. Therefore it is said that through the quarrel of ordinary folk, he cursed the river Gaṅgā — and thus he is described as one who still bore habitual tendencies of that kind.

For that reason, because the fuel of afflictions is meager and because the fire of the noble path is exceedingly keen, there is no fault of the kind found in something burned by a sharp fire of butter or sesame oil — for such faults have been relinquished. Whose is this? He is described as the Protector.

Just as in my own stream of being
Not even a residual habitual tendency remained,
So in every respect
You have thoroughly vanquished all faults.

This is how it will be explained. The one who is without faults of that kind and who possesses qualities of that kind is accepted by those who desire liberation as worthy of homage, beginning with going for refuge. In the same way, it is said of the Blessed One that he is without faults as described and possesses only qualities. The phrase "that also" picks up the fault of the kind described. The meaning of "fault" has already been explained, and so too has "is without." The word "alone" expresses certainty — it is exclusively one, not two. What is that one? It is explained as: the meaning of "having attained the lordship of protection." The Blessed One alone is called the Protector of all phenomena, and there is no other protector — and so it was thus declared.

Alternatively, the syllable "tra" in the element "tri" carries the meaning of sustaining, and it is definitively conditioned by "ni." Therefore, because he protects without fail once the time of those to be tamed has come, he is called the Protector.

Even the ocean, the abode of sea monsters,
Causes time to pass swiftly away;
But for sentient beings who are to be tamed,
A buddha does not let the right moment slip by.

This was declared in like manner.

The word "all" is connected with qualities. "Omniscient" means knowing all things and having come to know all things, so omniscience is the distinction between quality and gnosis. Alternatively, "omniscient" has the sense of the sixth case ending and is connected with Protector. "That also" refers to the quality. "Without diminishment" means being of an unchanging character. By this, the non-diminishing nature of the Teacher's dharmatā is shown. Alternatively, "without diminishment" is to be taken together as: without faults, the Protector, omniscient. By praising his qualities, the praise is applied specifically to the Blessed One. Therefore, the reason that the Blessed One — having abandoned all faults together with their habitual tendencies without remainder, and possessing the complete fullness of all qualities — is worthy of homage beginning with going for refuge has been explained.

As for how it can be understood that the Blessed One is without even faults together with their habitual tendencies, it is explained: here an inference is to be set forth.

In the enlightened body, speech, and mind
And their activity of the Blessed One,
None who bears enmity
Can find a legitimate opening.

"Cannot find it through bearing enmity" is the extended form. The word "not" expresses negation. It is connected here with "cannot find a legitimate opening in the Blessed One." The word "also" goes with the meaning of "whosoever." Where is it that they cannot find it? It is explained: "in the activities of his body, speech, and mind" — that is to say, his body, speech, and mind. The word "activity" is applied to each individually. By whom is it not found? It is explained: "one who bears enmity" — this is the extended form. Not only one with minor fault-finding intent, but even one who is fully bent on

seeking faults — that is the meaning. During the four months of the rainy season, so that people of a later age might seek out the flaws of the Great Person, they would abide in the presence of the Blessed One, and —

— in order to examine those who behave improperly. And yet not even the slightest fault such as attachment or the like was found in the Blessed One. That is the meaning of the sūtra.

Now then, if it is said that other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) found an opportunity by relying on the going-forth of a beautiful woman, the commentary responds: the word "endowed with Dharma" — here the word "Dharma" applies to what is true. To state it precisely: one who acts in accordance with truth is one in whom no opening is found. As for one who abandons truth and speaks ill of the Blessed One — what need is there even to mention refuting such a person?

In the same way, when the Tathāgata was born, those non-Buddhists found neither gain nor honor, and so they themselves killed a beautiful woman who had gone forth and spread a slanderous report about the Blessed One, saying: "The ascetic Gautama had her wait upon him in service and then killed her." Then some non-Buddhists, having gained gain and honor, spoke to the other contentious non-Buddhists: "If you yourselves killed the beautiful woman, does that cast blame on the ascetic Gautama?" When King Prasenajit heard this, he expelled them from the country. In just this way, one should cite the analogy of Ciñcā the female ascetic's slander.

"Gain" means what is obtained. "By whom" connects with the one who bears enmity. "The Blessed One" is a term of veneration for the Tathāgata. "Opening" means "seeking a fault" and "seizing upon wrongdoing."

If a fault existed, and one searched among the activities of body, speech, and mind arising from it for conduct contrary to the proper ways of the Tathāgata's activities — who would be able to find it? Therefore the Tathāgata has no faults whatsoever. By such reasoning, having shown the inference that the Blessed One's faults are exhausted, the purpose of offering praise is now to be explained.

Throughout beginningless saṃsāra — with the cutting of tongues, with birth in the lower destinies and the like, with afflictions — whatever praise of the Blessed One I have not made, that is my own self-deception.

Now, because of the great breadth of the verse beginning "Like a yoke with a hole upon the ocean," two verses are to be explained:

Like a yoke with a hole upon the great ocean,
and a turtle's neck fitting into it —
having obtained human birth, which is adorned
with the great feast of the holy Dharma,
attended by impermanence,
with concern for the opening that karma provides,
why would I, with this very tongue,
not take up the essence?

"I" points to oneself. "Having obtained" means having attained. "Human birth" means birth as a human. "Adorned with the great feast of the holy Dharma" — this is the distinguishing quality of human birth. The "holy Dharma" is the holy Dharma. Or else, the beautiful Dharma is the holy Dharma. Even if the word "Dharma" here applies to many things — to scripture, to nirvāṇa, and so forth — in this context too it refers to the scriptures of the Buddha. In the same way, the sūtras teach: "The Dharma that is taught tends toward pacification and complete nirvāṇa," and so forth. It is great, and it is a feast; therefore it is the great feast — for it is the cause of both higher states and definite excellence. What is similar to the great feast of the holy Dharma is the great feast. That which is endowed with the great feast of the holy Dharma is "endowed with the great feast of the holy Dharma," and this connects with "having obtained human birth."

"The ocean" is the great ocean. The yoke upon it is an implement for carrying loads. The hole in the yoke is its aperture. A turtle's neck fitting into that hole — that is the image. "Like a turtle's neck fitting into the hole of a yoke upon the ocean": the simile for human birth is like a turtle's neck fitting into the hole of a yoke upon the great ocean.

The Blessed One said the following:

"Monks, here the great earth has become a single river and a single ocean" — because of the great scope of this, it is a sūtra that is fully endowed with a narrative occasion.

The meaning of its subsidiary parts is as follows. Just as a turtle that rises up once after a hundred years in the great ocean — tossed violently back and forth by the wind, whose yoke has a single hole — finds it as difficult to enter the hole of that yoke as a crow finds it to obtain the fruit of the tāla tree, so too a living creature that has fallen into the vast ocean of the lower realms, driven by the great wind of the path of non-virtuous karma, finds it difficult to obtain

entry into the destiny of a human being. This is what is meant by "difficult to obtain."

Therefore, having obtained what is difficult to obtain — a human birth — what is one to do? It is said:

Bound up with impermanence itself,
suspected of an opening for karma —
take the essence of the tongue.

"Impermanence" means the cause of destruction. Some say it means simply destruction. "Being bound up with it" means constantly following after impermanence — this is the meaning of "conditioned phenomena are destroyed moment by moment." "My tongue" will be explained below. Therefore, having taught impermanence together with its fortunate aspect, the sustenance of the tongue of life itself is to be described. As for "suspected of an opening for karma" — among those persons who perform virtuous and non-virtuous karma, what arises from virtuous karma is human birth itself. The non-virtuous karma of those same persons constitutes the opening. Being connected with it and suspected of it means being fraught with doubt, because things such as cutting off the tongue of life and illness and the like are able to overwhelm. "Take the essence" means to take it up. What is the essence of the tongue? It is proper praise of the Tathāgata's qualities. Likewise it has been said:

It is the essence of words of holy Dharma.
Other than this is the sound of a crow.

As for "why" — this refers to the impossible. Or alternatively, "why" means the sense of "in no circumstance whatsoever should this not be done." "This" refers to what resides in one's own continuum. "Tongue" means speech; it is an instance of the result being designated by reference to the cause, for it is speech alone that is called the tongue.

Having explained the purpose of taking up the essence that consists in uttering praises, the master understood the occasion for the words of others: one who knows the extent of the qualities is worthy of worshipping the Tathāgata with praise. But if one does not know the extent of the Blessed One's great qualities, why should one strive to praise the Blessed One? It is replied:

Though I know the domain of the Sage's qualities
is of innumerable scope in just this way,
with reverence for my own purpose
I have gathered myself to one side and speak.

As for "of innumerable scope in just this way" — "in just this way" here means "as has been said." The intent is: having obtained the difficult-to-obtain human birth adorned by the arising of a buddha, and having fully examined why the essence of the tongue should not be taken up, one proceeds as follows. Alternatively, the word "in just this way" here introduces the cause — as in, for example, the expressions "it rains in this way" and "it runs in this way."

Therefore here too, if one were to refrain from offering praise on the grounds of not knowing the full extent of the Tathāgata's qualities, even the noble Śāriputra, who became the foremost of the wise, would not offer praise to the Blessed One. That is the meaning of "from this cause." As for "innumerable scope" — "innumerable" means that they cannot be exhaustively counted. The wisdom of the Tathāgata cannot be counted; its domain is not within the range of the wisdom of pratyekabuddhas and noble śrāvakas. "Though I know the qualities" — even so, knowing them.

At the time when the buddha, the Blessed One, arouses a mind that transcends the world, at that very time śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas too do not know the Blessed One's mind and intention — this is the scriptural authority. That which possesses an innumerable domain is called "of innumerable domain," because it pervades everything. Therefore I am unable to offer praise. The meaning of the verse line "though I know the qualities to be innumerable" has already been explained.

Regarding the words "I set forth and speak of one facet of those qualities" — a facet of those qualities is a portion, and "setting it forth" means striving for the sake of offering praise. As for the question of whether such praise could benefit the Blessed One in the slightest — "devotion to one's own good" means: by striving for one's own good, one offers praise to the Blessed One. This is because praise and blame do not cause the Blessed One to feel attachment or anger.

Thus these three verses together explain that, even without knowing the full extent of the qualities, one undertakes praise of the Blessed One by striving for one's own good through even a portion of those qualities.

Now I shall explain the entrance into the praise that begins with obeisance to the Teacher:

Whose qualities in their count
And whose power have no limit,
Whose wondrous enlightened activity is immeasurable —
To you, the self-arisen, I bow.

This verse is the elaborated statement. "Self-arisen" means: without being taught by another, he came to possess the distinction of having fully realized all that is to be known, and thereby became omniscient — that is "self-arisen." To pay homage to that self-arisen one is called "bowing." "I bow" means "I do bow."

Regarding the words "whose wondrous enlightened activity is immeasurable" — "immeasurable" means without measure, exceedingly rare, and wonderful. "Enlightened activity" refers to the enlightened activity of body, speech, and mind — and to the one who possesses immeasurable and wondrous enlightened activity, one bows: this is how it connects. Praising the excellence of the cause is said here because enlightened activity is what serves as the cause.

The praise of the excellence of the result is also to be explained. The phrase "whose qualities in their count" connects with "whose." Through the force of meaning, the instrumental verb form becomes transformed, so that the "to you" at the fourth case ending here becomes the sixth case ending, meaning "of you, whose." "Count" refers to one, two, and so on. "Power" means capability for the activity of taming those to be tamed. That these qualities of count and power have no limit — that is, no limit in terms of powers, fearlessness, and so forth — means there is no definite grasp of their extent. And because there is no such limit, the verse is explained:

Since there is no end to what you do of this measure,
What is there to say of "it is thus"?
For your qualities, I —
Thinking of merit — bow my head.

"Of this measure" means being of this particular measure; to say the limit is "one hundred" or "one thousand" — such a limit would mean the qualities come to a definite end — meaning you do not possess qualities of that kind. In this way, the excellence of the result is explained.

The explanation of the teaching on the excellence of power is given in the words "what is there to say of it being thus." "Thus" means: the qualities of you who possess such power — "what is there to say" is merely a grammatical expression meaning "what is there to say," conveying the intended meaning. As for "how do you strive to offer praise" — "thinking of merit" means: since it is the sole cause of merit, it is merit. Or alternatively, since he enacts qualities, it is merit, said to mean "destroying wrongdoing." The particle "thinking" conveys definiteness of intention. The particle "or alternatively" signals that another meaning is intended. The explanation is this:

Although your qualities are without limit or end in their number and power, I have arisen to a definite certainty that your qualities are merit. Therefore, "for the sake of qualities" means: it is because I rely upon your qualities. The phrase "reverence arose in me universally" means: even without having discerned the specific distinctions among your qualities, we do universally possess reverence, and this is taught because, out of respect for one's own benefit, one is to offer praise with regard to even a single dimension of those qualities.

This second verse, it is explained, fully commences the praise of the Blessed One's perfection of cause and effect. This is the commentary introducing the praise, and it constitutes the first chapter.

Now, how the Blessed One, through his wondrous activity, aroused the mind of awakening — this is to be explained.

Having abandoned conceptuality about whether to act or not to act,
You yourself acknowledged: "These beings are wretched."

"To act" means performing the conduct; "not to act" means not performing the conduct. The syllable "dam" is to be understood as "conceptuality." The word "thinking" conveys the meaning of "having not abandoned it in his mind." "Conceptuality" means conceptual thought. "Himself" means by his own person. "Without being asked" — because he came under the influence of compassion — this is the intended meaning. "Acknowledged" is to be explained as referring to "the beings." He acknowledged it in order to fully protect them — that is the intention behind "arousing the mind of awakening."

In like manner, the Blessed One, while still a bodhisattva, thinking that if he did not know the path of the Tathāgata he would not undertake to protect beings from saṃsāra, gave his body and all else to those who begged of him and aspired — by means of this giving and utter giving, in a future world

lacking a guide, having become a buddha, to lead across those beings not yet led across, to liberate those not yet liberated, to give ease to those not yet given ease, and to bring to complete nirvāṇa those not yet fully brought to nirvāṇa — this is a scriptural passage. "You" here means "by you." And if one asks why, having abandoned such conceptuality, he acknowledged it — it is because of the word "wretched" spoken concerning these beings. One who is called "wretched" is worthy of veneration through the protection of the wretched, and this is a proper place for one who speaks with compassion. Therefore this is the meaning: because he bore the awakening mind and compassion toward beings who are helpless in the face of the suffering of saṃsāra, abandoning conceptuality about whether to act or not to act, he acknowledged it in order to protect beings. The phrase "this" refers to what is being pointed out in proximity. "Beings" means the world of sentient beings. Therefore:

The verse reads:

You are a benefactor without being asked,
You are a friend with no cause for love,
You are an intimate companion to the unacquainted,
A kinsman without any connection.

"Without being asked" means without request. "Good" means the manner of the Dharma. Protecting those who suffer — worldly people devoid of compassion — from suffering: even when asked whether this is done or not done, it is itself the nature of goodness. As for the Blessed One, even without being asked, the verse presented above expresses this half by saying "excellent." The word "you" refers to the Blessed One. Some people love others here and there for the sake of their own happiness, and this is called affection.

You, too, because you are endowed with compassion and do not depend on the cause of your own happiness, love without a cause, as it were. The query is once again about loving-kindness by way of connection. "Without acquaintance" means without familiarity. Their "intimate companion" means a friend — a friend to the unacquainted. Because you are endowed with compassion, you are a friend even to the unfamiliar, just as to the familiar. "Kinsman" means a relative — one connected by the lineage of father and mother. This is what is called a kinsman in the worldly sense. The Blessed One, too, because he is endowed with compassion, is a kinsman without connection: even without any bond of lineage, he is still called a kinsman.

These two verses together explain how the Blessed One, having aroused the mind of awakening with compassion going before it, took sentient beings under his care.

"The cause" — meaning the sixfold classification — is taught as the six perfections (pāramitās). By these, the praise of the Blessed One is conveyed: doing good without being asked, loving without cause, and so forth — all of this has been explained. How so? In order that the perfection of generosity might be fully completed, with joy and with hair standing on end:

"If you gave even your own flesh,
What need to speak of other things?
You, O Excellent One, gave even your life
To those who came to beg."

In this way, the Blessed One who had become a bodhisattva through the power of loving-kindness, with a sword exceedingly sharp like a blue lotus, cut and cut again his own flesh and gave it to yakṣas to eat. And the bodhisattva who became Crest-Jewel (Ratnaśikhī) likewise gave to rākṣasas — this is to be understood as implied. "Other things" refers to jewels, gold, silver, and so on. "What need to speak" means: what need to say that? The intention is that the giving of other things is understood by implication. If it is asked whether he gave only his own flesh, the answer is: not only that — the phrase "and even life" is the elaboration. "Life" means even life itself. "Gave" means it was offered. "Those who came to beg" means those who came desiring to obtain something. For example, the story of the Jātaka tells of the Blessed One who had become a hare: when Śakra (Indra), the lord of the gods, came in the form of a beggar with the intention of making full use of what he received, the Blessed One placed himself upon a pile of fire so that he might be consumed — this is the Jātaka tale.

"You, the Excellent One, did good without being asked" — relying on what was said above, the word "Excellent One" is a form of address to the Blessed One. Thus, having explained the giving by which living beings are given enjoyment, the giving that fully protects is now to be explained:

"With your own body and life itself,
You ransomed, a hundredfold and more,
The bodies and the lives as well
Of those seized by murderous slayers."

In the phrase "with your own body," "your own" means just that. "Body" is said with reference to the part in relation to the whole — a part of the body is called the body. The phrase "and life" is taken as an expression compressing the meaning. When asked what was done with this body, it is said: "he ransomed, a hundredfold and more." "Ransomed" means bought back. "A hundredfold and more" means many times over. When asked what was ransomed, the answer is given: the ransoming was done by abandoning attachment to oneself, and through the power of compassion, relying on the attachment others have to themselves, he ransomed the parts of their bodies. When asked whose bodies these were, the answer is: belonging to those who possess bodies —

— belonging to sentient beings. When asked what condition they were in, the explanation is given: "held by executioners" means those striving to kill, that is, the executioners. "Those held" means those who have been seized by them. As an example, when the Blessed One, having become King Śrī-dala, proclaimed himself to be one who gives everything away, and Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), taking on the form of a brahmin, was given half his body and he freely offered it — this is an expression conveying the meaning. When asked whether it was only bodies that were ransomed, the answer is given: No. In the phrase "with their lives," "lives" means by means of their own lives. Thus:

With their lives, those held by executioners —
their bodies and their lives as well
you ransomed, a hundredfold and more.

This is applied in the same way to all. When the tigress, overwhelmed by the suffering of hunger and striving to devour her own cubs, was seen by the bodhisattva, he gave himself to her, ransoming the cubs with his own life. Likewise, when King Śivi, in the form of a dove held dear by him being seized by a hawk, saw what had happened and, wishing to free it, cut away and freely offered his own flesh with a sword, continuing to weigh out and add the flesh of his entire body until it balanced — in this way he ransomed that dove. It is said that in the same way, other birth stories of the bodhisattva's former deeds of joy should be cited as examples.

Having praised the Blessed One's perfection of generosity with two such verses, the commentary now continues to explain how the longer passage beginning with "Not out of fear of the lower rebirths" praises the perfection of

moral discipline.

Not out of fear of the lower rebirths,
nor to accomplish a destiny you desired —
with intention utterly pure alone
did you make moral discipline your practice.

Here, hell, animals, and hungry ghosts are the lower rebirths, because their karmic maturation is unbearable. That very thing — fear of that — is the reason for "fear of the lower rebirths." Worldly people who are attached to themselves maintain moral discipline. But you did not make moral discipline your practice out of fear of the lower rebirths.

People who desire the happiness of gods and humans maintain moral discipline. And you did not make moral discipline your practice in order to accomplish a desired destiny either. Then why did you? The explanation is given: "With intention utterly pure alone" — this means with a mind that is pure by nature, being habituated to virtue and liberated from wrongdoing. Likewise, since it is free from attachment to self, the intention is also just that, and exclusively that — hence "intention alone." "Intention" refers to mind and the assemblage of mental factors arising from mind. Its purity is unsurpassable awakening arising from stainless primordial wisdom for the sake of protecting all sentient beings without remainder — as in the verse passage: "The purity I have attained is unsurpassable awakening." "For the sake of that" means "as the cause of that." "Pure" here is used to establish the third meaning in the sense of cause — just as one understands the phrase "resting because of begging" to mean "on account of the cause of begging," so too here it should be understood as "by means of the cause of pure intention." "Moral discipline" is the perfect undertaking of turning away from what ought not to be done. "Made it your practice" means making it one's natural way.

Having thus explained the perfection of moral discipline as complete through excellence of intention, in order now to teach its completeness through excellence of application, the following verse is to be explained: "Ever abandoning all deceitfulness" — and so forth.

Ever abandoning all deceitfulness,
Constantly relying on the steadfast,
Through actions wholly pure,
You have become the sole foundation.

Actions arising from guile are "deceitfulness," and a person associated with such actions is likewise deceitful. "Always having abandoned these" is to be understood as meaning "having utterly relinquished them forever." The "steadfast" are virtuous actions, and those persons who are devoted to such actions are likewise called the steadfast. "Constantly relying on them" carries the meaning of the phrase "by thoroughly relying on them." One may ask: what results from those causes? The response is given in the words "through actions wholly pure" and what follows. The meaning of "through actions" has already been explained. "Wholly pure" refers to virtuous deeds. As for the expression "become the sole foundation," "foundation" means the path. "Sole" is connected with "you" — that is, the Blessed One alone. Since one is the ground that serves as foundation, that very thing constitutes the singular foundation. "Become" carries the meaning of "attained." The meaning is this: You are a guide who leads beings beyond the worldly, and through precisely these two causes you have become the one sole path of white, virtuous actions. Having thus rightly praised the perfection of moral discipline with this pair of verses, the following is spoken in order to rightly praise the perfection of patience:

When oppressed by many sufferings,
With a mind of virtue,
You stood resolute against the afflictions,
And showed love toward afflicted beings.

"Oppressed by many" is an elaboration. "Oppressed" means being in the company of the suffering of having one's limbs cut off, for the sake of benefiting sentient beings. "Many" means on many occasions. "You" refers to the Blessed One. "With a mind of virtue" means with a mind made wholly pure through the power of compassion. One may ask: what did you do? As stated in the words "stood resolute against the afflictions" — the afflictions are attachment and so forth. "Standing resolute against them" means manifesting strength. The intended meaning is: "I shall overcome the afflictions of those who harm me" — this is the mental engagement that was made. But here one might object: if the afflictions of the executioner are themselves the cause of the bodhisattva's patience, then since those afflictions are worthy of reverence, why should the mind be disturbed for the sake of overcoming them? The answer is: that is indeed true, and yet, when enemies, driven by affliction, harm a vessel similar to oneself, they will certainly become sinful. Therefore, out of compassion for those enemies, the mind is roused to

overcome their afflictions. Just as some, wishing to benefit someone, exorcise a possessing demon — not the one already seized by it — so it is here. For precisely this reason, the text continues: "And showed love toward afflicted beings" — "beings" here refers to vultures and the like who consume eyes and other parts of the body. "Afflicted" means those who have come under the power of afflictions. For that very reason, "showing love" means rousing the mind out of the wish to overcome the afflictions of those enemies.

Although it is a cause of the perfection of patience, this verse explains that he practiced patience in two respects: as an offering when others caused him suffering, and in not being disturbed even when beings under the sway of afflictions did him harm.

The second occasion of patience is now to be explained. The verse reads:

You, for the sake of others,
gave up your body and life with joy.
Yet not even those beings who had been slain
and then revived came to feel such joy.

In the phrase "for the sake of others, gave up body and life," "for the sake of others" means for the sake of benefiting others; "gave up" means relinquished; "body and life" means life; and "joy" means that which was pleasing to your mind. For example, seeing that a young nāga with a white topknot was being approached and was about to be seized and devoured by a garuḍa, you, having become a bodhisattva in the form of a youth riding a cloud, gave yourself to the garuḍa in order to protect it. Similarly, as King Candra, you gave your own head as an offering to the fierce brahmin known as "Eye." "Not coming to feel such joy" refers to that joy. "Those who had been slain and so forth" refers to those who were revived after having previously died — the earlier time and the later time together encompassing death and rebirth. Those who had no hope of life yet somehow found life again — this is what is meant by "the slain being revived." That beings, whose lives had come to such a pass, should experience a joy like yours in giving your life for the sake of others is impossible — this is the condensed meaning.

Thus, since in this occasion the sin of the executioners was not abandoned, and the executioners are therefore the cause of arousing patience, this verse explains: you, desiring the perfection of patience, made an offering even of your own life.

The next two verses explain the third occasion of patience:

You, not just once
but being cut and yet taking no account of the suffering,
you in whom compassion for beings
who acted as executioners was supreme —
your mind, precious one,
is that seed of perfect awakening.
Only you, O Courageous One, know it as the very essence;
other ordinary beings cannot fathom it.

"That" is explained as compassion. "Taking no account of the suffering" means not taking to heart the torment you yourself endured. "Being cut" should be understood as meaning by a sword and so forth. As an example of someone who had become a teacher of patience dwelling in a forest: when the queen of the king came to him and he taught her the Dharma, the king, inflamed with jealousy, picked a quarrel and cut off his ears, hands, and feet with a sword. Alternatively, "being tormented by suffering" is connected with the same phrase. "Taking no account" should be understood as referring to his own life. Just as when, born as a tortoise, he carried merchants on his back with the intention of ferrying them to the far shore when their vessel was wrecked in the great ocean, and ferried them across, and then, having grown exhausted and fallen into a very deep sleep, ants ate him all over, and upon waking from that heavy sleep, fearing that those ants would die, he did not stir even slightly and passed away on that very shore — this is what is meant. Similarly, the Jātaka of the six-tusked elephant is to be cited as another example. "Being cut" means being hacked into pieces. "Not just once" means many times.

"Toward sentient beings who act as executioners" means: toward those who kill. "Compassion" means thinking to heal or cure them. "Compassion itself" means compassion — and the analogy of the four classes and so forth applies in the same way. "Having become" means the sense of "has become." "The Chief" is a name for the Blessed One, since he is the lord of all qualities.

The praise spoken in this third moment is, one feels, quite wonderful. What is so wonderful about it? It is because at the first moment he bore with patience the very fact that, being under the power of afflictions, those same beings tormented him. At the second moment too, he practised patience, thinking "these executioners benefit me." In this third moment, not only was he cut apart again and again, but he remained undisturbed even in the slightest and bore it with patience — and further, toward the executioners themselves,

reflecting "may those who have harmed me not be attended by suffering in the future," he resolved that he himself would destroy their afflictions. Thus he aroused a mind of compassion toward them. For this reason, what is remarkable is here expressed. It is said that, without regard for his own suffering, he committed himself to pacifying the suffering of others.

Therefore, in explanation, the verse "The seed of perfect awakening" — this is an elaboration. "Perfect awakening" is the stream of the Tathāgata, whose defining characteristic is the primordial wisdom of exhaustion and non-arising. "Its seed" means: the cause — that is, the seed of perfect, complete awakening. What is its nature? The verse says "the mind is a precious jewel." The mind itself is a precious jewel, because it protects all sentient beings without exception, and because it is exceedingly rare by virtue of its genuine wealth. "That" refers to being fully possessed of the intention of compassion toward the executioners. "You yourself" means you alone. "You alone, and not others" means: no other. "Hero" is an address to the Blessed One, since he is endowed with such power; or alternatively, because he is distinguished by the diligence of striving to rescue all beings without remainder. "Knowing as the essence" means: the mind of compassion — the seed of perfect, complete awakening — is the essence, that is, the Tathāgata's primordial wisdom, unobstructed with respect to all knowable objects, is known as the essence. This is to be connected with "you alone." "Not accessible" means: not within the range of experience. "That" refers to the essence. "Other persons" — śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, bodhisattvas, and so forth — means, in brief, that it is not within the domain of experience of śrāvakas and the like.

With these three verses the perfection of patience has been duly praised. Then, with the verse beginning "Without having performed austerities" the perfection of diligence of the Blessed One is praised:

Without having performed austerities,
one does not attain what is hard to gain —
so thinking, without regard even for yourself,
you cultivated diligence to excellence.

"Without having performed" simply means "not having done." "Through austerities" means: one must accomplish it through hardship. How so? The explanation: "does not attain what is hard to gain" carries the sense that it will be gained through hardship. "The station" refers to the Tathāgata's primordial wisdom for the protection of all sentient beings, since it is the support for the

benefit of all others without exception. Having aroused that intention, what did he do? The explanation: "without regard even for himself" means without concern even for his own life. "Diligence" has as its defining characteristic enthusiasm for virtuous qualities, and "cultivated to excellence" means elevated in a special degree — such is the intention.

Just as, having become the leader of a herd of deer, he saw a king accompanied by an army of hunters intent on pursuit, and, carrying the herd upon his back, he caused the deer to cross to the far shore of a rushing river. Though the sharp hooves of the herd's deer were wounding him, drawing blood, lacerating his body entirely, and he was in the grip of suffering from his joints being loose, still he rescued every last fawn of the herd without leaving a single one behind. Austerities of this kind and the like are to be taken as examples.

Furthermore, the phrase "in order to elevate to distinction" is expanded upon as follows:

In order to elevate to distinction,
not once did you relax your effort.
Therefore, in your excellences,
there is no break, from root to top.

"Removing faults," "accumulating virtues," and "acting for the benefit of sentient beings" — these constitute the distinction. Elevated by these, one becomes exalted. Here, "relaxation" refers to the steadfast quality of diligence. "Not once occurring in you" means that not even when passing through the lower destinies was there ever such a moment. Just as a worldly person who, upon learning of a scriptural instruction, arouses the first meditative concentration, thinks to accomplish his own ends by that very means and thereby becomes distinguished — you did not act in that way. For that very reason, having attained awakening and become preeminent, those qualities of yours beginning with great compassion have no break from root to top — this is the meaning of the phrase "without interruption." In this way, it has been explained that you alone are the supreme culmination of all distinguished qualities. Alternatively, this refers to the stage of the bodhisattva. For that very reason, "elevated to distinction" means having attained distinction in generosity, moral discipline, and so forth — the meaning being that you brought the perfections to complete fulfillment.

With these two verses, having praised the perfection of diligence, the praise of the perfection of meditative concentration will now be explained:

Since your mind is always bound together
with great compassion,
even to the profound bliss endowed
with the fruit of samādhi you were not attached.

In the phrase "profound bliss" the word "profound" is used because it is free from suffering. "Not attached even to profound bliss" is connected with the phrase "you did not come to abide in existence." To what exactly? The answer is given. The phrase "endowed with the fruit of samādhi" — here, samādhi refers to the dhyānas. "Endowed with fruit" means possessed of fruit: that is, the dhyāna of entering equipoise and the dhyāna of establishing what is reasonable — the meaning is "not even to those." Why? The answer:

"Always bound together with" and so forth: because the bodhisattva, keeping constant mindful attention to the activity of benefiting sentient beings through great compassion, did not seek an occasion to become attached to the bliss of dhyāna. Therefore, he became perpetually joined to that great compassion — such is the meaning. Because the bodhisattva, before attaining awakening, had long cultivated great compassion in that way, he became distinguished from those who lack compassion.

Because he was the reason for not becoming attached to what is endowed with fruit, the verse is elaborated:

That bliss which is uncommon to others,
extraordinary though it be,
for one such as you who engages in noble conduct
it serves only as harm, not as medicine.

"One such as you" means one like you. This is said with reference to bodhisattvas, for they are the ones who act in this way throughout the stage of causes. "Serves as harm" means it only inflicts harm. "Not as medicine" means it does no benefit. "That bliss" refers to the dhyāna of entering equipoise, the dhyāna of establishing what is reasonable, and —

— arising from seclusion. If it is asked whether that is not supreme, the answer is that it is not. The word "supreme" means "excellent," because it accomplishes great benefit and because one follows it for a long time — that is the sense of "extraordinary." As for the phrase "one who engages in noble

conduct," "conduct" simply means conduct. The point being made is: "This quality makes one noble in this way." As for the question of why that bliss inflicts harm on one such as you, the explanation is given. "Uncommon to others" — the reason is that it is uncommon, meaning not general. Uncommon in relation to what? The sense of "others" is: in relation to other beings. The explanation is this: whatever arises from the samādhi of the Blessed One cannot be cultivated by other sentient beings; therefore, by means of having transcended that absorption together with the experience of not generating attachment to it, the perfection of dhyāna is completely fulfilled. Having thus praised the perfection of dhyāna with these two verses, the verse beginning "Well-spoken from the mixed" sets forth praise of the Perfection of Wisdom, and it should be explained:

Well-spoken from the mixed,
the essence — flawless though brief —
you have received entire and held in mind;
and speech ill-spoken, like poison, wholly cast aside.

Speakers in the world are of three kinds, corresponding to the distinction between well-spoken words, ill-spoken words, and mixed words. Of these three, the bodhisattva has taken what is well-spoken as essence from mixed speech and held it in mind — that is, has retained it. Some read the phrase "held in mind" as "bringing near by transposing the vowel," understanding it on the model of the letter ā, and they invoke the citation "the essence alone — ātaṃ" — but that is an unwarranted citation. The reply to this is: what appears here is not a vowel transposition but a word-contact similar to it, as in the example durṇaya. Therefore "held in mind" as explained by the Ācārya is the elegant reading. For those who speak only well-spoken words, the bodhisattva applies the phrase "flawless though brief," joining it to "well-spoken." Whatever is unmixed with anything other than well-spoken speech is received with delight, like nectar — that is the meaning. As for others who speak only what is blameworthy, their ill-spoken words have been cast aside entirely, like poison. Having thus shown the purity of the Perfection of Wisdom through these three aspects, its further growth is now to be explained:

You who know the jewel-essence —
when well-spoken speech is weighed with life,
in each and every birth
you have shown courage for the sake of awakening.

As for the line "You who know the jewel-essence," the phrase "weighed by you" connects with what is to be weighed. "Knowing the jewel-essence" means: well-spoken speech alone is rare to find, and therefore precious; its essence is unsurpassed awakening; and one who knows that is called one who knows the jewel-essence. As for the question of by what it is weighed, the explanation is: not by weights and gold alone, but also by lives. What is weighed? The answer is: well-spoken speech. As an example, the Blessed One, who had come to seek well-spoken teaching, and whose mind had grown troubled through not hearing the Dharma, was deceived by Śakra (Indra), who had assumed the appearance of a yakṣa, offering this verse:

One who practices the Dharma — practice it well;
if practiced, that which is to be practiced must not be neglected.
In this world and in the world beyond,
one who practices the Dharma sleeps in ease.

Having offered his own body to be eaten in exchange for this verse, he was tricked.

What did he do? It is said: "Displaying valor" means he directed his attention toward diligence. Why so? It is said: for the sake of awakening, it was the cause of awakening. "Lives" — he was born again and again throughout all of cyclic existence in the five destinies. Here, the Jātaka of Dematā, the Jātaka of the Deer, and so forth should be taken as examples.

Therefore the verse that summarizes in brief the extended praise of the cause over three incalculable aeons:

Over three incalculable aeons,
striving thus as you strove,
with diligence alone as your companion,
you attained the unsurpassed station.

The word "thus" carries the meaning of suchness, or alternatively refers to the manner. Accordingly, virtuous qualities other than the perfections — such as faith and so forth — are also to be understood as included. "Over three incalculable aeons" means by means of three immeasurable great aeons. "Striving thus as you strove" means by engaging in the practices of the precepts as they were taught. As for "with diligence alone as your companion" — diligence is just diligence, and what one has as one's sole companion is that very thing alone, diligence itself — not elephants, horses, or the like. Therefore "you," whose sole companion was diligence, is the construction. What did you

do? It is said: you attained the unsurpassed station — you made it manifest. "Station" means a position or rank. What kind? It is said: "Unsurpassed" means that in which there is no distinction that exceeds it — that is unsurpassed — which carries the meaning of the Tathāgata's primordial wisdom. Thus this has been explained as the verse's praise of the cause, the six perfections, as the causes of the Blessed One.

This concludes the explanation of the praise of the cause — the second chapter.

Now, from the praise of the result in three aspects, first comes the praise arising from the quality of being without equal. From that praise of being without equal: by what cause was the state of being without equal attained, in what manner, and together with what — these are the three divisions. Of these, the attainment of the state of being without equal through its cause is explained by the following verse:

Envying not those above,
disdaining not those below,
with no rivals among those equal —
you became the lord of the world.

Most worldly people feel envy toward those who possess excellence in learning, moral discipline, and the like — they cannot bear the qualities of others. "Disdaining those below" refers to a contemptuous mind, and "having rivals among those who are equal" means mutually overpowering one another. Even the Blessed One, during his time as a bodhisattva, did not envy those above him, because he wholly embraced their qualities. He did not disdain those below, because he truly bestowed good qualities upon them as well. He had no rivals among those equal to him, because he made the qualities he had taken on stable and firm — for rivalry would have become an obstacle. By these three causes, "you," referring to the Blessed One, became the lord of the world — which is to say, he attained the state of being without equal. Having thus first explained that he was without equal owing to the absence of envy and the rest, the verse proceeds to explain further causes through the extended passage:

You rejoiced in the causes of good qualities,
not in their results.
By that very authentic striving,
your qualities reached their far shore.

Worldly people are attached to the results of good qualities, not to their causes.

Even when the Blessed One had become a bodhisattva and was still accompanied by craving, his attachment to causes rather than to results — however slight — was accomplished through seeking them and through his aspiration. What were those causes? The text explains: "good qualities" means meditative concentration (dhyāna) and meditative absorption (samādhi). "Not" is to be connected with "attached." Attached to what? The text explains: "to results" means to the pleasures of meditative concentration and absorption, or alternatively, to supernormal powers and the like. "By that very" means by that continuum and by the attachment to the causes of those qualities. "Your qualities reached their far shore" is connected with "by that very." In what manner? The text explains: "authentic striving" means by means of the authentic path and through the door of benefiting others. "You" refers to the Blessed One. "Reached their far shore" means excellence. "Good qualities" means meditative concentration and so forth. "Reached" means attained.

This second verse of that kind explains the Blessed One's incomparable quality — his having attained awakening — through the first phase of the bodhisattva stage: not having enacted envy and the like, and through his attachment to the causes of good qualities rather than to their results.

Next comes the explanation dispelling the inclination toward the inferior in the intermediate phase. Because bodhisattvas of lesser inclination speak in this way — saying that, since the afflictions cause harm, and since the attainment of the station of a lord of sages is difficult to accomplish, one should be content for the sake of attaining buddhahood itself — having set that aside, and through the power of compassion for sentient beings, the text presents this:

Just as even the dust of your feet
causes birth and merit to increase —
so by your excellent conduct
you fashioned yourself supreme.

Regarding the words "you fashioned yourself supreme," "in that way" refers to the manner of diligence and so forth. "Fashioned yourself supreme" means having reached the limit of good qualities, because the wisdom of the Tathāgata was fully assimilated. "You" refers to the Blessed One. "By excellent conduct" means by the three virtuous activities of body, speech, and mind.

"Just as" means in what manner. "Causes birth and merit to increase" — "merit" refers to virtuous activities; "birth" means arising; "causes to increase" means caused to expand, so it is merit and birth that increase. The substance of these is: at the arising of merit and birth, they come to be thus. "Again" refers to further existence. "The dust of your feet" means the dust of those feet. Even if one pays reverence to the very dust of your feet, beings will obtain merit — that is the meaning. This is the intermediate phase.

Now the causes for incomparability in the final phase are to be explained:

Having eliminated faults at the root through weakening,
and purifying by increasing good qualities —
by that excellent method, you, O Blessed One,
attained the supreme and transcendent accomplishment.

"Having eliminated faults at the root through weakening" is an elaboration. "Weakening" means causing them to become thin in former births — for the sake of eliminating and abandoning the worldly path. "Having eliminated at the root" means causing the seeds to be destroyed by the noble path in subsequent births. What are these? The text explains: "faults" means attachment and the like. "By increasing" means in former births, through earnest application of diligence, bringing them to exceptional distinction. "Purifying" means in subsequent births, through undefiled wisdom, for the sake of abandoning all obstructions of every meditative absorption. What are these? The text explains:

"Qualities" refers to meditative concentration and the meditative absorptions (samādhi), and so forth. "By that excellent system" means by that excellent system, as stated in the verse. If one asks what that is like, the text says "having attained the supreme accomplishment most excellently." "Supreme accomplishment" is unsurpassable awakening, because by it all purposes of others are fulfilled. The meaning is: "That you have attained."

Now, for the subsequent section, the cause of being without peer is to be explained:

Just as in my own stream there remain
no residual habitual tendencies without exception —
so in every respect whatsoever,
you have utterly vanquished the faults.

"In that way" means in that manner. "In every respect whatsoever" means with every form of effort. "Faults" refers to attachment and the like. "Vanquished" means: by cultivating the antidote, you have caused them to be prevented from arising again. "Just as" refers to the faults themselves. "In my own stream" means in one's own continuum. The definition of "habitual tendencies" has already been explained. The particle "also" indicates something distinctive: it is not only that all faults without exception have been vanquished, but that the habitual tendencies belonging to all those faults without exception have likewise been left behind — that is the meaning.

By saying, through this kind of verse, that śrāvakas and others who retain faults along with their habitual tendencies are unable to accomplish all the purposes of sentient beings, the text explains the sense of being without peer through having abandoned faults together with their habitual tendencies. Then, by saying further that those impoverished in qualities are likewise unable to accomplish the purposes of sentient beings, it again explains the sense of being without peer in fullness of qualities. This is elaborated by the verse beginning "In others there is not even a likeness of these":

In others there is not even the slightest
likeness to these qualities —
so through accumulated and ever-accumulating effort
you have established qualities in yourself.

"In that way" refers to with diligence and so forth. "Accumulated and ever-accumulating" is an intensifier indicating the extreme, like the expression "eating and eating, one goes on." The example of a bird grasping fish, seizing the meaning of the vast domain, points to accumulating with diligence in the highest degree — that is the condensed meaning. "In yourself" means in one's own continuum. "Established" means made manifest by means of mere aspiration. "Qualities" refers to the fearlessnesses and so forth. "Even the slightest likeness" means even a mere resemblance. "Of these" refers to the qualities. "In what manner" — "in what manner" is to be connected with "there is not even a likeness." "In others" means that not even the continuum of a pratyekabuddha, solitary like a rhinoceros horn, possesses these.

By these verses the cause — the reason why incomparability alone is described — is thus stated. As for the manner in which this incomparability is expressed, it is explained by the two verses beginning "All worldly analogues":

All worldly analogues in their actual objects
are marked by obstruction and obscuration,
are temporary and slight,
and are exceedingly easy to obtain.

Your unsurpassed qualities, however,
are free from obstruction, free from obscuration,
stable and continuous —
how could there be any analogy for them?

Here, "obstruction" means being overshadowed. "Obscuration" is obscuration: whatever has these is marked by obstruction and obscuration. As for "analogues in their actual objects," these will be explained. For example, what creates obstruction for the sun and moon is a planetary demon (Rāhu) and the like, and what creates obscuration is cloud cover and the like.

"Temporary" refers to the sun by day and the moon by night. Therefore one should understand: "temporary things are the objects that serve as analogues." "Slight" means that, while the sun and moon exist in Jambudvīpa, they do not reach the northern continent of Uttarakuru. It is for that reason that the phrase "exceedingly easy to obtain" and so forth is used: that which possesses the distinction of being exceedingly easy to obtain is what is called exceedingly easy to obtain. What then is it? The answer is given: "worldly objects that serve as analogues" — that which is used as an analogy is the analogue, and that very thing as a substantial entity is the referent; the objects that serve as analogues are the sun and so forth. "Worldly" means well known in the world. In the same way, this should be applied as appropriate to the lotus, the blue water-lily, and so forth as well. "Your qualities" are the powers (bala), fearlessness (vaiśāradya), and the rest. "Free from obstruction" means separated from what creates obstruction: since afflictive and non-afflictive obscuration are utterly absent, it means being free from what is adverse. "Free from obscuration" means not being overwhelmed by the darkness of others' objections. In the same way, as the Blessed One declared: "Having become a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, I have not failed to understand these Dharmas — so who here would dispute with me, or even find reason to challenge my mindfulness?" And he said: "Not seeing such a reason, I have attained ease, attained the absence of anxiety, attained fearlessness, and, abiding there, I declare the foremost among herds, the place of the great waves; I turn the pure wheel of Brahma and proclaim the lion's roar truly in the midst of the assembly." "Stable" means not temporary — for it follows along,

always and completely. "Continuous" means having no obstruction with respect to all objects of knowledge. It is in such a manner that one conveys the meaning: there is nothing other that is unsurpassably supreme. As for the statement "How could there be any analogy for yours" — "how could" is connected to the analogue; "analogy" refers to someone who wishes to explain another meaning; "there be" means to be so; "for yours" means for yours. The intention expressed is: in reality there is no other worldly analogue that could serve as a different meaning. Thus this second verse, by way of enumeration, corresponding point for point — sun being subject to obstruction, and being free from obstruction and so forth — explains that the Tathāgata's qualities are without analogue.

Now, the demonstration that they are without analogue shall be made together with that which they are without analogue of. First, the Tathāgata's intention has three qualities: depth, stability, and luminosity. Regarding depth, the exposition proceeds thus:

When one examines the depths of your intention,
finding it to be without bottom and without far shore,
even the profundity of the great ocean
would appear as shallow as a cow's hoofprint.

"Like a cow's hoofprint" expresses smallness. Compared to the profundity of the great ocean, it would be like a cow's hoofprint. In what way? The profundity of the great ocean would appear as shallow as a cow's hoofprint. The meaning is: the very profundity of the great ocean. When would this be? The answer is given: "When one examines the depths of your intention" and so forth — this is to be joined with the words "when one examines." When one examines the depths of your intention, finding it to be without bottom, then the profundity of the great ocean would appear shallow as a cow's hoofprint. By what reason? When one examines the depths of your intention —

bottomless and without a farther shore. It is bottomless because even the greatest śrāvakas and others cannot fully comprehend it. The ocean's depths have not been fathomed even by the asuras. The very center of the Blessed One's intention is likewise without a farther shore, because all objects of knowledge without exception fall within its domain, whereas the ocean is limited and fully measurable. In this manner, through this verse on the profundity of the great ocean, the profundity of the Blessed One's intention has been set forth.

Now the incomparability of his steadfastness is to be explained.

When one reflects upon your steadfastness,
unmoved by all phenomena,
the very steadfastness of the earth itself
becomes as small as the tip of a śirīṣa blossom.

The phrase "tip of a śirīṣa blossom" refers to the petal of the flower that grows from the śirīṣa tree. That petal's tip would become as small as the tip of a śirīṣa blossom. Steadfastness means the quality of being immovable. The word "earth's" means pertaining to the earth. When asked for the reason, the text replies: "unmoved by all phenomena" — the steadfastness of your mind is such that it cannot be moved by all phenomena; stated in terms of grammatical category, it is an instrumental in the sixth-case relationship with what is done. How is the Blessed One's steadfastness immovable? Because those whose domain is the meaning of his mind, who speak distortedly of it, are unable to move it. As it has been said: any monk who speaks thus — "whatever the ascetic Gautama has taught me, I shall disparage it and proclaim it to others" — that position is groundless. Therefore it is simply immovable.

When one reflects upon his steadfastness, when one contemplates what is to be contemplated, the steadfastness of the earth becomes as small as the tip of a śirīṣa blossom, because even certain goddesses are capable of moving it. This has been stated as follows: even a goddess nun endowed with great miraculous power and great might, perceiving the earth as something small, can bless the earth and then, conceiving of boundless water, set it in motion.

Through such a verse, the Blessed One's intention has been supremely demonstrated to be without equal in steadfastness, surpassing the steadfastness of the earth.

Now the incomparability of his luminosity is to be explained.

O Sage, before the light of your gnosis,
which destroys the cataracts of ignorance,
even the sun is of no more use
than a firefly.

Regarding the phrase "which destroys the cataracts of ignorance": non-knowing is ignorance, and that very ignorance is the cataract, because it obscures the view of reality as it truly is. What is it that destroys the cataract

of ignorance? It is the light of gnosis. Gnosis is the mind of the Blessed One, and that itself is the light, because it illuminates the four noble truths of the noble ones perfectly and clearly. This will be explained in relation to the domain of that light of gnosis. "Your" means belonging to you. "Sage" — he is a sage because he possesses the three masteries. The syllable "mi" negates whatever activities are present, so "mi-spyod" means "does not function." What does not function? The sun — the sun itself. Where does it not function? The text replies: it is connected with the domain where the gnosis does not shine. What does not function there? The text replies:

"not even as much as a firefly" — a firefly is the luminous insect possessed of brightness, and in that domain there is brightness; that is said to be its proper domain. Even that much brightness the sun cannot manage, because the domain of truth has not become manifest to it.

Having thus, through such a verse, explained that the Blessed One's mind is incomparable in luminosity, surpassing even the light of the sun,

The incomparability of the Blessed One's remaining qualities is now to be explained. The verse reads:

Compared with your pure speech, mind, and conduct,
the autumn moon, water, and sky in their purity
appear as things defiled.

What is impure appears as impure, and the verse now explains what "the pure things" are. The text asks: by what are they defiled? It replies: the phrase "autumn moon, water, and sky" refers to things that can be made impure by clouds and so forth, and therefore the word "autumn" is joined to each of them in turn. "Autumn moon, water, and sky" — the seventh lunar phase that is the essence of the lunar division — this is a gathering connected with persons. Against what are they compared? The text replies: the phrase "compared with the pure" means "when set against the pure." In that comparison, when set against the purity of the Blessed One's speech, the purity of the autumn moon appears defiled; when set against the purity of his mind, the purity of the autumn sky appears defiled; and conduct is the enlightened activity of his body — when set against the purity of that, the purity of autumn water appears defiled. This is because his speech, mind, and the activity of his body are free from every last defilement together with its habitual tendencies, defilements born from impure actions of body, speech, and mind.

Having, through such a verse, explained that the speech and other qualities of the Blessed One are incomparable in relation to the autumn moon and so forth, a summary of that incomparable praise is now to be given. The verse reads:

Whatever goodness the world may hold,
even if all of it were gathered and offered — it is surpassed by that.
By the afflicted phenomena of the world,
the Dharma of a buddha cannot be matched.

On the phrase "even if all of it were gathered and offered — it is surpassed by that," this refers to everything stated previously in the passage beginning "as vast as a bull-elephant's footprint" and so on. The nearby examples given there — such as the depth of the ocean and so forth — are merely words, and since the meaning is understood through the text itself, all those other things are likewise not true analogues — this is what is being summarized and stated. What is meant by "all of it"? The text replies: the verse says "whatever goodness the world may hold," and "whatever" refers to lotuses, blue lotuses, and so forth; "goodness" means whatever is beautiful and renowned among worldly people — even that is not a true analogue for you. This is the intended meaning.

What is the reason? The text replies, on the phrase "the Dharma of a buddha cannot be matched" — the phrase "cannot be matched" means "there is no obstruction to the many distinctions," as was explained earlier. This addresses the meaning "for what reason, and by what." The phrase "the Dharma of a buddha" refers to the powers, the fearlessnesses, and so forth. The phrase "phenomena of the world" refers to the sun and other things renowned among worldly people. Here the word "phenomena" is to be understood as a term meaning simply "things." "Afflicted" means that they are subject to destruction as described, through obstruction, obscuration, and so forth. The meaning of the verse is this: because the afflicted phenomena of the world cannot match the Dharma of a buddha, therefore, whatever goodness the world may hold, even if all of it were offered, it is surpassed — and none of it is a true analogue for you.

Having, through these verses, explained that there is no worldly analogue for the Blessed One by means of worldly examples, the text now explains his incomparability by means of a transcendent analogy:

Having found the precious Dharma, you yourself
are that very supreme thing,
comparable to you it is gathered, and with that
compared to you alone it falls short.

On the phrase "the precious Dharma you have found" — unsurpassed and perfectly complete awakening is what is fitting to be called the precious Dharma here; nirvāṇa is not what is intended.

This is because śrāvakas and others also attain it. The word "having found" means having genuinely followed after or actualized it. The phrase "you yourself are that very supreme thing" means "you have become supreme among all sentient beings without exception." "Whatever sentient beings there may be — footless, two-footed, or many-footed — among all those sentient beings, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha is supreme" — this is a sūtra passage. The word "that" refers to the precious Dharma. The word "very" is to be taken as definitive, meaning: by that very thing, not by another's. The word "alone" expresses completeness of statement. The verse-phrase "and with that compared to you alone it falls short" is an address to the Blessed One. The intended meaning is: "Because the precious buddhas are utterly pure, there is no fault in using them as a simile."

For that very reason, the text states: in the phrase "that and you" — "that" refers to the precious Dharma, while the conjunction "and" is used to introduce the simile. "You" is a summary of the simile of the precious Dharma alongside the Blessed One, and of that "you" in relation to it. In the verse as well, the master Dignāga praises this as especially remarkable:

Yet that too and you are not the same;
for the very fact that the two are equal
is something no epistemic instrument (pramāṇa) can express,
and that will not be understood by anyone.

The intended meaning of this is as follows: even though there is a difference between a domestic bull and a wild bull, one may use the general notion of an epistemic instrument and the like to describe them as analogous — just as a domestic bull is, so too is a wild bull; or just as a wild bull is, so too is a domestic bull. In the same way, however, the measure of the Tathāgata and of the precious Dharma is not known by anyone. Therefore: the precious Dharma is not a simile for you, and you yourself are not a simile for the precious Dharma.

If the Blessed One has no analogue, then when this text says "these words arise like nectar dripping from the moon," how can a simile be used at all? The answer is given:

When one takes what is merely a common feature
and speaks of it just a little,
it is for the speaker's own satisfaction
and is but a rough approximation.

"Own satisfaction" means one's personal wish, and this is no more than a contradiction. The word "just" indicates that there is no genuine simile. What then? As the text says, "when one takes what is merely a common feature" — a common feature is what exists in something else as well; "takes" means examining the phenomena thoroughly; "a little" means precisely what it says: a little. The meaning is this: whatever simile for you has been mentally constructed by taking a common feature shared with other phenomena — because it is for one's own satisfaction, it is no more than a contradiction; it is not a genuine simile. As for what the text says, "when one has pointed to something" and so forth, "something" refers to that thing regarding which, having taken a common feature, one speaks using the very language of analogy — that person, the speaker, has produced merely a rough approximation; meaning: something extremely rough. Therefore the Blessed One has no analogue. This is the exposition of the praise of the incomparable. This is the third chapter, the exposition of the praise of the incomparable.

Now comes the praise of the marvellous, explained through two verses beginning with:

You are victorious over Māra.

You are victorious over Māra,
you inspire faith in all beings —
yet when I contemplate the nature of reality,
I find nothing that is truly great in this.

Those who strive to assail with hostility,
and many who are to be subdued —
that patience in a verse relying on a distinguished station
holds no special wonder.
I find nothing that is truly great in this.

The phrase "this is marvellous" will be explained at the end of the third verse. "I find nothing that is truly great" means it is small. The word "like" is used as an analogy. The word "which" is a filler completing the verse. The intended meaning is this: even hearing that your own śrāvaka, the elder Upavāna, was victorious over Māra, you do not see your own victory over Māra as something great or marvellous like that. The phrase "when I contemplate the nature of reality" means: the nature of reality is the intrinsic nature of all phenomena, and the meaning is "having reflected a little upon the qualities of the buddhas." Just as the learned do not find it marvellous that a jackal claims victory over a lion, so too, even inferring from one's own power that all beings are inspired with faith — and so forth, as stated — the word "all beings" will be explained. "Inspired with faith" means filled with wonder. "Victorious over Māra" is said in dependence upon that victory over Māra. Māra is the god of desire, the divine son, surrounded by thirty-six million spirit-children, who aimed great arrows and hundreds of short spears at the Blessed One and stationed himself nearby in order to obstruct his meditative absorption, yet could not create even the slightest impediment. Your victory over him is regarded as marvellous by ordinary beings, but not by me — this is the intended meaning.

Why not? The answer is given. The phrase "those who strive to assail with hostility" is expanded upon. "Many" means without remainder, and carries the sense of "those endowed with power." The particle also carries the sense of "because." "To assail with hostility" means with an intention that does not turn aside. "Those who are to be subdued" means for the sake of victory. "Those who strive" means those who have stationed themselves nearby. The verse states: "patience holds no special wonder." This means that even in the case of a śrāvaka, applying patience in order to overcome those who labour to assail one does not constitute something difficult to accomplish. As for "relying on a distinguished station": a bodhisattva who has subsequent rebirths, striving over three immeasurable aeons to attain pure merit and wisdom, occupies a distinguished station. Relying on the patience born of that station, it is very easy to be victorious over the unpleasant things sent by Māra's retinue and his emissaries — and for that reason, such easy victory holds no special wonder.

Now, if one asks what then is the Blessed One's true marvel, the answer is given:

On the very night that the māras were fully subdued,
to abandon afflictions of the most extreme intensity
on that same night alone —
that indeed is the marvel.

The phrase "on the very night that the māras were fully subdued" and so forth will be explained. The exclusive particle "alone" indicates the desire to convey a different meaning. "The māras were fully subdued" — because they were employed in actions that bring death, the māra here is the māra who is the divine son, and "fully subdued" means "brought under" in the sense of what came after. As for "to abandon afflictions of the most extreme intensity": afflictions are attachment and the rest, and "to abandon" means the abandonment of those afflictions. Even a śrāvaka does this. What is extreme is the distinction — the fact that even the habitual tendencies were abandoned. "On that very night" refers to the night on which Māra stationed himself nearby in order to disrupt meditative absorption. It is that abandonment of the most intensely great afflictions on that very night which is the marvel — not the victory over Māra. Even when meeting with conditions of distraction, to abandon afflictions of the most extreme intensity — that alone is the marvel; victory over Māra is not.

But if that is so, does not the Blessed One's display of a great miracle, by which he subdued the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) such as Kāśyapa the Perfecter and others, also constitute something marvellous? Why then insist exclusively on this? The answer is given:

The sun, adorned with garlands of rays,
that dispels the darkness —

Hero! What marvel is it that you conquered the non-Buddhists?

So much for the phrase "that dispels the darkness." Dispelling darkness means clearing away pitch-blackness. The sun is simply the sun. But what sort of sun? The answer was given: "adorned with garlands of rays." Rays means rays. It has a thousand of them, and those thousand rays form garlands, so it is "a thousand rays" — and the one who possesses them is "adorned with garlands of rays." That this sun, possessed of a thousand garlands of rays, dispels darkness — that is no marvel. Whoever is a person who does not reflect carefully on this matter regards it as marvellous, thinking "it is marvellous." The clause "that you conquered the non-Buddhists" is to be connected with the word "marvel."

The word "Hero" both serves as a term of address and indicates the reason. Because you are endowed with the greatness of diligence, you are therefore a hero. As for those non-Buddhists, they were subdued even by śrāvakas of lesser diligence — such as Śāradvatīputra and others. Therefore your victory over them is no marvel.

For this reason too it is no marvel, and so the following is to be explained at length:

One free of attachment, against one with attachment;
one free of aversion, against one full of aversion;
one free of delusion, against one who is deluded —
these three ever subdue those three.

The three persons possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion are ever subdued — in corresponding order — by the three persons free of attachment, free of aversion, and free of delusion. In this case too, the non-Buddhists are possessed of attachment, whereas you are fully liberated. Therefore for you to be victorious over the non-Buddhists is, in that sense, no marvel. That is the meaning in brief.

Then what is the marvel of the Blessed One? The answer is given:

Even while you praise the sacred Dharma
and censure what is not the sacred Dharma,
toward the noble and toward the lowly
you harbour neither attachment nor anger.

In the phrase "while you praise the sacred Dharma," praise means praise. Sacred Dharma means virtue belonging to the side of purification. What is not the sacred Dharma means the afflictions belonging to the side of utter defilement. Censure means the act of reproving. Attachment means following attachment. Anger means being enraged. The meaning of "these are not present in you" applies in each case. In regard to whom? The answer is given: "toward the noble and toward the lowly" — that is, toward those who are virtuous and those who are non-virtuous, in corresponding order, attachment and anger are not present. And yet the intent is that both — the praising and the censuring — are done for the purpose of reproving others.

This too is the marvel. For the reason is:

If your mind does not turn
toward attachment and anger

for an arhat or for a non-Buddhist,
what is there left to praise in you?

In the phrase "toward an arhat or toward a non-Buddhist" and so forth, the clause "if your mind does not turn" will serve as the explanation. "An arhat" means those who have abandoned all faults without remainder. "Toward a non-Buddhist" means toward those such as Kāśyapa the Perfecter and others. "Toward attachment and anger" — the intent is: your mind does not turn toward rage against non-Buddhists who cause harm to the nature of reality; that is, you do not become angry toward them.

As for the noble arhats such as the noble Ānanda and others — when Ānanda the forest-dweller, he of the charnel-ground robe —

"Attached to his cave, he looks on without regard for pleasures" — thus, for a long time, the thought you have cherished in your mind: your mind does not turn with attachment toward attaining arhatship and bringing it to full completion. That is, you do not become attached to those things. As for praising you, who are endowed with such extraordinary qualities — by what praise could another being adequately praise you? The meaning is: such praise does not exist.

Further extraordinary qualities are to be described:

Unattached even to virtues,
and toward the virtuous one, no afflicted preference —
how wondrous, the strength of your mind
is utterly and completely pure!

As for the line "Unattached even to virtues" — "virtues" refers to powers, fearlessness, and the like. At the bodhisattva's stage, not reckoning these as equivalent to virtues already attained, and being unattached to them — that is, not becoming attached — is because one strives to make them grow further. The meaning of "he dwells in effort" is that by means of those causal virtues he works to make sentient beings endowed with virtue. "Toward the virtuous one, no afflicted preference" means that even toward one who has come to possess virtues such as meditative concentration and so forth, there is no afflicted preference. Therefore, the words "how wondrous, utterly —" — "how wondrous" means astonishing; "yours" means belonging to you; "utterly" means free from the defilement of attachment and the like, as described above; "the strength of your mind" refers to the mind itself; and "completely

pure" means free from stain.

The verse "The faculties are utterly clear" is to be explained as yet another extraordinary quality:

The faculties are utterly clear,
never diminished in any season —
your mind, ever pure,
appears as if directly manifest.

The faculties — those sense faculties that depend on their respective supports, the eye and so forth — are utterly clear, meaning without defilement, because they are free from changes of countenance caused by anger and the like. Just as it is described in the case of the brahmin of pure birth: the eyes of the Blessed One Gautama are supremely clear, the complexion of his face is pure, and the color of his body is white — this is because his faculties are clear. For example, O Gautama, just as a lump of Jambudvīpa gold of natural purity, polished by a skilled goldsmith and placed upon white cloth, becomes exceedingly bright, pleasing, and luminous — so too are the faculties of the Blessed One Gautama utterly clear — as explained before.

"Never diminished in any season" means characterized by never diminishing, the sense being "at all times." "The mind" refers to the mind itself. "Ever pure" means perpetually clean. "As if directly manifest" — if the mind were not clear, the faculties too would not be clear. As it has been said:

Within a hollow log in which a fire dwells,
leaves will not grow forth from the wood.

Thus the clarity of the faculties serves to indicate the clarity of the mind. And because the clarity of that mind is not directly cognized by those who do not know others' minds, the word "as if" is a simile.

Another extraordinary quality is to be described:

By the excellence of your noble nature and well-spoken words,
and proclaimed through noble conduct,
your intentions and wisdom
are known as pure even among children.

"Even among children" means beginning even from children — that is, universally. "Known" means well renowned. "Yours" means belonging to you. Now, what are these? "Wisdom and intentions" refers to the wisdom of fearlessness and the like.

because it is of the nature of wisdom. The three close placements of mindfulness are the intention. Their purity is due to being free of the stain of affliction. As for how these are renowned even among children, it is replied: the word "proclaimed" means made clear and evident. "Nature" is intention — that is, the mind and the host of mental factors associated with fearlessness and the like. Its proclamation means what is intended by the phrase "has become a sign." As for the phrase "well-spoken words and noble conduct," "well-spoken words" is the enlightened activity of utterly pure speech, and "noble conduct" is the enlightened activity of utterly pure body. The Blessed One who desires little conceals certain qualities, yet even those are made manifest by these — like a secret made plain. Therefore those qualities are proclaimed. The words "these too would not be pure without a pure mind" serve to make clear the purity of the mind. Thus even the profound Dharma of the buddhas is supremely renowned among children. This is how even the worldly say:

From appearance, signs, and movement,
from conduct and from speech,
from the expression of the eyes and face,
the inner mind is to be known.

By means of this verse, the praise of the extraordinary has been explained. This concludes the fourth chapter, the explanation of praise for the extraordinary.

Now, praise of the Blessed One has been offered for a moment by way of the result that is the very essence of the significance of immaterial things. Regarding praise of the body, there are four aspects: generating faith, bringing satisfaction, according with the qualities of support and supported, and the beauty of the body and its qualities mutually depending on and supporting one another. Of these, the first — generating faith — is now to be explained:

Tranquil in presence, yet beautiful to behold,
blazing, yet causing no harm,
tamed, yet of great majesty:
who could fail to place faith in this body?

"Tranquil in presence, yet beautiful to behold" — this will be explained by the words "because the body is like that." One might ask: is not the tranquility of the outer non-Buddhist sages (tīrthikas), who endure suffering and are capable of bearing ascetic hardship, similarly pleasing? It is replied: "pleasing to

behold" means that it is rendered pleasing by being adorned with the major and minor marks, and that is the meaning of "made beautiful to behold." "Blazing" means that it shines with light filling a fathom in all directions. One might ask: since it blazes, does it cause harm like the rays of the sun? It is said: no. "Causing no harm" means that the nature it possesses is one of not harming — the meaning being "in accord with what is seen." "Tamed" means possessing conduct appropriate to one who has gone forth, and that is the meaning of "not given to agitation." One might object that it would be contradictory to be tamed and yet not be without great majesty. It is replied: "of great majesty" means that it is of great majesty. "Body" refers to its color and form as its essential nature. "Who could fail" — the meaning is: what person, however full of aversion, would not be drawn toward faith? The intention is that faith is generated in all beings. How is this so? Because when encountered on every occasion, no displeasure arises toward your body. This is to be explained by the verses beginning:

Your body — that body of yours — by whom,
whether seen a hundred times or seen
for the very first time, alike in both cases —

equally delights the eye. Because of that — "seen a hundred times" means "seen many times." The word "hundred" is used simply to indicate a large number. "By whom seen for the very first time" means: the person who sees that body for the first time — the defining marks of the body have already been explained. "Delights" means causes to be pleased. "Yours" means belonging to you. "The eye" — because it causes the arising of eye-consciousness accompanied by ease. "Equally" means in the same measure. "Both cases" means: not only seeing for the first time, but both together — both seeing a hundred times and seeing for the very first time. This second verse explains precisely the fact that the body generates faith.

One might ask: for what reason does that body generate faith? The answer is given:

Your body, because it is beautiful,
is by nature such that beholding it is never enough;
and all who see it, again and again,
it fills with joy.

"Your body, because it is beautiful" — this is the expanded expression. The word for "satisfaction" here refers to the element of satiation; because it

produces satiation, it is beautiful. This is to be connected to the supporting basis in the manner of a nourishing condition. It is beautiful precisely because it is beautiful. The explanation is this: since living beings never grow sated from beholding the body of the Blessed One adorned with the major and minor marks, that body is therefore called beautiful. A tradition has been heard to this effect: King Rūpasāra (the Essence of Form) wished to generate faith in the son of the fierce king of the cliff-city, and so he set about having an image of the buddha painted on cloth and sending it to him. But all the painters, because they could not get their fill of looking at the limbs and features of the Blessed One, were unable to paint the image. Hearing of this, the Blessed One, since that great king had made the request and the painters had grown weary, said: "Because a Tathāgata is by nature simply inexhaustible to behold, let radiance therefore shine forth from the painted image." Then the Blessed One caused radiance to shine forth from the painted image. King Rūpasāra then sent it to the lord of the cliff-city. Upon seeing it, the king was filled with deep faith, and meditating upon the image of dependent origination painted on that same painted image, he came to behold the noble truths, then went before the Blessed One, went forth into renunciation, and attained the state of an arhat.

The word "because" in the verse means "for the reason that." "Because it is beautiful by nature" means: simply being in accord with beholding. "Body" means the body. "And all who see it, again and again" — one who sees it over and over is filled with the mental ease of joy. "Fills with joy" is the predicate. "Again and again" means: it brings about a joy endowed with an exceptional quality unprecedented before. "Both seeing a hundred times and seeing for the first time" — this is as explained above, which is correct. This verse explains that the body is inexhaustible to behold. The conformity of the support is now to be explained:

The qualities of the support and
the qualities of what rests upon it, mutually
harmonizing, render your body and
your qualities endowed with the highest excellence.

In the verse beginning "The qualities of the support" and so on — the support is the form body, and its quality is stability, since the vajra-bone relics have not yet been seen to perish. The form is supremely beautiful: like the nyagrodha tree, it spans as wide as it is tall, and —

like the upper body of a lion. It blazes, because it is suffused with a cubit of radiant light and ablaze with the major and minor marks. Its color is like gold, and it resembles the supreme excellence of Viṣṇu's power — such is the form body endowed with the qualities of the support, and it is this that is explained as "endowed."

Regarding the phrase "the qualities of what rests upon it": what rests is the set of qualities — the powers, the fearlessnesses, and so forth, along with the unshared qualities. The phrase "qualities of what rests" means that these are distinguished and excellent. In this context, the word "quality" is a word meaning distinction or excellence. The distinguishing excellence of a quality consists in such things as being utterly pure, being unobstructed, being overwhelming, being profound, and so forth. Those very qualities of what rests — the fearlessnesses and the rest — endowed with supreme excellence, are endowed with an excellence that is the cause of greatness of character; and this connects with the phrase "your body and your qualities." The phrase "mutually harmonizing" means: the excellent qualities of the support conforming with the qualities of what rests upon it — that is the support. The qualities of what rests being excellent and conforming with the qualities of the support — that is what rests. This verse, being of such a kind, explains precisely the conformity of the body's resting qualities.

In order to illuminate that very meaning, the two verses beginning "blazing with fair major and minor marks" are now to be explained:

Blazing with fair major and minor marks —
other than from your body,
upon whom else could these qualities of the Tathāgata
beautifully reside?

Just as it is said, "Your body, relying on qualities,
is spoken of as my great glory,"
so too, it is said, those very qualities
declare, "We are beautifully arrayed."

"Upon whom else" means upon some other person. "Beautifully reside" means: they would abide in splendor. Those referred to are the fearlessnesses and the rest. A Tathāgata is so called because he has gone in accordance with the way things truly are (tathatā). Or, just as the perfectly awakened buddhas of the past went forth — setting out — so too this one goes forth setting out to benefit others and so on; hence he is called Tathāgata. Alternatively, just as

going to perfect and complete awakening in the past means being endowed with distinguished primordial wisdom in order to bring to complete fulfillment the accumulations of others and the dharmakāya and so forth, so too this one is said to have gone thus — hence Tathāgata. His qualities are the qualities of the Tathāgata.

Regarding the phrase "other than from your body" — the meaning is: other than from that very body which has been described. What makes it so distinguished? The verse says "blazing with fair major and minor marks," meaning that it is intended to convey: other than the blazing of the fair major and minor marks.

As for the major marks of a great being — the marks consisting in the wheel-signs on the palms of the hands and soles of the feet, the luminous complexion, the ūrṇā hair between the brows, the uṣṇīṣa on the crown of the head, and so forth — these are to be referred to the sūtras.

Now the minor marks are to be explained. They are: nails that are not too long, that are raised, that have a copper-like color, that are smooth; fingers that are rounded, full, subtly graceful, with veins not prominent, with no knotted joints, slender and fine; thighs full and smooth like the trunk of a nyagrodha tree, without imperfections, of unmatched grace, subtly fine and beautiful; blood that is as red as a utpala flower in bloom, clear, smooth, and fragrant like sandalwood — and so forth, making eighty in all.

Furthermore —

"Your body is greatly glorious" — this is the elaboration. "Greatly glorious" means endowed with fortune. "I" is just as in the expression "it is mine." "You" means "yours." The defining marks of the body have already been explained. "Spoke" means uttered speech. Speech is so called because it is an object for living beings. "Like a sight" — this is the analogy. "Relying upon" refers to the reliance explained before. "We are well arrayed" means "they are those by whom we are well arrayed." "Spoke again" means spoke once more. The resonant word is to be explained as before. "That" refers to the body. The qualities have already been explained. The meaning of what has been explained is this: "Your body is like speech relying on qualities — it is that which is endowed with my great glory," meaning that supreme, unsurpassed qualities abide in me. Those qualities — arraying us well through the perfectly pure enlightened activities of you, adorned with the major and minor marks of which it was spoken again — this is what is meant. In this way, body and

qualities, through being mutually support and supported, have been explained with reference to the speech, and so the praise of the body has been set forth. This is the explanation called "The Praise of the Body," which is the fifth chapter.

As for "acting as physician," there are eight divisions. First, through the praise of compassion: the Blessed One, who knows the faults of saṃsāra, abides long out of compassion; and in order to bring great relief from the suffering of sentient beings at that very moment, he dwells in places where many people gather and does not remain in solitude; he endures the sufferings that arise at present; and his compassion is the same toward both the good conduct and the bad conduct of women — these are the four meanings of the words.

In this regard, it should be explained that through the power of aspiration, the Blessed One, until his final passage into nirvāṇa, endures suffering such as hunger and thirst; that he resembles other ordinary beings of saṃsāra; and that he possesses no distinction with regard to causes. As the verse says:

All these wandering beings
are bound without distinction by the afflictions.
You, in order to free wandering beings from their afflictions,
have long held them in compassion's embrace.

Regarding "all without distinction" — "all" refers to the three realms. "Without distinction" means from the gods down to the hell-beings. Because they are without distinction, to be bound by the afflictions means, as is intended, that they have not definitively abandoned them even at the summit of existence. "The afflictions of wandering in saṃsāra" — because saṃsāra brings affliction, these are the afflictions. "Bound by them" means not having passed beyond saṃsāra. "These wandering beings" is this world of sentient beings. Thus, worldly beings, bound by the afflictions, have become afflicted in saṃsāra. "You, in order to free wandering beings from their afflictions" — this is in order to cut the snare of the afflictions of wandering beings with the weapon of wisdom. "Long held in compassion's embrace" — this extends from the time of aspiration all the way until final passage into nirvāṇa.

Because this is so:

Shall I bow first to you,
or rather to that great compassion
by which you, knowing the faults of saṃsāra,
have remained so long in that way?

Regarding "shall I bow first to you" and what follows, the word "or" expresses a question and hesitation. "First" means at the outset. "Bow" means to pay homage. "To you" means to the Blessed One. The defining mark of great compassion has already been explained. "Or rather" has the meaning of "alternatively." As for what gives rise to this hesitation —

That those blinded by mundane understanding, bound by the snare of afflictions, experience the sufferings of saṃsāra — this is no wonder. What is wonderful, however, is expressed by the words "by whom" and what follows. "By whom" means through great compassion. "Such as this" refers to knowing the faults of saṃsāra — that is, the six classes of beings — through a wisdom that has become perfectly clear and luminous. "Has remained" means caused to remain, for the purpose of pacifying over a long time the afflictions of beings. Therefore the thought expressed in "shall I bow first to you" is this: recognizing that otherwise it would be as though an inconclusive sign-inference had been made regarding qualities, the verse "shall I bow first to you" is posed as a complete question. These two verses thus explain that, though knowing the faults of saṃsāra through wisdom, you have remained long within it through compassion.

Furthermore:

You who have abandoned the bliss of solitude,
who dwell among the many —
your time has passed, O you,
through compassion seizing every occasion to act.

Regarding the words "you who have abandoned the bliss of solitude": solitude means the abandonment of crowds and bustle. The bliss that arises from it is the bliss of solitude. "Such as that" — the one in whom that is found as a fitting quality — is one who has abandoned the bliss of solitude, being surrounded by the many disciples to be trained. "You" refers to you yourself. "Has passed" means has gone by. What is this? "Time" refers to nights, days, and so forth. "Seizing every occasion" means acting through a compassion that has found its opportunity. The condensed meaning is: abandoning the bliss of solitude that you yourself cherish, under the sway of a causeless compassion, you are wholly single-pointed in healing others — thus your time has passed.

Why, then, does compassion act having found its occasion? The text replies:

As by the science of nāgas a nāga is drawn from within a lake,
so too you, through the science of compassion,
are drawn from a peaceful hermitage to the outskirts of a town,
for the sake of those to be trained.

Regarding the words "from the peaceful hermitage to the outskirts of a town" and what follows: a hermitage in harmony with peace is peace itself. From there, "to the outskirts of a town" means drawn near to a town. "You" is the Blessed One. "Also" has the sense of "because." As for "like a nāga" and what follows: just as a nāga dwelling in a lake in order to heal the poison of a snakebite is drawn out from the lake by the science of nāgas — in just that same way, you who delighted in peaceful hermitages were drawn from your hermitage to the outskirts of a town by the science of compassion, in order to heal beings bitten by the serpent of afflictions. Therefore the meaning of the extended verse "you who have abandoned the bliss of solitude" is altogether fitting. These two verses thus explain that through the power of compassion you dwell among the many and do not remain in solitude.

Furthermore:

Though abiding in the highest peace,
yet endowed with compassion as your sovereign quality,
you cast aside with your feet
even the artistry of a master musician.

Regarding "though abiding in the highest peace": "abiding in the highest peace" means dwelling in supreme nirvāṇa. The particle rendered "though" carries the sense of wonder. Regarding "endowed with compassion as your sovereign quality": "sovereign" means what is principal, what is said to lead or guide; the one in whom that resides is endowed with the sovereign quality. The essential nature of that is being endowed with compassion as the sovereign quality — it is through compassion, and not through anything else.

That "endowed with compassion as sovereign quality" means having come to possess compassion as one's sovereign quality. "You cast aside with your feet" means you set your feet in motion. Why? That is what is expressed by the words "the artistry of a master musician." The artistry of a master musician consists in the crafts of the arts. Even those you cause to enter into your activity. For example: assuming the guise of a master musician, you went to the realm of the gods. There, the Blessed One himself struck the strings of a lute, and though a thousand strings were cut, a sound that filled the entire sky

was proclaimed, whereby the gandharva king — a craftsman of lute-playing named Atimuditā, the Very Joyful One — who was endowed with pride in his art of striking strings, was freed from that pride of a master musician and was brought to taming. So it is heard. This too shows that it was not in accord with ordinary expectation, but was done through a compassion that takes up from the very beginning the suffering of beings to be tamed.

Furthermore:

Miraculous power, the lion's roar,
and whatever proclaims your own qualities —
these you enact through compassion, O Protector,
for you are without craving and conduct.

"Miraculous power, the lion's roar, and..." — this is elaborated. Miraculous power refers to things such as flying through the sky, blazing with fire, causing rain to fall, and so forth. The lion's roar is like the roaring of a lion and the sound of thunder. As it is said: "Outside of me, among ascetics (śramaṇas) or brahmins there is none who can rightly proclaim the lion's roar among these assemblies of retinues" — and so on. Because he proclaims it just as a fearless lion does, it is the lion's roar. "Whatever proclaims your own qualities" means praise of yourself — as in "endowed with the ten powers," "Tathāgata," "arhat," and so forth. Miraculous power, the lion's roar, and the proclamation of one's own qualities — these are things that childish, worldly people display to others out of desire. That is why the verse continues: "for you are without craving and conduct." Here, craving means desire and thirst; conduct means engaging in the stream of sense objects through that very craving. "Without these" means that whoever has abandoned them is without craving and conduct. "These you enact through your compassion" — "these" refers to miraculous power and so forth. "Enacted through compassion" is the sign of compassion. Just as the quality of gold, whether good or poor, is tested with a touchstone, in the same way the compassion of the Blessed One — who acts bearing the present suffering of sentient beings — is to be inferred from the touchstone of miraculous power and the rest, because he is without craving and conduct. This is the condensed meaning. With these two verses it is explained that, through the power of compassion, he does not stand apart from the present suffering.

Now the explanation conforming to the manner of a woman who is noble and one who is not shall be given:

For the sake of others, O most excellent one,
showing no tenderness toward your own support,
compassion — you alone, O Protector,
are the compassionate one.

"For the sake of others, O most excellent one" — this is elaborated. "For the sake of others" means acting as a physician for others. "Most excellent" means the wise one. The particle of address applies to the one being addressed. "Showing no tenderness toward your own support" — the support of the Tathāgata himself is this: showing no tenderness toward it, acting with harshness and severity, is what will be explained as compassion. "You alone" refers to the Blessed One and not to another. "Alone" carries the sense of one who is supremely great.

"O Protector" — this is a form of address.

"You have not acted with tenderness through compassion" — this is what is now explained. "Acting with compassion" and "taking under one's care" are the characteristics that accord with the meaning of compassion. It has not become a characteristic according with the meaning of compassion toward your own domain. Therefore, showing no tenderness toward one's own support and having attachment toward others — by that nature of attachment to others, the conduct of women that is not excellent is described. As for how one comes to understand "attachment to others" and "absence of tenderness toward one's own support," the reply is:

Thus, at times, O steadfast one,
for the sake of accomplishing the good of others,
you have been cast in all directions
a hundred times over, like a torma offering.

On the verse "Thus, a hundred times over, in all directions" — "thus" means: just as this is to be explained as attachment to others and absence of tenderness toward one's own support, so it is to be explained. "Since which" means "for the sake of which." Or again, "thus which" is a conjunctive particle that introduces clearly the meaning one wishes to explain. "You" refers to you yourself. "A hundred times" means many times over. Because of being steadfast, "steadfast" is stated as being compassion itself. "At times, like a torma offering" — just as those without compassion cut a thing into pieces in all directions and send it forth as a torma offering in order to please yakṣas and the like, so too — with compassion, yet resembling one who has no

compassion — you have been cast a hundred times over: this is what will be explained. For what reason? The reply is:

For the sake of accomplishing the good of others.

This means for the sake of providing food for the tiger cubs and the like. "You" means you yourself. It was given over at the time of application to the bodhisattva stage. "In all directions" carries the force of an instrumental case ending, with the meaning of being sent forth in the four directions. Because things became that way, the excellent benefit to others is well explained.

By these two verses, when conduct resembling that which is not the excellent conduct of women is described, what then is the excellent conduct of women is to be explained. Even an ordinary person would not come under the sway of a deceitful woman — and what need is there even to speak of a bodhisattva distinguished by steadfastness? Thus:

Although they do harm to you,
not accounting them as those who have transgressed,
aligning yourself solely with what you desire
is indeed excellent.

"Although they do harm to you" — this is the elaboration. Even at the cost of your own life, you think of cherishing the lives of others. Therefore, this compassion is aligned with what you desire and does not conflict with your mind; engaging thus is engaging for the sake of healing sentient beings. "Excellent" means this is so. How is this to be understood? The reply is given in the verse beginning "Although they do harm to you." "Thus" is to be explained as before. Or alternatively, "thus" refers to the manner of being cut into pieces a hundred times and cast as a tormā offering and so forth. "Even" carries the meaning of "because." "Although they do harm to you" means even while tormenting you. "You" is the Blessed One. "Not accounting" means it is good — not that they are malicious. Because of "not accounting them as those who have transgressed" — if a malicious woman is to be abandoned, you have not abandoned this compassion; therefore, certainly, this means: not accounting them as transgressors, not treating it as a transgression. In this way, because this is aligned with the intention expressed here, it is to be clearly understood that compassion resembles the excellent conduct of women, as made clear by this verse.

This concludes the explanation of the praise of compassion. This is the explanation of the chapter called "Praise of Compassion" — the sixth chapter.

The praise of speech has eleven divisions. Among these, the verse that explains the distinctions of meaning in the words will be explained later. Regarding this, there are two verses beginning with the words "beautiful of language, of great meaning":

Your speech is thus:

Beautiful of language and of great meaning,
True and pleasant,
Possessed of meaning both profound and clear,
And endowed with both the concise and the elaborate.
Even if your enemy were to hear it,
Who could fail to give rise to certainty
And exclaim, "Excellent! You are omniscient"?

To explain the words "beautiful of language": speech that possesses beautiful language is beautiful of language — meaning language that is clear. Now, one might ask: even if the language is clear, is the meaning not sparse, as with elegant poetic composition and the like? The reply is given: it is of great meaning because it illuminates the higher realms and liberation. The words of the yellow-robed sages (ṛṣis) and others are also clear in that way; however, because those others illuminate meaning that is mistaken, they must be distinguished from this. "True" means "not mistaken." Most of what is not true is still pleasant — these are agreeable and pleasing, in the sense of being suitable to be heard.

Apt combination corresponds to the capacity of those to be trained who are of lesser, middling, or sharp faculties — and that which possesses the meaning of the profound, the clear, and both together is possessed of meaning both profound, clear, and both combined. In this regard, that which possesses the meaning of the words of dependent origination is profound — that is, the profound. That which possesses the lighter meaning of generosity and so forth is the clear meaning. That which possesses both the meaning of dependent origination and the rest is possessed of meaning both combined.

The concise is the brief summary — as for example: "Monks, you should abandon the phenomenon called form." The elaborate is the expanded version, such as: "Monks, form is not self; for if form were self, form would not come to be afflicted and suffering." That which possesses both of these is endowed with both the concise and the elaborate, because it is given in accordance with those to be trained who delight in the concise and in the

elaborate respectively.

"Who" means it is impossible. "Could not arise" means it does not arise. "Having heard" means upon hearing. "Speech" refers to the collection of sūtras, the collection of mixed prose and verse, and so forth. "Thus" means possessing the character as described. The first "your" means "of you." The second "your" refers to the Blessed One. "Even the enemy" means the word "also" — not only followers and the middling, but even enemies. "Because of omniscience" is why it is called omniscience. "By that" means "the condition of certainty." These two verses show that the Blessed One's speech illuminates solely omniscience — this is the explanation of the first division.

Furthermore:

Pleasant it is not on account of mere quantity;
It surpasses what has been merely embellished.
Yet even through the accomplishment of meaning in your speech,
Everything is well-spoken and nothing less.

"Pleasant it is not on account of mere quantity" — this is the elaboration. "Quantity" means what is mostly pleasant, in the sense of being agreeable to hear. The expression "all speech" will be explained presently. "What has been merely embellished" refers to one who clings to the enjoyment of desired pleasures — such a person cannot be gathered in by speech that is merely concordant with that desire. The meaning of "what has been merely embellished is not pleasant" is this: for example, the speech taught in order to show the danger of continued existence for one attached to the pleasures of desire goes:

What joy and delight could there be
In something so ablaze?
For one who dwells in darkness...

...would not seek a lamp,

as it is said. Now, some others put it this way: what has been embellished is not pleasant speech. For example, consider what the Blessed One declared to Devadatta: "You foolish man — if the Saṅgha of monks would not be entrusted to Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana, why on earth would they be entrusted to you? For you are going to become one who licks the spittle of a commoner named Ambaṣṭha, who is the son of a slave-woman of the Śākya." Therefore the Blessed One, with compassion in mind for a disciple who was fit to be

tamed by staying with an attitude of intolerance, declared it thus. And that too is neither unpleasant nor harsh, because it is free from any affliction of mind.

The meaning of the word "speech" has already been explained. "Accomplishing the aim" means doing so for the sake of accomplishing the aim of higher states and liberation. The word "also" indicates a different meaning. "All" refers to what is pleasant and what is unpleasant. "Well spoken" means well spoken. With such a verse as this, the speech of the Śākyas is pleasant — and this constitutes the explanation of the second division.

That same point is now to be stated:

When your speech is thoroughly examined,
whatever is gentle and whatever is rough,
and whatever partakes of both —
all of it becomes a single taste.

Whatever is gentle will be explained as pleasant speech. What kind, one might ask? As it is stated in the sūtra that sets out the grounds: "This is the virtuous conduct of body; this is the fruit that is the karmic maturation of virtuous bodily conduct; this is the virtuous conduct of speech and mind; this is the fruit that is the karmic maturation of virtuous conduct of speech and mind; and these are gods and humans."

What is called rough is what accords with what is rough. Just as in that same sūtra: "This is the misconduct of body; this is the fruit that is the karmic maturation of bodily misconduct; this is the misconduct of speech and mind; this is the fruit that is the karmic maturation of misconduct of speech and mind; and these are the hells, animals, and hungry ghosts."

"Whatever partakes of both" means: the speech that partakes of both those two — gentle and rough — with "partakes" meaning just that. Likewise from that very sūtra: "This is the virtuous conduct of body" and so forth, as before; and similarly "This is the misconduct of body" and so forth, as before.

"All" means that the speech that is gentle, rough, and partaking of both becoming a single taste is the analysis conducted to the final limit of a single liberation — this is the range of conduct; "becomes" means becomes. "Your" refers to your speech. Your speech, because it is free from attachment and anger and is conjoined with compassion — when thoroughly practiced, all of it becomes a single taste, leading those who abide in virtuous conduct to attain liberation by that engagement. That is the condensed meaning.

With such a verse as this, speech and liberation are of a single taste — this is the explanation of the third division.

Therefore one should praise it with a mind filled with wonder:

How wondrous! Supremely pure
are the enlightened activities — be skilled in them!
I have fashioned this vessel of the same kind
for the precious speech.

"How wondrous! Supremely pure" — this is an elaboration. "How wondrous!" expresses astonishment. "Supremely pure enlightened activities" refers to what is entirely white, because duplicity is perpetually abandoned, as it is said, and so forth. "Be skilled" means to be expert. "Supremely" carries the sense of "endowed with distinction." "By that activity" is connected with the complete verbal expression of the agent. "This" — by means of the faith that has arisen, it makes it as if directly present —

"For the precious speech" — the speech is precious because it is supremely rare, on account of its qualities such as beautiful phrasing, vast meaning, and so forth. "Of the same kind" means resembling this in form, adorned with major marks and excellent features. "Vessel" means a support or receptacle. "I have fashioned" means created and definitively accomplished — the intention being "consonant with the precious speech."

As to what kind of vessel it is for those precious jewels of speech, the text explains:

When your face is seen, it is supremely beautiful;
when from it one listens, the words are melodious —
these teachings of yours arise
like nectar dripping from the moon.

Concerning the line "When your face is seen, it is supremely beautiful," the words "from that face" will be explained presently. The particle "when" carries the meaning "for the reason that." "Beautiful to behold" means pleasant to see — the sense being that it is worthy of being looked upon. This will be explained as "speech." What kind of speech is it? It is "melodious to the ear." "From the face" means dripping from the mouth, arising as if dripping. The defining characteristics of your speech have now been described. Regarding "arising like nectar dripping from the moon," it is well known in the world that the moon is by nature nectar. Just as from the moon there drips nectar whose

nature is to be cool and soothing, so it is taught that from the moon of the Blessed One's face, it is precisely the speech that arises like dripping nectar, for it brings about the attainment of ultimate truth and nirvāṇa. These two verses together describe the support that is consonant with the speech, which is the explanation of the fourth category.

Furthermore:

Your speech is like a rain cloud
that thoroughly pacifies the dust of attachment.
Because it drives out the serpent of aversion,
it is like Garuḍa, king of the sky.

Concerning "thoroughly pacifies the dust of attachment" — attachment itself is the dust, and by teaching what is disagreeable, such as the foulness of the body and so forth, it thoroughly pacifies that dust, meaning it dispels it. The meaning of the speech has been explained. "Yours" means belonging to you. "Like a rain cloud" — although it is not a rain cloud, because it functions in a manner similar to a rain cloud, it is said to be like one. The grammatical construction with the suffix following words such as "tree" and so on should also be understood to apply here in the same way of explanation. Concerning "like Garuḍa, king of the sky," Garuḍa is the lord of the sky, and the simile works by way of the speech moving as Garuḍa does, because it teaches loving-kindness and so forth. Concerning "because it drives out the serpent of aversion" — aversion itself is the serpent, because it releases the poison of anger. "Because it drives out" carries the sense of "by relying upon that."

Furthermore:

By vanquishing the cataract of unknowing
that recurs again and again, it is like an umbrella.
By vanquishing the mountain of pride,
it is like the weapon of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods).

"Like an umbrella" — this is an elaboration. Because it functions like an umbrella, it is likened to one. "Again and again" — by teaching dependent origination as something that recurs repeatedly, it illuminates the former limit, the latter limit, and the middle; therefore, the speech is likened to an umbrella, and this is to be applied to all cases. What does it do? The text explains: concerning "by vanquishing the cataract of unknowing," unknowing is what is known as ignorance — it is the cataract that obstructs the correct view, and the meaning is that it thoroughly clears that away. "The weapon of

Śakra" is the vajra (Skt. vajra), and the speech acts in a manner similar to it. Pride, by virtue of sharing the defining characteristic of elevation with a mountain, is therefore a mountain. Because it vanquishes that mountain, the speech is like the weapon of Śakra — both because karma is to be appropriated as one's own, and because it arises from selflessness. When one reflects that karma is to be appropriated as one's own, it comes about as follows: from karma arise lineage, form, youth, and all the other qualities as well. This is connected with selflessness, and —

since it is merely conditioned, arising from karma that has come under the sway of afflictions and is governed by others, through what mode could there be pride? This then is the meaning of that verse.

Those two verses in this manner vanquish attachment, aversion, delusion, and pride, and because they do so through speech, the fifth division has been set forth.

Furthermore:

Because it sees meaning, it does not deceive.

Because it knows no fault, it is concordant.

Being well composed, it is easy to understand.

Your speech possesses these three excellences.

"Because it sees meaning, it does not deceive" — this is the elaborated form. The one in whom the seeing of meaning abides is the seer of meaning. The word "three" will be explained in its place. Its essential nature is this: because it sees meaning, it does not deceive — that is what is meant by the word "true." The meaning of the Blessed One's speech is seen to be non-deceptive, because those who enter into that speech attain the higher realms and liberation. As an example: one hundred years after my passing into nirvāṇa, a fierce king called Aśoka will arise, and in a single night he will build eighty thousand stūpas for the Dharma-king — so declared the Blessed One. Likewise, everything such as "In a future time, the people called the Kūṭaka will develop wrinkles on their heads, and sons will be born even of young girls" — all of this will be found to come about in accordance with what was declared. Alternatively, the speech that speaks of what is seen in its meaning is non-deceptive.

The one who sees meaning through the wisdom that vanquishes ignorance and the rest — that is the seer of meaning, and that is none other than the Blessed One himself. His speech is non-deceptive, for he is the seer of

meaning.

The words of those whose minds are agitated by attachment and the rest are discordant. The Blessed One's, however, because he knows no fault, are concordant. The intention here is that, unlike the words of the renowned great sages and others, there is no discordance between what was said earlier and what is said later.

"Easy to understand" means that it is made comprehensible by beings who are to be tamed. "Well composed" is explained as follows: just as those who are to be tamed come to know the meaning through the distinctions of ordinary language, Dharmic language, and the language of border peoples, likewise it is said to be well composed. Therefore, in the one in whom the seeing of meaning, concordance, and ease of understanding are all present — that one possesses the three excellences, and that is your speech. The particle "ni" is a metrical filler. By means of these three aspects, the speech that is perfectly pure proclaims the one known as the Teacher — thus this verse sets forth the sixth division.

Furthermore:

First, your speech captivates the minds of those who hear it.
Then, when one reflects upon it in mind,
it dispels even dust and darkness.

Regarding "captivates the minds of those who hear it": "mind" here means the stream of consciousness. "First" has the sense of sequential order. It captivates the minds of those who hear it in the sense that, through a voice endowed with the five qualities, they do not follow after anything else. "First" means at the outset. "Speech" means the speech itself. "Your" means your own. After hearing, in the subsequent time, "when one reflects upon it in mind" refers to the sequence of reflection and meditation. "Dust" is all the afflictions, because they soil the continuum. "Darkness" refers to delusion. All the varieties of affliction are improperly described as delusion because delusion precedes them. As for attachment, it is indicated by the mere word "dust" as that which is to be abandoned. Here it is said that from one aspect of speech to another, the afflictions are vanquished together with their root. By this the seventh division, which shows that the speech captivates, has been set forth.

Furthermore:

It gives relief to those who are destitute,
it causes those who are heedless to tremble,
and in that it protects those who dwell in ease —

"Your speech accords with all,
it gives relief to those who are destitute" —

regarding this: "those who are destitute" are those who are afflicted by mental afflictions. Because it has been taught that definite emergence from those afflictions is possible, such relief is spoken of — hence it gives relief to those who are destitute. "Speech" will be explained further. For example: fishermen had dragged a large fish to the bank of a river alongside a creature of the same water-dwelling kind, and that fish was in great suffering. By the power of the Blessed One it then spoke, saying, "When I die and pass from here, I will be reborn in a hell realm." The Blessed One then spoke to it this verse:

Have faith, with a mind of full confidence,
in me, the compassionate Victor.
Having abandoned the animal realm of birth,
from there you shall go to the higher realms.

With this verse he granted relief. Through profound faith in the Blessed One, that being took birth among the gods, and by approaching the Blessed One, it came to see the truth. Likewise, other examples such as a suffering venomous snake and so forth should be understood in the same way.

As for "it causes those who are heedless to tremble" — those who are heedless, lacking one-pointed focus on virtuous activity, are caused to develop fear through the teaching of suffering. As it is said:

Just as a ripe fruit
always carries the danger of falling,
so too people who are born
always carry the danger of death.

And by showing scarcity amid enjoyment, or by showing arising and perishing, those who dwell in ease, experiencing the pleasure of desired objects, are made to feel weariness — which is to say, they are led to develop dispassion. For example:

Acquainted with the wise, one knows desire
to be slight and brimming with suffering;
thus even toward the pleasures of the gods

one will feel no special delight.
Conditioned things are impermanent —
being phenomena that involve birth,
they arise and then fall apart;
their swift pacification is bliss.

These are the two verses.

Therefore, the manner of proceeding in accordance and harmony is to proceed in a way suited and fitting to each — that is what "accords with all" means, and it is your speech. By such a verse the eighth division, which shows that your speech accords with all, has been set forth.

Furthermore:

It generates joy in the wise,
it ripens the understanding of those in between,
and, dispelling the cataract of ignorance in the least —
this speech of yours is medicine for all beings.

As for "it generates joy in the wise" — this is the elaboration. The wise are those of sharp faculties. "Joy" is the generation of mental ease — joy is generated because the mere utterance of it brings understanding. "Speech" will be explained further. For example: the being who had previously become a divine son from a water creature, upon seeing the very nature of truth, became like a merchant who had found profit — attaining mental ease, he departed. So it has been taught at length.

As for "those in between" — those of middling faculties have their understanding ripened through applying themselves in listening, reflection, and so forth, whereby wisdom is drawn near through cultivation. "Ripens the understanding" means that their wisdom is gradually developed.

As for "the least" — those of dull faculties have their cataract of ignorance dispelled, and their certainty in the connection between karma and its results is firmly established. Thus, because this speech is medicine for those of sharp, middling, and dull faculties alike, it is medicine for all beings — and this is the very speech being described. By such a verse the ninth division, which shows that the speech is medicine for all beings, has been set forth.

Once more:

It draws one away from views with delight,
it guides one close to nirvāṇa,
it removes faults — your speech
also rains down a shower of qualities.

Regarding "it draws one away from views with delight" — "drawing with delight" means drawing to a distance. "Speech" will be explained.

The views are such things as the view of the transitory collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi) and the view of holding to an extreme, and so forth. By teaching the exhaustion of afflictions, the path of seeing arises — that is the reason. As for "it guides one close to nirvāṇa" — by that very teaching of the exhaustion of afflictions, the path of meditation is generated; and so the meaning is that it guides one close to nirvāṇa with remainder, that is, to nirvāṇa with a residual aggregate. As for "it removes faults" — this is because, by the very teaching of abandoning afflictions, the path of no-more-learning is generated. "Faults" refers to the complete removal of all faults of the three realms without exception; and "rains down" means it rains down indeed. Because it causes the attainment of arhatship, a shower of qualities also rains down — such as freedom from affliction, the wisdom of aspiration, and so forth — because it teaches what gives rise to those. Thus, by a verse of this kind, the tenth division has been set forth, showing that the speech is concordant with the path of seeing, the path of meditation, and the path of no-more-learning.

Because memory and intelligence are accompanied by obstruction, the words "the great sage" and so forth are false. But concerning the Blessed One, the verse to be explained at length runs:

Your mind, unobstructed toward all,
your intention abiding in all things evenly —
therefore all your prophecies
are never deceiving, not one.

"Unobstructed toward all" — "unobstructed" with respect to all knowable things means having no obstruction whatsoever. "Mind" is wisdom, because afflictive obscuration is abandoned, as is ignorance that is both afflictive and non-afflictive. "Your" will be explained below. "Toward all" means toward knowable things themselves; "abiding" means meditative equipoise. "Intention" means desiring an object. "Deceiving" means teaching what is without result. "Non-deceiving" means not deceiving — meaning it is endowed with result, that is the intention. "Therefore" means because that is the cause.

Because your mind and intention are in meditative equipoise toward all things, all your prophecies — that is, your instructions — are non-deceiving: that is the meaning. And for this reason too it is non-deceiving:

Because it does not engage those who are not proper recipients,
not the right time, not the right vessel —
therefore your speech has meaning,
like diligence that is well begun.

Regarding the statement "because it does not engage those who are not proper recipients, not the right time," and so forth: "because" means "for the reason that." "Not a proper recipient" means engaging precisely with the proper recipient — for the sake of the purpose of the one to be trained. For instance, wishing to display great miracles, he traveled from Rājagṛha to Śrāvastī. "Not the right time" means engaging precisely at the right time. As when King Prasenajit asked for how long the Blessed One had displayed great miracles, it was said, "after seven days had passed" — because he saw that within that span of time the stream of mind of those to be trained would be fully ripened. "Not a proper vessel" means those who are not vessels — such as those beyond help and the like. "A vessel" means he engages precisely with those who are vessels, those possessing the seed of liberation. "Therefore" means by that reason it has meaning, that is, your speech is endowed with meaning. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are those who teach the Dharma with results that are endowed with meaning. In what way? It is said:

Like diligence that is well begun.

As the Blessed One has taught: a childish kind of diligence gives rise to laziness, while striving too intensely leads to agitation. Thus, having abandoned both extremes, one should arouse diligence by way of the middle path — such is the meaning.

Just as diligence that is well begun becomes endowed with meaning and leads to liberation itself, so too, by that cause, that speech is called endowed with meaning. Those two verses thus explain the nature of the fruit of speech endowed with meaning. The eleven-fold division is an explanation in praise of speech — and this is indeed the explanation in praise of speech, which is the seventh chapter.

Since the meaning of speech is the teaching, after the praise of speech one should next explain the praise of the teaching. It is said:

A single path, with ease of method,
Well connected, and without fault,
Wholesome at the beginning, middle, and end —
A teaching like yours exists nowhere else.

Regarding the words "a single path, with ease of method," and so forth: that by which one travels is the path, and since it is both "one" and a "path," it is "a single path" — this will be explained as: the teaching. As it is said in a sūtra: "For the purification of view, there is no other path than this." It is indeed a single path — just as one speaks of the Tathāgata's teaching. Or alternatively, since it is to be traversed in order to attain liberation, and liberation alone is what is to be attained, it is "a single path of traveling." The phrase "traversed by one" is a sixth-case compound. As it is taught in the sūtra of the simile of the *śiṃśapā* leaves: those phenomena by directly knowing which, by fully awakening to which, and by rightly entering toward *nirvāṇa* — those alone he knew, fully and perfectly awakened to, and taught.

As for "ease of method," method here means application. Since the teaching possesses ease of method — in that it counters austere mortification involving torment and the like — that is what "ease of method" means. Being endowed with ease, the mind will enter into meditative equipoise: these are words of a sūtra.

"Well connected" means that as long as liberation has not been attained, the teaching possesses the character of being well connected in the way results properly accrue for gods and humans.

"Fault" means defect. Since the teaching is not endowed with the faults of attachment and the like, it is "without fault."

"The beginning" is the time of hearing; "the middle" is the time of reflection; and "the end" is the time of meditation — these are wholesome, being endowed with the defining marks of higher states and definite excellence. It is therefore the teaching that is wholesome at the beginning, middle, and end, since it is the cause of all those.

"A teaching like yours exists nowhere else" — this refers to the teachings of the yellow-robed sages, the adherents of *Peluka*, the naked ones, and others. The teaching here is worthy of being relied upon in every way.

Likewise it is also said:

A system of teaching such as yours,
Wholly resolved and with attachment to views —
If childish ones were to find fault with it,
There would be an enemy just like that view.

"Wholly resolved" means extensive. Such is the collection of "a single path" and so forth. Being "wholly resolved" is what is to be desired. "Wholly resolved is your system" — this will be the explanation. Attachment to the corrupted views of non-Buddhists is attachment to views, for it is by that which is the cause of attachment to views. "Childish ones" means exactly the childish. "System" means the teaching. "If" is a conditional particle. "To find fault" means to engage in disparagement. "There would be" means there would be. "An enemy like a view" is an enemy resembling a view — it is precisely a view. Those are the supreme enemies: those childish ones who thereby disparage your teaching, endowed with virtue. That is the summary.

As for another:

For the sake of beings,
Whatever many sufferings you have undergone —
Thinking of that, even if your teaching were poor,
It would come down to abiding in it.

"Having undergone" means: what you yourself have experienced. As for "what you yourself have undergone," the meaning is: what you yourself have undergone.

"Whatever suffering" connects with what was said before. "For the sake of" means on account of that reason. For whose sake? For the sake of beings. "Suffering" refers to the many sufferings of many kinds endured from the arousing of the awakening mind up through nirvāṇa, and likewise the many sufferings of hell-beings and animals — that is what suffering means. "Thinking of" means by recollection. "Even if poor" means even in what is not beautiful. The particle "even" indicates something that would be impossible, yet is shown to be supremely close to peace. "It would come down to abiding in it" means it is fitting to abide in it. "Your teaching" refers to the rite you yourself have proclaimed. The explanation is this: because you act as a physician, it is fitting — taking care of even a poor expression of your teaching — to abide in it.

You who teach what is beneficial and who act for benefit —
What need is there to speak of your teaching?

Even with a burning fire having entered one's head,
For what reason would one not strive?

As for what is said — "What need is there to speak of one who acts for benefit?" — the phrase "what need is there to speak" conveys the absence of doubt. "Who acts for benefit" means one who acts for benefit through the display of miraculous powers and through the skillful means of taking on the manner of others. "Who teaches what is beneficial" means one possessed of the conduct of teaching what is beneficial. The defining characteristic of the teaching has already been explained. "For what reason" means because it is impossible — there is no other way, and there is no way in which one would not strive. "Even with a burning fire having entered one's head" — even should the head catch fire and burn, the intended meaning is: with equanimity toward the burning of the head, through seeing the noble truths, one should bring your teaching to its fruition. This is what the Blessed One declared: "Monks, even with the head burning, setting that aside with equanimity, in order to actualize the four noble truths that have not yet been actualized, one should strive with great aspiration and great diligence for as long as it takes — this is what is fitting."

Having, by means of those verses, explained the reason why one enters the teaching — the cause — one should now explain the benefits of entering the teaching:

Through your teaching, autonomy,
The bliss of awakening, peace,
The praise of your qualities —
All these four excellent things are obtained.

"Autonomy and the bliss of awakening" and so forth will be explained in fuller detail. Autonomy is precisely the nature of reality — obtaining it will be explained further. Autonomy means just that: autonomy — the meaning being that one has not come under the power of another. By relying on the teaching, craving is abandoned; therefore one does not become a slave, for craving is the cause of slavery. It is said accordingly:

When craving is cut off at the root,
Attainment comes into the palm of one's hand.
When there is no opportunity for it to take hold,
Slavery itself comes to rest upon one's head.

As for "awakening" — because all suffering without exception has been vanquished, awakening alone is bliss. "Praise" means veneration. Having offered praise to your qualities means paying homage to your qualities. Among my śrāvakas endowed with wisdom, Śāriputra (Śāriputra) is supreme because he has become the divine eye; and the foremost among those endowed with miraculous powers is the monk known as Maudgalyāyana (Maudgalyāyana). In order to honor with such qualities and more — "peace" means nirvāṇa. "Obtaining" means to obtain. What, then? "All these four excellent things" — all four excellent things beginning with autonomy will be obtained. From what? From your teaching — that is the meaning.

Having, by means of such a verse, explained the benefits of entering the teaching, one should now explain how the teaching is victorious over the four māras:

O hero, this teaching of yours
Causes all non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) to tremble,
Fills the māras with anguish,
And brings relief to gods and humans.

Regarding the line "causes all non-Buddhists to tremble" and what follows: "causes to tremble" means to fill with fear. "Teaching" means what will be explained. Entering for the purpose of fully understanding supreme excellence is like a shore, and so it is called a "shore." Because that is well expressed, "non-Buddhist" refers to those who complete things by such means, and so forth. The teaching causes all of them to tremble because it teaches the truth of selflessness. Since those non-Buddhists have no desire to praise the view of a self, they will be made to tremble by the Tathāgata's teaching that all phenomena are without a self. It has thus been explained that, because teaching selflessness overcomes all the afflictions that arise from grasping at a self, the teaching is completely victorious over the māra of afflictions (kleśas) without remainder.

"Māra" here refers to the māra who is the son of a god. The statement that the teaching is victorious over the māra who is the son of a god means that it is taught to transcend that one's domain. As for the fear of lower destinies — that is not what is indicated here by the teaching of the truth. The line "brings relief to gods and humans" means that because this is the method for granting life even to human beings, it is declared that the teaching is victorious over the māra of the aggregates (skandhamāra).

"This of yours" is as has been explained. "Hero" is a form of address. Now the victory over the māra of the Lord of Death is to be explained:

The Lord of Death, whose teaching ranges
Across the vast ground of the three realms,
Who strikes without obstacle or distinction
And cannot be turned back —
Even he is overwhelmed by your teaching.

Regarding "the vast ground of the three realms" and so forth: the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm are the three realms. The vast ground of those very realms is the great domain. "Ranges across it" means that the Lord of Death ranges across that vast ground of the three realms. "The teaching of the Lord of Death" will now be explained. Even toward those endowed with good qualities, "without obstacle" means that, because there is no obstruction, there is no distinction — this conveys the sense of "he strikes down and kills." "Cannot be turned back" means there is no hook that can restrain him — the meaning is that he cannot be reversed. "By your teaching" means by the path of your teaching. "Overwhelmed" means rendered powerless. "Lord of Death" means of the Lord of Death. "Teaching" here carries the sense of "setting forth" or "entering."

If one asks from what this is understood, it is explained:

One who seeks the heart of your teaching,
If joyful, abides for a whole aeon;
And wherever the māras do not intrude,
There too shall one go with great rejoicing.

"One who seeks the way of your teaching" — because one knows the manner of your teaching, one seeks the way of your teaching: this conveys the sense of being endowed with the power cultivated through the four bases of miraculous power (ṛddhipāda). "Na" here carries the sense of "because" or "for what reason." "Abides even for an aeon" means not merely for many years but abiding even for an entire aeon — the intended meaning is that this is genuinely possible. As for whoever, among some, cultivates, practices, and wishes to perfect all four bases of miraculous power: that one abides for an aeon, or even beyond an aeon — this is the wording of the sūtra. "Shall go" means to proceed. "There" means into the nirvāṇa without remainder, the nirvāṇa in which no aggregates remain. The particle "also" carries its usual meaning of "also" — meaning that one shall also go there. If one asks why one

shall go there: because the joy of being liberated from the bondage of the afflictions is freedom. Where? Into nirvāṇa without remainder of aggregates, and nowhere else. "The māras do not intrude" means it is beyond their domain. Since this is the case, the meaning of the earlier verse — the line "the vast ground of the three realms" — is now made consistent with the preceding verse's intent.

Those verses, then, express only the victory over the four māras through the teaching. Furthermore:

The meaning of scripture — reflection,
cultivation, and reverent listening:
the threefold division by time is found
nowhere but in your teaching.

Regarding the line "the meaning of scripture — reflection," this is an elaboration. "Scripture" means what is heard from another. "Reflection on the meaning" means attending to reasoning. "Cultivation" is explained as meditative absorption (samādhi). "Reverent listening" is application — that is, cultivation and reverent listening. The particle "and" connects scripture and reflection on the meaning as well. "The threefold division by time" means: first, the time of scripture; then, the time of reflecting on its meaning; and then, the time of applying oneself to cultivation — this is the division into three times. "Not found elsewhere" — not found in what other? In your teaching. It is only in the teaching of the Buddha that the wisdoms of the nature of hearing, reflection, and meditation are taught to exist; they are not found in others. Such is what this verse expresses.

Now the suffering that comes from not following the teaching is to be explained:

O sage, supreme among sages, in your teaching
that spreads so well in this way —
whoever shows no reverence:
what greater suffering could there be for them?

Regarding the words "that spreads so well in this way," and so forth — "in this way" summarizes what was gathered in the preceding verses on autonomy and the rest. "Spreading well" is said because the teaching is the cause of the assembly of benefits. That the teaching spreads well means it spreads definitively, well, and completely — and this is applied to your teaching. "Sage" (ṛṣi) means arhat. "Supreme among those sages" is a designation

meaning guide and chief. "The teaching" has already been explained. "Shows no reverence" means does not have faith. "Whoever" refers to whoever acts in pursuit of that object. "What" is an expression of what is possible. "Greater suffering" means extreme harm to one's own purpose. "From that" means from showing no reverence. The meaning to be explained is this: it is precisely by showing no reverence toward your teaching, which spreads so well, that those who hold views external to it suffer this great loss of their own highest purpose — not through anything else. This is an explanation in praise of the teaching.

This is the explanation called "Praise of the Teaching" — Chapter Eight.

Praise of the Aspiration: The Blessed One (the Buddha) previously made an aspiration:

May whatever is approached through seeing, hearing, remembering,
touching, or the words one utters
be of benefit to all beings in every way —
may it make them truly possessed of happiness.

The aspiration together with its fruit is now to be shown:

Hearing of you, joy arises.
Seeing you, faith comes to be.
Hearing your speech, one becomes glad,
and the teaching liberates completely.

Regarding the words "hearing of you, joy arises," and so forth — "hearing" means hearing, namely this melodious sound of the word "buddha." "Joy arising" means that from the mere hearing, aspiration toward what is seen is produced. For example, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, having heard for the first time the sound of the word "buddha," which he had not heard before, was glad, his hair stood on end, and he became drawn toward the teaching. Therefore, it is shown that the Blessed One's aspiration together with its fruit is this: by the mere hearing, one becomes such. As for "faith coming to be" — because his very nature was to satisfy impoverished beings and the like, faith arises — faith is produced. "Seeing" means making it direct perception. So it is stated that, by thus seeing, one is benefited.

"By the speech that teaches the Dharma, one becomes glad" — this means: he causes those who listen to produce joy. Thus, it is a sūtra statement that when a noble śrāvaka properly hears the Dharma, joy arises, the mind becomes

stirred, and one turns directly toward nirvāṇa. "He causes liberation" — that is, from the snares of mental afflictions. "By teaching" means by the noble path.

Furthermore:

Even when the Dharma is not taught,
Your son brings gladness.
By his growth, all living beings rejoice.
When you depart, you bestow benefit.
When you have gone, there is decline.
Your son brings gladness.

As for the phrase "your son brings gladness" — this is the expanded form. "Son" means one born from the womb. That this one causes gladness is because, through the announcement "a bodhisattva is born," Śakra (Indra) and the others are caused to rejoice. Or alternatively, "son" refers to one who has attained awakening, and likewise, because he brings ultimate happiness to its completion, this gladness arises — meaning that through the bodhisattva's having realized the deathless in a supreme way, Śakra and the others became glad. "Growth" refers to the many śrāvakas; that thereby "all living beings rejoice" means that he causes abundance among worldly beings. As the scripture says: "Monks, when new śrāvakas conduct themselves within their domain, it is for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many," and so forth, exactly as it was taught.

"Departure" means the departure of the Blessed One, and that "he bestows benefit" means he performs every kind of benefit. It is scripture that says: when the Blessed One departed for the villages within his domain, high ground became low, low ground became high, the blind gained sight, the deaf gained hearing, and the mute gained speech.

"When you have gone" means when the Blessed One passed completely into nirvāṇa, and "there is decline" is because living beings' own welfare diminishes.

Furthermore:

By proclaiming, he strips away wrongdoing.
By remembering you, one becomes glad.
By seeking, intelligence is born.
By fully knowing, one is purified.
By proclaiming, he strips away wrongdoing.

Regarding "by proclaiming, he strips away wrongdoing" and what follows: "proclaiming" is praising one's qualities, and by that proclamation wrongdoing is stripped away — therefore it is called "he strips away wrongdoing." Since the Blessed One possesses such qualities, speaking of him is mentioned incidentally as a secondary point. "Drawing near to, and engaging in, such speech is shown to be beneficial" — this is what is seen.

"Remembering" refers to the recollection of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha. "You" means yourself. "Becomes glad" means he causes gladness. Thus it is a sūtra statement that a noble śrāvaka who recollects the aspects of the Tathāgata will quickly obtain the aim, quickly obtain the Dharma, and obtain the gladness that comes from being in union with the Tathāgata. In this way, the benefit of understanding and following the recollection is explained.

In all other contexts likewise, by making the connection in the appropriate way, one benefits beings, and this is to be applied to the Blessed One as well. "By seeking" means seeking the Teacher alone. Just as a renunciant named Pharva spoke to a brahmin of pure lineage in this way: a man going to an elephant forest, having entered that great forest and seen an elephant's footprint there, would think with certainty, "My, what a great elephant — whose footprint is this?" In just the same way: "Now, a person with a human form has no four feet,

The one in whom this is so is the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Gautama, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha — and so forth, as it is taught in the Sūtra of the Brahmin's Meeting.

In just the same way, through following and withdrawing in the manner of seeking, certainty about the Teacher alone is arrived at — this is what is called "full understanding." One does this in order to find faith through understanding. "Purification" means because the defilements of affliction are stripped away.

Furthermore:

Welcoming you brings splendor,
Relying on you brings supreme intelligence,
You render one free from fear by trusting in you,
And through attending upon you one comes to happiness.

"Welcoming you brings splendor" — this is the extensive meaning. It is called "bringing splendor" because it produces the excellence of gods and humans. "You" refers to you yourself. "Welcoming" means going into your presence. "Reliance" through the practice of drawing near and hearing the Dharma means that through understanding what is blameworthy and what is blameless, understanding is produced — this is what is meant by "generating wisdom." "Supreme" means endowed with distinction.

"Trusting in you through the practice of taking refuge in the Blessed One and the Dharma after hearing the Dharma" means reverence. "Rendering one free from fear" is because one transcends the fear of the lower destinies. As it is said in the verse: "Whoever goes for refuge to the buddha shall not go to the lower destinies." Going for refuge and thus entering the noble path is what is called "attending with reverence." By doing so one attends upon the Tathāgata in all respects, because thereby one accomplishes his teaching. "Coming to happiness through attending with reverence" — this happiness is happiness indeed. And here, happiness refers to what is intended as nirvāṇa, characterized by the total pacification of all suffering without exception, for it is said: "The supreme happiness is nirvāṇa." The manner of accomplishing that — one in whom that is present — is what is meant by "coming to happiness," and the intended meaning is that one is made to attain nirvāṇa.

Furthermore, just as something capable of bearing a sword can pacify the torment of those scorched by fire, so too: "You, who are tormented by wrongdoing — what is this great ocean that is your nature of abundant merit?" The reply is given:

Purified by the excellence of ethical discipline,
Serene through the excellence of meditative concentration,
Undisturbed through the excellence of wisdom —
You are the great ocean of merit.

Regarding "purified by the excellence of ethical discipline": ethical discipline has already been explained. The excellence thereof is its distinction. Being purified through that excellent ethical discipline — because it is free from the defilement of blameworthy conduct — it is like a great ocean free from impurity.

"Meditative concentration" is virtue — single-pointed mindfulness. The excellence thereof, by way of the distinction of serenity, is clarity; and because it is unstained by the mud of attachment and so forth, it is like a great ocean

free from turbidity.

"Wisdom" is the discernment of phenomena. Its excellence is its distinction. Because it remains unmoved by that, it is called undisturbed. This is the sūtra's phrase: "the Tathāgata's wisdom with its boundless individual illuminations" — like a great ocean that is undisturbed.

Thus, because of this agreement with the great ocean, "great ocean of merit" denotes the nature of merit itself; because merit is abundant, it is like a cart whose very nature is wood.

Furthermore:

Your form is a jewel worthy to behold,
Your excellent speech is a jewel worthy to be heard,
The Dharma is a jewel worthy to be practiced —
Therefore you are a mine of jewels.

Regarding the verse beginning "Your form is a jewel worthy to behold" — form refers to color and so forth. Among things worthy to behold, it is a jewel, because by virtue of the perfection of the major and minor marks and so forth, it is worthy of faith, and through that it brings benefit. "Worthy to be heard" means worthy of being listened to. It is a jewel among things worthy to be heard, because it is supremely precious; excellent speech brings benefit. Dharma is what is excellently spoken, and its meaning has already been explained. This includes the faculties (Skt. indriya), the powers (Skt. bala), the factors of awakening (Skt. bodhyaṅga), and so forth. That is a jewel worthy to be practiced — to practice the nature of the Dharma is to find a jewel, because it brings the greatest benefit. For this reason, "you are an excellent mine of jewels of qualities." Qualities refers to form and so forth, and you yourself are the source — the generative ground — of those very jewels. "You" means you yourself.

Furthermore:

You are an island for those swept away by the river,
A protector of the sin-natured — those who have done wrong —
A refuge from the terrors of existence that threaten,
And a guide for those who seek liberation.

Regarding the verse beginning "You are an island for those swept away by the river" — this is an elaboration. "You" is the Blessed One. The river refers to the afflictions (kleśa) and the secondary afflictions. "Swept away" means swept far

from the path of liberation: beings such as the Jāṭilas — the fire-worshipping ascetics — and others like Kāśyapa, who are utterly devoted to fire and cling to ethical conduct and austerity as supreme, are swept away by the river of such views; like an island swept around by a river, the Blessed One is an island, because he is established in nirvāṇa. "Protector" means one who acts as a protector. "Sin-natured" refers to those in whom the nature of sin is found in the mind — they are of a sin-natured character, having done evil. The protector of those of sin-natured character — namely, those who kill many hundreds and thousands of living beings by means of garlands of fingers and the like — is the one who teaches them the Dharma and thereby establishes them in arhathood, thus protecting those who would otherwise go to the lower realms. "Refuge" means that even by merely accepting refuge, when there is no one to teach the Dharma, those who are terrified by the terrors of existence — such as hell and the like — are protected from those terrors of existence. In this regard too, there is the account of understanding: certain sons of gods, knowing seven days hence they would be born in the womb of a sow, were overwhelmed with grief, and urged by Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) they took refuge in the Buddha, whereby they were turned back from birth in the animal realm and were reborn among the gods. "Those who seek liberation" means those who wish to free themselves from the prison of saṃsāra. "A guide" means their guide — you yourself are the path.

Furthermore:

Because your moral discipline is pure, you are the supreme vessel,
A fine field yielding abundant fruit,
And since you bring benefit to all living beings,
You are also the supreme friend.

Regarding the verse beginning "A fine field yielding abundant fruit" — this is an elaboration. The "supreme vessel" will be explained in connection with "all living beings." One in whom pure moral discipline is found — that is pure moral discipline as their very essence. By reason of that pure moral discipline, they are supremely worthy of being venerated, and so are the supreme vessel. "A fine field" means an excellent field. "Yielding abundant fruit" means what it says — bearing rich results. For even a gift of sand offered to you became the seed of the fruit of freedom from sorrow for the fierce king. "The supreme friend" means an excellent companion. "Since you bring benefit" means acting to bring benefit — teaching the path of liberation. "To all living beings" means to every embodied being. "You" means you yourself. Even those who have not

yet entered the Tathāgata's path are benefited by the Tathāgata, because teaching the Dharma to all is itself the act of bringing benefit to all. Furthermore:

You are a friend since you bring benefit,
Cherished at heart because you bring joy in company,
Singularly pleasing because you are at peace,
Possessing every virtue — you deserve all veneration.

Now follows the commentary on the verse "You are a friend to all living beings." "Since you bring benefit" means: having taken to heart the sufferings of saṃsāra, you attained the rank of buddhahood and then showed the path of liberation — that is the benefit you bring. "Because you bring joy in company" — among worldly beings, patience is known simply as bearing the harm done by others when conflict arises. But being endowed with the joy that comes from companionship means not only that there is joy in company; beyond that, patience is practiced toward all who do harm, and benefit is given to sentient beings as well — for one who abides in such ease, that is joy in companionship. For that very reason you are cherished at heart. The cherished object of the buddhas: because it is said to captivate the minds of people at all times, it is what is dear at heart. Being adorned with the major marks and so forth, you are singularly pleasing — worthy to behold; and because you are peaceful, beholding you is in harmony with seeing, like the orb of the moon. The essential quality of being utterly at peace is peacefulness — and that is the reason. "Every virtue" refers to having all the foregoing qualities as its cause. As for "possessing them, you deserve veneration" — the word "possessing" indicates a special manner of action, and "you deserve veneration" means you are worthy of homage, worthy of veneration by all living beings.

Furthermore:

Without wrongdoing you are pleasing to the mind,
Your body and speech being good, you bring delight,
Abundant in splendor because all aims are fulfilled —
You who are the excellent ground of every virtue are auspicious.

Commentary on the verse "Without wrongdoing you are pleasing to the mind." "Pleasing to the mind" means pleasing, excellent, good — it follows on "to all living beings." "Without wrongdoing" means you do not engage in bodily and other actions that are condemned by the noble ones. "Delight" means joy. "Body and speech being good" means they are pure: because you have

perfected the individual analytical knowledges and command of precise speech, your speech is good; and because you are adorned with the major marks and so forth, your body is good — meaning that both hearing and seeing are harmonious with beholding you. "Abundant in splendor" is explained as the cause of excellence. It is thus only in the Blessed One that splendor is abundant. As for "because all aims are fulfilled" — all aims, from which higher rebirth, liberation, and the like are achieved, are all aims being fulfilled; the essential quality of this is the fulfilment of all aims, and for that reason splendor is abundant. Alternatively, it is told that merely by gazing he beheld five hundred treasure hordes, and all other kings sent many gifts of sustenance for the sake of his father Śuddhodana's birth. Thus his father gave him the name "Accomplished in All Aims," and for that reason too splendor is abundant. "Auspicious, along with excellence" means auspicious — with the meaning of vanquishing wrongdoing. The reason? It is explained: because he has become the ground and support of all excellent virtues.

In this way, through all aspects and all occasions, along with the results of aspirational prayers — including seeing, hearing, and the like — the praise of the Blessed One's aspirational prayers has been set forth. This completes the exposition of the chapter entitled "Praise of Aspirational Prayers," the ninth chapter.

Now the praise of entry upon the path has seven divisions, and these are to be set forth in the course of the commentary. Regarding that, two verses beginning with "You urge toward the attainment of reward" are to be explained:

You urge toward the attainment of reward,
You cut off those who act as thieves,
You set straight those who are devious,
You encourage the sluggish to exert themselves,
You place the disciplined ones on the path,
You cultivate equanimity toward the wild and untamed.
Therefore, of the tamer of persons —

"The unexcelled supreme charioteer" — this phrase, "you urge toward the attainment of reward," is to be explained by way of "the unexcelled supreme charioteer."

For example, just as the supreme charioteer urges on horses that are stubbornly disinclined to take even a single step by striking them with his

whip, so too do you fully rouse those persons to be tamed who, through the power of laziness, remain in saṃsāra, by showing them the sufferings of saṃsāra and the qualities of nirvāṇa, and through the method of generating calm abiding — this is the meaning of "you set them upon the path leading to nirvāṇa."

Just as horses drawing a chariot that stray from the road onto another path are cut off with a rein by the charioteer, so too do you cut off those persons to be tamed who dwell on a bad path, with the rein of teaching the Dharma — this is understood as "you set them upon the good path."

Just as horses that move crookedly, veering off course, are set straight by the charioteer and placed upon the even road, so too do you straighten out those persons to be tamed who are endowed with deviousness and guile — this is understood as "you set them upon the straight path."

Just as a charioteer prods and urges on horses that go sluggishly, so too do you prod and urge on those who have little diligence by teaching diligence. Ānanda — for just as a charioteer, relying on diligence, sets the finest horses to the task of bearing a special burden along the road by placing them on the path, in just the same way do you place those persons to be tamed, such as Śāriputra (Skt. Śāriputra) and the rest, upon the path endowed with the distinguishing marks that serve the special purpose of those to be tamed. Likewise, it was at that command — to the noble Śāriputra, "Please attend to the assembly of people dwelling at Śrāvastī" — that the noble Śāriputra arranged in the Jeta Grove the non-Buddhists who were advancing toward him, and the assembly of people at Śrāvastī, in the matter of seeing the truth and so forth, as it has been told.

By a verse of this kind, together with the one preceding verse-line, we have the explanation of the first division: entry upon the noble path preceded by the generation of calm abiding.

Just as wild, untamed horses that are intractable are treated with equanimity by the charioteer, so too do you treat with equanimity those who are wild and untamed and have not taken up the seed of awakening — this means you do not set them upon the path. This is because the occasion for taming them has not yet arrived, not because you are without compassion.

Toward sentient beings endowed with the seed of liberation,
you bow in homage as their teacher,
and with loving care you free them

from the lower realms and from conditioned existence.

This verse explains the second division: that equanimity is maintained toward those without the seed for as long as that time has not yet come.

Furthermore:

You have affection for the wretched,
you delight in benefiting those who dwell in ease,
with compassion toward those who dwell in poverty,
you wish to bring benefit to all.

"You have affection for the wretched" — this is the expanded statement. "The wretched" refers to those whose roots of virtue have been cut and who engage in wrongful conduct: the meaning is that you are inclined toward drawing them away from that wrongful conduct.

"Those who dwell in ease" are those whose roots of virtue are growing; since they are endowed with good fortune, you delight in benefiting them. The word "benefit" here speaks of liberation, since that alone is the true essence. "Delight" means "wish" — its nature is delight in benefiting, which is to say the meaning is "striving to lead toward liberation." Thus: "Monks, reflect! Do not be heedless!"

"Those who dwell in poverty" means those who are impoverished with respect to view — those whose roots of virtue have been completely severed. "Compassion" is simply having benefit as its object of focus.

As for striving to lead out those who lack good fortune — that is not the intent here. "Wishing to benefit all" refers to wishing to benefit all of them, both those who are adversarial, such as Devadatta and the like, and those who are devoted, such as those who give food to the destitute and the like — with the aim that they may attain the higher realms and liberation. This classification of that kind explains the tripartite division: benefiting, not benefiting, and wishing to benefit all.

Furthermore:

You show loving-kindness even to enemies,
and render aid to those who have fallen.
With compassion for the cruel,
you are noble and utterly wondrous.

Regarding the verse "You show loving-kindness even to enemies," enemies are those who cause harm — Devadatta and the like. The Blessed One's loving-kindness even toward those enemies means thoroughly protecting them from suffering, out of compassion. Hence the scriptural passage: "The fever that had seized the god Devadatta, who was stricken by a burning fever, was dispelled by the blessing of the truth of the Blessed One." "Renders aid" means that the Blessed One came. This alludes to the teaching. "Those who have fallen" refers to the grounds for falling. One who has fallen is to be censured, because they act in ways contrary to worldly standards.

For example: a young man known as Supraṭiṣṭhita, who had been making his living by laundering rags in the city of Śrāvastī, was heard to have been ordained by the Blessed One after he came to him. The assembled people of Śrāvastī became greatly displeased with the teaching of the Buddha, saying, "He has even ordained such a base and wicked person." Then King Prasenajit went to the Jeta Grove in order to give rise to remorse. The noble Supraṭiṣṭhita was at that moment sitting on some flat rock, scrubbing his launderer's garments. The Blessed One, for his part, had shut the door of the upper story of his dwelling and entered into meditative absorption. Not recognizing the noble Supraṭiṣṭhita, the king said to him, "Noble one, please go and announce to the Blessed One that I am here." That noble one was an arhat possessed of miraculous power and the knowledge of others' minds; knowing the king's mind, he passed through the flat rock as a bird passes through water, and departed, and caused the Blessed One to rise from his meditative absorption. The king then entered within, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One, touching his head to the ground, and first asked, "Which monk is it who is possessed of such great miraculous power?" The Blessed One declared, "You came here in order to give rise to remorse." Hearing this, the king became exceedingly faithful and joyful. Then, in order to generate further faith in him, the Blessed One declared:

A physician, fully understanding
what speech is harsh and what is gentle,
gives a medicinal bath —
without examining the patient's lineage.

Likewise, fully understanding
whether one's stream is gentle or rough,
a buddha gives the medicine
to cleanse the afflictions — without regard to lineage.

"The cruel" refers to those such as Aṅgulimāla and Śrīgupta, who slaughter many living creatures. "Compassion" means being moved and guided by compassion for others. The expression "utterly wondrous" conveys that the Blessed One is beyond the grasp of ordinary understanding, because he transcends the ways of worldly beings — for a worldly person would not engage with adversaries and the like out of compassion and so forth. "Noble" simply means being an ārya. This verse explains the fourth division: wishing to benefit even enemies. Furthermore:

"If parents, in order to confer benefit, are regarded as teachers — how much more need be said, then, of you, who confer benefit even beyond that, and so become a teacher yourself."

The phrase "if parents, in order to confer benefit" is an elaboration. The word "parents" is connected with the word "teacher." The phrase "in order to confer benefit" refers to giving birth, raising, and so forth. The phrase "if they are regarded" is connected with the word "teacher." The phrase "how much more need be said" means: what need is there to say that this becomes so? "Teacher" means a teacher. "You" refers to you. "Conferring benefit even beyond that" means the meaning is this: since you bring about perfect and complete benefit by causing beings to reach the city of liberation, free from afflictions, this is said to be unsurpassable benefit. The explanation is as follows: parents are close and are therefore teachers because they confer benefit in a single lifetime; but since you, too, confer benefit even beyond that, it cannot be expressed that you are merely a teacher.

Furthermore:

Since you do not regard your own aims,
and have become like an enemy to yourself,
to those who dwell at the brink of the abyss
you have become like a fence.

Regarding the verse beginning "Since you do not regard your own aims": "one's own aim" means the roots of virtue and the like; "not regarding them" means being attached to wrongdoing. "And have become like an enemy to yourself" means having become like an adversary. To those who do not regard their own aims and have thus become like enemies to themselves, you are the Blessed One. "Those who dwell at the brink of the abyss" — the abyss is transmigration into lower states of existence, and the brink of that abyss is the wrongful karma that lies just ahead. To dwell there is the situation of those

such as Aṅgulimāla and Śrīgupta — whoever they may be — who stand at the very edge of the abyss and commit deeds leading to lower rebirths. "Having become like a fence for those" means: just as a fence standing visibly at the edge of an abyss has the power to hold back those who would fall, so too you have become like a fence for them in order to remove from them what is unfit.

Furthermore:

To administer medicine for both worlds,
and so that beings might transcend the world,
to this world that had become darkness
you made wisdom's light to shine.

The phrase "to administer medicine for both worlds" is an elaboration. The term "world" here denotes things that are associated with defilements. "Both worlds" means both of them: the form realm and the formless realm together with the meditative absorptions leading into them, as well as the worldly path. "To administer medicine to these" refers to the first administration of medicine to both worlds. If one asks: to whom did you administer medicine? — the answer to be understood is: to those in whom roots of virtue have fully ripened. Alternatively, because through the noble path the truths are seen and the danger of lower states of existence is transcended, medicine was administered to gods and humans. The phrase "you made wisdom's light to shine" will be explained presently. "So that beings might transcend the world" — transcending the world is what it is: transcending it through the transcendent path, because by means of that transcendent path one passes beyond even the peak of existence. "For that purpose" means: the path that transcends the world is the transcendent path, and the intention is that those who are endowed with good fortune enter upon it. The particle "and" abbreviates the phrase "you made wisdom's light to shine." If one asks whether this light of wisdom was brought about by others as well — the reply is stated in the verse: "to this world that had become darkness." Darkness is ignorance; and it is because the world is possessed of that very ignorance that those beings are a world become darkness. For example, you who became a bodhisattva made the aspiration, "May buddhas arise for the blind world," and you accomplished exactly that. In order to remove from those who had become that darkness whatever was contrary to what is truly so, making wisdom's light to shine upon them is what is being taught.

This is the meaning of the phrase "causing unsurpassed wisdom to be thoroughly understood." A verse such as this sets those whose wholesome roots have fully ripened upon the paths that transcend the world, and thus the subject of the sixth distinction is explained.

Having in this way set beings upon the worldly and world-transcending paths, the next verse reads:

In their engagement with objects,
the conduct of gods and humans differs,
yet through the shared enjoyment of Dharma
there is, for you, no distinction.

Regarding the words "the conduct of gods and humans differs," "differs" means "not being one and the same thing." "In their engagement" means "engaging with objects," and "conduct" simply means conduct. How exactly do they differ? Gods possess the enjoyment of consuming the nectar of the gods, and their conduct of coupling consists of pairing together, embracing, holding hands, laughing, and union through gaze. Humans, by contrast, possess the conduct of a coarser kind of enjoyment. In this way the conduct of enjoyment of gods and humans differs. As for the phrase "the enjoyment of Dharma," the enjoyment of Dharma consists in the seeing of truth, the peaceful and secluded dwelling-place, and so forth. That it is shared means that it is entirely equal. The meaning of "shared enjoyment of Dharma" derives from that equality. "You" refers to the Blessed One. "There is no distinction" means "having attained equality," and this is connected with engaging in and enjoying objects. In brief: because, through reliance upon you, the enjoyment of Dharma is equal, gods and humans come to possess the conduct of enjoying objects equally. This verse teaches that gods and humans are alike in entering the path, and this is the explanation of the sixth distinction.

How is it known that gods and humans are alike because the enjoyment of Dharma is shared? The reply is stated:

The Blessed One, through Dharmic teachings
free from the faults of birth, age, clan, region,
and time, has bestowed upon all of these
the merit of a medicine.

Regarding the words "birth, age, clan" and so forth: birth, age, clan, region, and time — subdivided by month — constitute the grouping. Each of these is paired with the absence of fault. Predominantly giving is a fault, meaning

giving in full measure — that in which complete giving is abundant is faultlessness, and this is connected with the phrase "he has assigned merit to the teachings." "Faultlessness" has the meaning of "not depending on distinctions." Freedom from fault with respect to birth means: just as those born among the gods are appointed the medicine of Dharma so that they may enter the teaching, so too are those born among humans. Freedom from fault with respect to age means: just as the elderly, so too children, youths, and those in the prime of life. Freedom from fault with respect to clan means: just as brahmins, so too the warrior class, the noble lineages, and the common people. Freedom from fault with respect to region means: just as those of the central lands, so too those of the border regions. Freedom from fault with respect to season means: just as when the water is calm and the sky clear, so too on the first day of the month. The word "and" carries the meaning of "because" — because it was bestowed upon all. "Bestowed merit" means "giving according to accurate distinctions." "Bestowed merit through the teachings" means "assigned benefit through the teachings." These are as has been explained. Without depending on distinctions, benefit has been bestowed upon all through the Dharma, and there is none whom he utterly abandons — just as those of the world

does not address the common people with a hidden meaning; it is not residual, nor is it something abandoned; to those for whom it is not Dharma, non-Dharma is not taught; and to them, observances too are not given.

For this reason, the meaning of the verse beginning "the distinction between gods and human beings" is fitting. Thus, even for those who have become human beings possessed of the enjoyment of the Dharma:

Your śrāvakas, free from craving,
Those who hold no wonder —
Even to these the gods press their palms together in homage,
And venerate them as though they were something supremely wondrous.

"Those who hold no wonder, yet are venerated as though they were something supremely wondrous" — this is the elaboration. "Wonder" means something marvellous. One in whom it is present is one who holds wonder. Those who hold no wonder are associated with śrāvakas. The phrase "as though they were something supremely wondrous" means just as if they were something supremely wondrous. As for the term "gods," this will be explained. Even those who have become human beings have come to possess such great miraculous

powers — it is by this that the gods come to be filled with wonder.

This scripture of the Sovereign of Sages (Skt. Muniīndra), being of the nature of established essence, not dependent on birth and so forth — it is because of this that wonder arose in them regarding the veneration paid to the śrāvakas. Such is the condensed meaning.

"Pays homage" means the gods — [meaning] "may we too become like this by following the śrāvakas." "Free from craving" means those śrāvakas who have accomplished their task and are free from aspiration — "venerating such ones" means serving them closely. Because the act of veneration is primary, and because the act of paying homage is not primary, the phrase "the śrāvakas free from craving" is stated — being connected with the act that is primary, this is the verb form; it is not the fifth case.

"Press their palms together" means joining the palms. As an example: a noble one who has been born into a low family, dwelling in certainty, is himself patching his cloth robe discarded in a dust-heap upon a flat stone, and seven hundred goddesses of the Brahma-class come down from the Brahma realm and, with reverence, attend and gaze upon him; and some among those goddesses recite this verse:

By seven hundred goddesses of the vast realm,
Coming down from the Brahma realm with reverence,
Seeing the limit of one born of Añjaśiva,
Who has reached the end of existence through certainty — we bow.

"Śrāvakas" means not only yourself — also the inexhaustible śrāvakas — such is the meaning of the particle "also."

These two verses together explain that those born to the noble path are honored from a place of distinction — this is the explanation of the seventh category.

Having thus comprehended and praised with a mind filled with wonder, what is stated is this:

How wondrous! The buddha who has arisen
As the very heart-essence of saṃsāra — how splendid!
Even that one has become
Something to be aspired to by humans and gods alike.

"How wondrous! The buddha who has arisen as the heart-essence of saṃsāra" — this is the elaboration. "How wondrous" means marvellous, and is

connected with "how splendid." Saṃsāra is the five appropriated aggregates. "Having become its heart-essence" is explained as the essential core: like the essence of butter, it is the heart-essence of that saṃsāra. By whom? It is stated: a buddha's arising does not need to be pointed out by another — he is called a buddha because he has shattered the sleep of not knowing by himself, like a person who has awakened. "His arising" is his birth. "His splendour" is the distinction of his light. Why is this so greatly wondrous? It is explained: as for "even that one" and what follows — "human being" means birth as a human, and it is wondrous precisely because it is a lower birth. "That one" refers to whoever has arisen as a buddha.

The gods are objects of aspiration for Śakra (Indra) and the rest — they have become the very thing aspired to. Thus Śakra's aspiration is expressed as follows: "Alas! May I pass away from this present abode, be born with the fortune of a human being, shave off hair and beard, and never again take rebirth in this existence" — up to that point, these are the words of the sūtra. This is the commentary explaining the praise of entering the path. This completes the commentary entitled "The Praise of Entering the Path" — the tenth chapter.

The Praise of the Ascetic Practices: this has four divisions — what the cause of the ascetic practices is; what the basis of the act of performing ascetic practices is; how this is not a matter of self-interest; and by what manner this is called the act of performing ascetic practices.

Concerning this, the two verses beginning with "Afflicted and losing the peace of meditative well-being" are now to be explained:

Afflicted and losing the peace of tranquil ease,
keeping company with evil persons,
enduring adverse conditions and crowds,
yet regarding faults as virtues,
exerting himself with unattached mind
for the sake of beings —
that Blessed One who is a buddha among buddhas,
whose nature is the nature of reality — he is wondrous.

What is meant by "affliction" is this: it points to the endurance of suffering. For it is indicated that he was afflicted by unbearable torment, brought to the verge of death by grave illness, and exhausted by teaching the Dharma to the fourfold assembly. "The peace of tranquil ease" is the bliss that arises from

meditative concentration. "Losing that" means having relinquished it entirely. "Keeping company with evil persons" refers to associating with the likes of Devadatta, Sunakṣatra, Kokālika, and Bharadvāja and others. "Adverse conditions" are things such as cold, wind, and heat. "Crowds" means being surrounded by disciples who lack the bliss of tranquil ease. Faults of this kind and more — including attaining nirvāṇa without remainder and even the attainment of sovereignty — are nevertheless regarded as virtues; this is the intended meaning of "regarding faults as virtues." "Exerting himself" means entering into action. Is this then for his own sake? No — it is explained: "for the sake of beings" is the cause of benefiting sentient beings. The particle "that" carries the sense of "by which" — it means by which cause of diligence he exerted himself. "He is wondrous" means: he is a perfectly and completely awakened buddha. But could it be that he exerted himself just as a worldly person exerts himself out of clinging to existence? It is explained: "with unattached mind" means with a mind free of craving, for craving has been uprooted at its very foundation. "He is wondrous" means he cannot be taken as an object — the intended sense is: "Because he is utterly extraordinary in worldly terms, those like us are incapable of fully comprehending him." "Blessed One" is a term of veneration. "Among buddhas" refers to among the Tathāgatas. "A buddha" here is an epithet, a form of address. "The nature of reality" is the natural character of Dharma — "great compassion" is the intended meaning. Thus these two verses, by explaining affliction and the rest as the cause of the ascetic practices of patience and endurance, namely great compassion, proceed to explain the bodily basis through which he personally gave himself over to affliction and mortification of the body:

Though the food was coarse, he accepted the offering,
at times he also practiced fasting,
he walked in the wake of the infirm,
and laid himself down in a harsh and difficult place.

Regarding the first verse and what follows: "coarse food" means ordinary food that has been soaked. "He accepted" will be explained as meaning "what you partook of." For example, it is recounted in the text called "The Brahmin King Who Guarded the City" that a brahmin king named Agnidatta invited the Blessed One as a guest for three months, and that from the brahmin's region a hidden adversary entered —

From those merchants who came along the northern road, he obtained horse fodder and offered it to the Blessed One — the phrase "the Blessed One

accepted it" is an expression of direct understanding. "At times he also practiced fasting" — for example, in the text called "To the Earth," the inhabitants of a brahmin village were seized by Māra, and not even a single alms-round could be found.

"He walked in the wake of the infirm" — for example, a brahmin merchant from Rājagṛha traveled to Śrāvastī in order to see the Blessed One. The Blessed One, seeing that the merchant was not yet endowed with a fully ripened mental continuum, walked back to Rājagṛha. The merchant also went to Rājagṛha. From Campā, the Blessed One traveled in the same way through six great cities including Vārāṇasī and Vaiśālī. Then, immediately upon seeing the Blessed One, the merchant attained the vision of truth.

"He laid himself down in a harsh and difficult place" — in this verse, "laid himself down" will be explained as referring to "you," the Blessed One. In its natural sense, the word is conditioned by the causative particle. The place is described as harsh and rough because cattle had trampled it, leaving dried mud clods churned up by their hooves, rough and uneven — and in such a place he laid himself down.

An account of this: There was a herdsman's daughter in a certain village district of Kauśāmbī. A wandering hermit who wished to take her by force was besieged by a crowd of her relatives and was sent off into the wilderness at the point of a blade. At nightfall the gates of the city were locked, and he remained outside. Seeing the city in the early dawn light, the hermit understood that he lacked the fortune to attain the vision of truth. The Blessed One, knowing this, approached the wilderness, and in that harsh and difficult place laid himself down on a grass mat. The cowherds then said to the hermit: "The very one whose going forth liberated you from the ogre has laid himself down in that rough place." Hearing this, without stopping to look back at the city in its early-morning glow, the hermit straightaway went to the Tathāgata, prostrated, and asked: "Blessed One, in the wind-stirred countryside, did you lay yourself down on a seat in that rough and difficult place?" The Blessed One replied: "Hermit, some worldly people lie down for the sake of comfort. I am different from them, for I am free of the torment of attachment, aversion, and delusion. One who is consumed by the torment of attachment and the rest will suffer even lying on a soft couch — suffering sends them to sleep." Thus, by teaching him the Dharma in this way, the householder who had been the hermit attained the vision of truth as it truly is.

Though you, O Protector, are supreme,
out of love for those to be trained
you changed your bodily comportment to roughness and hardship,
and also altered your speech and your manner of dress.

Regarding "you changed your bodily comportment to roughness and hardship": "bodily" here refers to that which is not venerable or honored. For example, just as the Blessed One was staying at the hermit's house, and when the hermit went outside, he came and said "Let the ascetic leave!" — and the Blessed One departed, because of being taken hold of by another. When told "Enter the monks' line!" the Blessed One entered, being free of arrogance and pride. Thus the account of his sharing in bodily comportment together with sentient beings is explained.

"He also altered his speech and his manner of dress" — abandoning the appearance of a buddha and adopting other appearances: for example, the appearance of one who beats a drum for a desired aim, or the appearance of an elderly potter, and so forth — exactly as described.

Having set aside noble speech, he taught the Dharma in the dialect of barbarians, so that those world-guardians who knew only such tongues could be reached — that is the meaning of the other dialect known as "dab phi dab phi." "Lying down in dependence on speech" means lying down with a support for speech. In this way, since he acted for the benefit of others, "Protector, you" is a form of address. "The trainable ones alone" means only those who are fit to be trained. "Loving-kindness toward them" means through great compassion — and it is for their sake that he showed loving-kindness to the trainable ones. Thus the cause of the deeds of hardship he undertook is here explained.

"Although having become the chief" refers to his having become the chief who enters the city of nirvāṇa — the nirvāṇa of peace, with no remainder of the aggregates. And not only did he perform such deeds of hardship as "he partook of ordinary cooked food," but further:

Though you, Protector, are sovereign
over your own being at every moment,
yet all beings, for their own ends,
herd you about just as they please,
as if you were a servant.

Here "being sovereign" means having autonomy. The meaning of "Protector, you" has already been explained. "At every moment" is a constant — and it is to be construed with "yet you were not." "As one's own being" — how is this to be explained with regard to his own body? It is said: in the phrase "like a servant," the word "like" indicates a simile, and the expression "fit for verbal honor" is glossed as "a servant," meaning under another's control. "All" means all living beings. "Yet" carries the sense of "because of." "As they please" means however they wish. "For their own ends" means for their own purposes. "To herd" means to surround — that is, in order to seek refuge. The explanation is this: just as a servant, being under another's control, is herded about however the master pleases for the master's own ends, so too are you herded about by all beings, however they please, for their own ends. Therefore:

You, Protector, have no sovereignty
over your own being at every moment;
by all beings, for their own ends,
you are herded about just as they please.

How is this to be understood? It is said:

Whatever and wherever any request is made of you,
you do not refuse;
there is not a single instance
of your transgressing your own virtuous practice.

"Whatever and wherever requests are made of you" is an expansive expression. "However they speak to you" means whether they are brahmins or the lowborn, poor or rich, happy or afflicted. "Whatever and wherever" indicates the sevenfold reasoning: in order to rescue beings from the lower realms, and in order to place them in the higher realms. "However they speak to you" means free of hesitation and reverence. "Being requested" means because of being asked. "Your own virtuous practice" means your own cultivation — namely, engaging in just those wholesome deeds appropriate to the situation, in order to remove others' torment. For example, for one oppressed by fear of going to hell, as was spoken later by a divine son in the scripture Beginning with Good Fortune: "With compassion look upon the rulers — have unwavering faith of mind in them." And so on — the same applies accordingly in other cases. Since the practice is singular in its consistency, it is called "virtuous practice," and "there is not a single instance of transgressing

it" means that it never has been transgressed. In this way, this passage explains his lack of autonomy.

Now the manner in which he undertook the deeds of hardship is to be explained:

Just as you exert yourself in benefiting
even those who harm you,
ordinary people do not exert themselves
in benefiting even those who help them.

"Exerting himself in benefiting" has already been explained. "Those who harm" means not only those inclined toward giving pure food and the like, but also those inclined to cause harm — such as Indra (Śakra) — and you, the Blessed One, served even them.

Just as you exert yourself in benefiting, ordinary people do not exert themselves in benefiting even those who benefit them.

As for "just as Devadatta" — he was a kinsman of the Blessed One who, in other lives, had made aspirations to cause harm and who consistently bestowed what was not beneficial. The Blessed One, by contrast, consistently acted for benefit. "Benefit" here means excellence of learning.

Furthermore, there is this verse:

You are the friend who bestows benefit
even upon the enemy who does harm,
and to one who constantly seeks faults
you seek only qualities.

In the phrase "you who bestow benefit even upon the enemy who does harm" and what follows: "harm" means causing injury. "The enemy who causes harm" refers to those groups of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) such as Pūraṇa and his like. "You who bestow benefit" means performing what is virtuous — that itself is friendship. "One who constantly seeks faults" is precisely one who perpetually seeks flaws. Those who constantly seek faults include the foremost of men and others, while "seeking only qualities" means being endowed with the pursuit of what is virtuous. This verse, through these aspects — exerting oneself in benefiting those who cause harm, seeking benefit for those who seek to undermine benefit, and seeking only qualities in those who seek faults — explains the undertaking of deeds of hardship.

Furthermore:

To the place full of poison
and armed assault where you were invited,
you went there with compassion,
and it became for you a place of nectar.

The fuller account of "to the place full of poison and armed assault where you were invited" is as follows. The householder Śrīguptrā, a devotee of the Nirgrantha sect, placed poisoned food in front of his house and, with the thought that if the Blessed One went inside, he would fall into the fire pit on the straw spread over it and die from the poisoned food, he invited him. The Blessed One, moved by compassion, came to that man's house surrounded by the assembly of the Saṅgha of monks. The moment he set his foot down, lotuses arose from the fire pit, and the food was freed from its poison, so the Blessed One and the noble assembly of the Saṅgha partook of it. Śrīgupta together with his wife came to faith; the Dharma was taught, and they came to see the truth — this belongs to the category of utterances expressing realization.

Based on that same event, the commentary explains the verse. In the phrase "to the place where you were invited" and what follows: "the place" refers to where Śrīgupta dwelled. "Invited" means he was requested under the pretense of offering alms. "Full of poison" means the invitation was extended along with poison. Similarly, it was extended with armed assault. "There" gives the reason, meaning: for the sake of Śrīgupta. "You went" means he came properly into the presence of the donor. How so, it is explained: "With compassion" means accompanied by compassionate mind. "It became a place of nectar" means it was transformed into nectar. "Nectar" here is the path leading to the attainment of nirvāṇa, for it is the cause of deathlessness. In that place, compassion manifested as the antidote to fire in the form of water, and nectar appeared as the antidote to poison — and so the phrase is to be read: "you went by means of the true path endowed with these." The word "went" is used because it is connected to both of those applications. This verse thus explains the undertaking of deeds of hardship by generating benefit even for those who are hostile, and doing so always.

Furthermore:

With patience toward those who speak harshly,
with loving-kindness toward those who revile;
toward those who speak falsehood, with truth —

you, with love, tamed those filled with hatred.

In the phrase "with patience toward those who speak harshly" —

In the phrase "with patience toward those who speak harshly" — one who speaks harshly is possessed of rough words, and such a person is tamed through patience. An example of one who speaks harshly is the brahmin Bhāradvāja, who, when the Blessed One was going for alms at Śrāvastī, spoke many harsh words to him and threw dust at his head — yet the dust fell back upon that very brahmin's own head without ever reaching the Blessed One. Thereupon the Blessed One spoke these verses:

One who is pure and without fault,
who wrongs a person in whom no wrong exists —
that evil turns back upon the very one who did it,
just as fine dust thrown against the wind falls back upon the head.

"Those who revile, possessed of the intention to cause harm, are tamed through welfare." The word "with" here also means "through patience." The expression "those who revile" is glossed by some as those who speak at great length. The word "well," it is explained, refers to ultimate virtue and nirvāṇa, meaning: "it is established." For that very reason, it is the noble path. Then, through welfare, those such as Śrīgarbha are tamed by seeing the truth, and also through patience.

Now, one might ask: if "those filled with hatred are tamed with loving-kindness" is the intended explanation, then since "those who are filled with hatred" are themselves the ones who revile — that is, hatred is their defining sense — saying so would constitute the fault of repetition, because what was stated before is merely repeated. But that is not so. Because the manner of undertaking deeds of hardship is being displayed, it is shown in one place that those filled with hatred are tamed through welfare and patience and the like, and in another place it is shown through loving-kindness and so forth in the context of deeds of hardship — and so to say otherwise in that context would be improper.

Some say: because the text reads "those filled with anger are tamed through welfare," that reading eliminates the fault of repetition entirely. "Those filled with anger" refers to those like Aṅgulimāla and others.

In the phrase "toward those who speak falsehood, with truth" — who are those who speak falsehood? They are the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) who speak falsehood in relation to the beauty of an ordained woman. You tamed them through truth, and the word "with" here also means "through patience." "Through loving-kindness" means through a mind of benefit. "Those filled with hatred" are those striving to kill — they are the servants dispatched by Māra. As scripture states, when they hurled arrows and short spears at the Blessed One, because these were joined to loving-kindness they became a rain of flowers. In this way, the deeds of hardship accomplished here are explained through the qualities of loving-kindness, welfare, and patience.

Furthermore:

The many natures of human beings,
habituated since beginningless time,
you turned back from the lower destinies
and completely transformed them in an instant.

In the phrase "habituated since beginningless time" and what follows — "habituated since beginningless time" means deeply ingrained; it is the state of having become habituated since time without beginning. "Many" means of many kinds. "Natures" refers to sentient beings characterized by attachment, aversion, and delusion. In the phrase "you turned back from the lower destinies" — "lower destinies" means bad migrations, and "turning back" means turning back from those lower destinies, by means of whatever turns them back. "In an instant" means in a very short time. "Completely transformed" means changed into something else.

One who had been engaged in the conduct of attachment became one whose faculties were subdued — as in the example of the noble Nanda, whose faculties were subdued. One who had been engaged in the conduct of aversion became one abiding in loving-kindness — as in the example of Aṅgulimāla. In this way, the deeds of hardship are explained here as turning back afflictions that had long taken hold, and doing so in a brief time. This completes the explanation of the praise of deeds of hardship. This is the eleventh chapter, the explanation of the praise of deeds of hardship.

Now the praise of wisdom is to be explained. In this context, "wise" carries the meaning of possessing wisdom and of being inclined toward it. In this regard, there is wisdom skilled in arising as birth after birth, wisdom skilled in generating satisfaction,

wisdom skilled in speech that carries meaning, wisdom skilled in presenting things in gradual stages, and wisdom skilled in the methods of exposition — this is what "endowed with cause" signifies, and so there are five divisions.

For what reason? The verse runs:

Those who were rough, and those who were made gentle,
and those who were frightened — by the power of generosity
and by being made fierce with certainty:
that is your skillful means.

As for the expression "made gentle in their own nature," gentleness of nature means gentleness — that is, being tamed. "Made" means having attained it. "Rough" means being wrathful. For example, just as the Blessed One (the Buddha) tamed a householder who had become fierce and violent and rendered him gentle in nature, so too it was with King Ajātaśatru and others like him.

"Those who were frightened" means those who were miserly. The word translated here as "condensed" refers to gathered or contracted meaning. "By the power of generosity" means by making them give. For example, there was a householder named Vīra who was so miserly he would not give even to beggars. When the Blessed One taught him the Dharma of generosity, the householder thought: "Even one act of generosity is difficult for me — how much more, then, five great gifts?" The Blessed One, knowing the thought arising in Vīra's mind, spoke this verse:

Generosity and conflict are equally described;
those qualities do not reside in the wretched.
The very moment of battle is the very moment of giving —
for when their causes are gathered they become alike.

Upon hearing these words, great faith arose in him. He offered many fine garments to the Blessed One and, by listening to the Dharma and beholding the truth, then went forth into homelessness and became an arhat.

"Fierce" means being endowed with deceitfulness and guile. "Made him gentle in his stream" means having calmed his mental continuum. "That" is to be construed together with "made." "Skillful means" carries the meaning of being skilled in application.

Furthermore:

That the beloved Ānanda quieted his sense faculties,
that swollen arrogance was caused to bow down,
and that the garland of fingers was also pacified —
who would not be filled with wonder?

Regarding the expression "quieted his sense faculties": the sense faculties are the eye and so forth; quieting them means not engaging them with objects of attachment and the rest. The "beloved one" here is the Blessed One's own brother Ānanda, who was dominated by attachment. By the Blessed One's taming him, he became foremost among those who had disciplined their faculties. The phrase "who would not be filled with wonder?" applies to all of these examples.

"Swollen arrogance" refers to a person so intensely arrogant that he would not pay homage even to his own father and mother. The Blessed One caused him to go forth and established him among the arhats, so that he came to bow down properly to those who were noble or elder by birth, and to elder monastics.

As for the garland of fingers, that refers to the one who possessed such a garland — Aṅgulimāla himself. He it was who, by stringing together the fingers of human beings he had slaughtered, was killing thousands of living creatures, yet was tamed by the Blessed One. That the garland of fingers was pacified — who would not be filled with wonder at that? The meaning intended is: all beings, whether they have faith in the Buddha's teaching or do not have faith, were filled with wonder.

Thus the two verses beginning with "having become one of the lineage of the coarse and so forth, and one of the lineage of the gentle and so forth" explain that the Blessed One is skilled in births.

Furthermore:

Satisfied by the taste of your Dharma,
they forsake their beds of gold
and lie at ease on grass-strewn resting places,
those who are steadfast, resting blissfully.

The line "on grass-strewn resting places" is an elaboration. "Many" refers to embodied beings, and it connects with "grass-strewn resting places." Regarding the phrase "made of gold," gold is explained simply as gold, and a bed made of gold means a bed adorned with gold — that is the meaning of

that expression. "They lie" means to sleep. "Blissfully" is used because there is no burning torment of attachment and the like. "Those who are steadfast" refers to those endowed with wisdom, because they have generated the noble path.

In this way, such persons as Bhadraka, Kāśyapa, Nandika, Ānanda, and the Licchavi rice-dealer, having abandoned pride and gone forth into renunciation under the Blessed One's teaching, became arhats. How is it that they lie blissfully on grass-strewn resting places? It is because of the line "satisfied by the taste of your Dharma." The taste of the meaning of Dharma is the taste of Dharma, because it produces satisfaction in noble ones through the noble path that attains nirvāṇa and the ultimate. Becoming satisfied by it — the word meaning satisfaction takes the verb form in its sixth position. "Your" means yours. Many such as Bhadraka, being satisfied by the taste of Dharma, lie blissfully — as the verse says:

With a mind that has attained peace,
one lies at ease, calmed by inner stillness.

In the same way, the Blessed One's skill in producing satisfaction is explained here. Furthermore:

Knowing the right time and the intention,
sometimes when asked you do not speak,
yet to others, when elaboration has arisen,
you go to them directly and give the teaching.

The line "sometimes when asked you do not speak" refers to the case of a young man of compatible lineage who had gone forth and asked the Blessed One "Gautama, does the self exist?" — and though he asked the Blessed One, the Blessed One did not reply. Why? This will be explained by the words "knowing the right time and the intention." In this context, "the time" means that thinking "the ripening of this youth's intention is not yet complete — he does not yet possess the capacity to receive the teaching of no-self," the Blessed One remained silent. The phrase "going to them directly" refers to the Blessed One teaching the Dharma even without being asked. For example, while dwelling in the potter's house at the son of Nanda's invitation, the Blessed One went directly to the monk Padma who was following behind, and from the outset taught him the Dharma beginning with what is virtuous. This is because the Blessed One fully knew the intention of the one following in Padma's footsteps at that moment. "When elaboration has arisen" means after

having generated in him a sense of urgency. "To others" is for the purpose of training others. The case where the Blessed One spoke when asked by Kāśyapa means only that the Blessed One responded to him saying "the time has not yet come to resolve your question." Then later, when Kāśyapa asked again and asked many times, the Blessed One aroused his enthusiasm and at another time, recognizing through his insight that the intention had fully ripened, gave him an answer to what he had asked. Having heard it, he came to see the truth at a later time — such is the meaning of the sūtra. Regarding the phrase "knowing the right time and the intention," the right time and the intention refer to their ripening, and knowing that is what is meant by "knowing the right time and the intention." It is thus you who know the right time and the intention.

Therefore, in this context, one is said to be skilled in teaching with meaningful purpose. Furthermore:

Like dye upon a spotless cloth,
first with talk of giving and the rest,
he stirred enthusiasm in their minds,
and only later taught the Dharma.

In the verse "first with talk of giving and the rest," the word "first" means "at the outset." In the phrase "with talk of giving and the rest," the word "rest" should be understood to include talk of moral discipline and so forth. "Enthusiasm in the mind" means the mind becoming workable — that is, possessing the capacity to fully comprehend the meaning through the teaching of the noble truths. "Later" refers to the subsequent time. "Dharma" is understood to mean the noble path. "Spotless cloth" refers to that which is free of stains — the cloth that has them not. "Dye" refers to the Dharma. "Like" indicates an analogy. Just as a skilled dyer, having first cleansed the cloth of its stains with powder and the like, then dyes it with color — in exactly that way, you stirred enthusiasm in the mind through talk of generosity and the rest, and, being skilled in graduated teaching, taught the Dharma. This is the complete meaning.

Similarly, a sūtra states: "The Buddha, the Blessed One, would give a Dharma talk at the outset — for example, a talk on generosity, a talk on moral discipline, a talk on the higher realms, and so on up to that point. Just as a clean cloth that is free of stains, when dyed, takes the color perfectly — in the same way, a brahmin woman suited to her position and rank, remaining in that

seat, directly confronted the Four Noble Truths," namely suffering, the origin of suffering, cessation, and the path. Therefore, in this context, one is said to be skilled in teaching in a graduated manner.

Because that is how he acted, therefore:

From the unbearable depths of saṃsāra,
to lead beings from their afflictions —
no method, no conduct was left unsought
by you in that effort.

This verse is an elaboration. "Method" means endeavor. If one asks whether it is impossible to act with method to guide those who are without the good fortune to receive it, the reply is: "conduct" — the particle "and" carries the sense of conjunction. "That method which is not practiced" means one does not lack it. "That for which the mind is not sought" means there was no effort you did not undertake. The meaning is this: you diligently sought out all methods and all conduct.

Why so? "From the unbearable depths of saṃsāra" and what follows: saṃsāra is unbearable because of dependence on aging, sickness, and death. Because it has existed since beginningless time, it is deep and its depths are vast. "To lead from it" means to guide beings to nirvāṇa. "Beings" refers to all worldly beings. Even though beings are not turned back from saṃsāra as the very nature of the five aggregates, still, since the commentator wishes to explain a distinction, the statement "to lead beings from saṃsāra" is established as an explanation — in the manner one might say, "In this forest there are kiṃśuka and pālāśa trees."

How does one know that you made effort for all? The answer is given:

With your body's many forms of appearance,
with speech in the very language of each,
with differing intentions toward those to be trained —
this you accomplished, here and there for each.

In "body's many forms of appearance," the word "many" means very numerous, and "forms of body" means manifold divisions. "Speech" is through speech. "Accomplished" means "it will be explained" — the meaning is "it was spoken." "The forms of appearance" are connected with "having assumed different forms of appearance" — and "accomplished" carries the meaning of "having done so." "Intentions of those to be trained" are their dispositions.

"Differing" refers to attachment, aversion, and so forth. "For those" — that is, by means of the causes arising from those differing intentions of the ones to be trained.

Now, in the city of Śrāvastī, your speech takes many forms — for example, addressing those such as one called Dabhe Dabhe with noble speech suited to the differing intentions of the world-protectors, and addressing others differently with noble speech. The forms of appearance too are made manifold. Knowing that a certain Dribe, a perfumer, was proud and thought himself clever, the Blessed One appeared in the guise of a musician's attire. And knowing that another — a certain potter — was proud because some clay vessels he had just taken off the wheel dried and cracked, and he had thought, "There is no master craftsman of pottery equal to me," the Blessed One, perceiving that intention, appeared in the guise of a potter and, working from the wheel alone, demonstrated his skill. Then again, resuming the appearance of a buddha, he trained that one and freed him from pride. This is what is meant.

"But is it not the case that some condemn such ordinary speech and other such appearances?" one might ask.

The reply is given in verse:

All these are pure, non-contradictory,
worthy of veneration, and splendid —
for gods and human beings alike,
they are, without exception, healing medicine and worthy of honor.

The phrase "pure and non-contradictory" and so forth: they are pure because they do not give rise to the roots of non-virtue. They are non-contradictory because they are engaged in for the benefit of others. They are worthy of veneration because they provide healing medicine to others — the meaning being "worthy of highest praise." They are endowed with splendor because they pierce through the cataract of ignorance. "All" refers to the many forms of appearance of body and the many forms of speech. "Providing healing medicine to gods and human beings" means working for their benefit, since it causes them to see the truth. "Without exception" means they are worthy of reverence by gods and human beings alike. The phrase "at the present time" is to be connected with the sixth verbal form.

"How does one come to know that these qualities — purity and so forth — are present?" one might ask.

The reply is given in verse:

For most, what is spoken and done
does not, alas, remain free from stain.
But in you, who speak truthfully,
these two are known to be otherwise.

"What is spoken and done" means in elaboration. The particle "and" carries the sense of "because." Because for the most part, even what is spoken well is not free from stain — for the majority, speaking well is also not free from stain. Furthermore, when worldly people act well or speak well, in your case, "otherwise" — that is, through the many forms of appearance, the many forms of speech, and so forth, through the connection already explained — it is known to be distinct. The phrase "who speaks truthfully" refers to the absence of any erroneous concealment. "Is known to be" means is so. "These two" refers to what was explained before — namely, for the most part, doing and speaking. Therefore, "the many forms of bodily appearance" have already been explained well.

By means of such verses, the establishment of pure body and speech, along with their causes, is explained — that is, the skill in leading beings with skillful means together with their causes.

And beyond that, the skill in leading sentient beings even without any deliberate activity is to be explained:

Solely by your own pure self,
you have made the field of glory for all beings.
None such as this, in such a manner,
exists within the three worlds.
In the pitiable state of beginningless existence,
long since fallen into a single ruin —
for all sentient beings, as medicine,
you have striven in just this way.

These are two verses. Because there is no deliberate activity, "solely by your own self" refers to the purity of mind — the certainty that he is simply himself, pure, because he has abandoned, without remainder, the defilements of afflictions together with their habitual tendencies. The word "solely" indicates this certainty. "Made the field of glory" means made into a field of purification, because he places beings on the path to the higher realms. The defining

characteristics of "beings" have already been explained.

The word "striven" is connected with the cause for the sake of existence. One might ask: how is this so? The answer is given in the passage beginning "in just this manner, of just this kind" and so forth. "In just this manner" means being of just this kind — free of all faults and endowed with all good qualities — as has already been explained. "Field" here is the place where the fruit of higher rebirth and liberation is obtained. "The three pure worlds" means within the three pure realms. "Is present" is connected with "is not present." It is therefore by offering praise and paying homage that he has made it a field of glory for wandering beings.

Regarding the passage beginning "In beginningless existence, pitiable" and so forth: the word "beginningless" is an accepted particle of assertion. "Utterly fallen" means that one's stream of being is tormented by birth, aging, illness, death, and the like. Because birth has no beginning, existence in saṃsāra is pitiable beginningless. "Existence" is saṃsāra itself, and it is pitiable precisely because it is characterized by birth, aging, illness, and death. "As medicine" means for the sake of abandoning all suffering. "For all sentient beings" refers to those embodied beings who have not discerned the distinction. Through the deportment and speech and so forth already described, you, the Blessed One, have thoroughly entered into this. Therefore one speaks of you as "expert in the supremely direct means" — and this is the explanation offered in praise of the expert. This is the commentary praising the expert, the twelfth chapter.

Now the explanation of the praise for freedom from debt is to be given. Debt is something that must be discharged; because that discharge is accomplished, there is freedom from debt — and its very nature is freedom from debt. In this connection, freedom from debt toward sentient beings is to be explained under three headings: because of the victory over Māra, because of the establishment in the sacred Dharma, and because of the differentiation of the form bodies. To begin, the introductory topic of this section is to be explained:

I do not think that any repayment of the debt of gratitude to you can be found.
And even those persons who have passed into nirvāṇa
have not repaid what they owe.

Those who abide in your Dharma
do only their own benefit —

so for those who have grown weary on that account,
what repayment of the debt could there be?

"Found" means accomplished. "I do not think it can be found" means "I do not see it" — such is the statement of the learned one in praise. "How it would be accomplished" is indicated by the word "found." "Gratitude" is intended in the sense of benefit. One might then ask: is not one who has attained nirvāṇa by maintaining the Sugata's word thereby repaying the kindness of the Blessed One? The answer is given in the passage: "And even those persons who have passed into nirvāṇa" and so forth. The particle "even" indicates the greatness of the very persons in question. "Those persons" refers to Śāriputra and the like. "Those who have passed into nirvāṇa" means those who have exhausted afflictions and rebirth. "They too have not repaid" means that they remain in debt because the debt has not been repaid. Why is this so? The answer is given in the passage: "Those who abide in your Dharma" and so forth — even those who abide in your teaching, that is, in the doctrine you have taught, exhaust only their own afflictions and do not in the same way bring about the benefit of others. "Those who have grown weary" are those exhausted by teaching the Dharma and so forth. "On account of that" means for the sake of those who are to be tamed. "What repayment of the debt could there be?" means: what could be repaid? — and the intention is that there is no repayment. Thus, first, how do you in turn act as medicine toward those from whom no repayment comes? The answer is given:

You, looking upon the stream of being
of sentient beings who are asleep,
are the good friend of those who have become heedless,
one who is vigilant.

"You look upon the stream of being of sentient beings who are asleep" is the full statement. "You" refers to the Blessed One. "For the reason that" is the sense of the particle "since."

"Vigilant" means one who has awakened from the sleep of ignorance and who strives to accomplish benefit for others — that is the meaning of the term. "Sentient beings who are asleep" will now be explained. Sentient beings are asleep because the sleep of stupor has sealed off the eye of wisdom. "Stream of being" is to be construed with the phrase "of sentient beings." "Looking upon" means the vigilance of one who regards each being individually. The elaborated meaning of "as things truly are" is this: three times by day and three times by night, the buddha surveys with his buddha-eye — seeing what is declining, what is growing, and what is afflicted and beset by the harm of mental afflictions — with the thought, "I shall free from whatever harm is beset

by wretched suffering." This is the full expanded meaning of how the Blessed One looks upon the world with the buddha-eye. "Heedful" means not having passed beyond the moment when the roots of virtue are fully ripe for maturation. "Those sentient beings who are heedless" means those who do not abide in virtue. For that reason the meaning of the phrase "you are a good friend, that is, a supremely healing companion" is: because you are a good friend, you are a companion — the meaning being "supremely healing." And he is also medicine in yet another sense, which is why the following two verses are now explained:

You have taught the destruction of the afflictions,
and revealed the deceits of Māra.
You have proclaimed the unbearable nature of cyclic existence,
and also shown the direction of fearlessness.
With compassionate intention for the benefit of beings,
what you have done for sentient beings —
whatever that may be which you alone have done,
what other protector could there possibly be?

The afflictions are attachment and so forth. "Destruction" is taught as their antidote. As the sūtra says: "O monks, the great disagreeable medicine for the great sickness of attachment — or alternatively, the contemplation of the disagreeable — and for aversion, loving-kindness — or alternatively, the cultivation of loving-kindness. O monks, for the great sickness of delusion, the great medicine is the individual investigation of dependent origination — or alternatively, the cultivation of the individual investigation of dependent origination." This is the wording of the sūtra. Alternatively, the antidote for all afflictions, each according to its kind, is taught as the path of seeing and the path of cultivation. Having thus explained the conquest over the māra of the afflictions, the words "you revealed the deceits of Māra" teach the deceits of the māra who is the son of the gods — and thereby what it means to owe no debt is explained. The deceits of Māra are the gathering of pleasant and unpleasant objects — showing them is the meaning of "you made them known." As it is taught in the sūtra: "O monks, here is Māra watching for an opportunity, seeking an opportunity, advancing upon that opportunity — so that what is seen by the eye: beautiful forms, joyful, pleasing, desirable, and enticing when gazed upon with desire, draws one forward; likewise sounds known by the ear, smells known by the nose, tastes known by the tongue, tangible things known by the body, and phenomena known by the mind —

these six, ever-present, lead one close in. Therefore one must guard oneself thoroughly with a mind of mindfulness and vigilance. When seeing such a form, one must not generate mental pleasure or mental displeasure, but should abide in equanimity by means of vigilance" — and so forth. For example, the elder Legs-sad, a meditator who possessed great fearfulness, was visited by Māra, and being frightened by him, reported this very occurrence to the Blessed One. The Blessed One declared: "That wicked Māra has gone away — meditate in absorption without anxiety." Once again he went into the forest and sat in meditation, and again that Māra came to him. The elder then spoke these verses:

Just as one who is enticed by forms of desire —

You cannot deceive me.

Having seen through your deceit,
you are diminished in my sight.

Thus he demonstrated the deceits of Māra. As for "the unbearable account of saṃsāra's nature" — this is the source of everything that is devoid of meaning. The words of the sūtra are these: "O monks, in saṃsāra, which has no beginning and no end, for a very long time you have undergone unbearable, joyous, and disagreeable suffering; you have taken up a blood-drop in a mother's womb; you have fallen many times into the hells, many times among the animals, many times among the hungry ghosts — many times you have fallen into the lower destinies." As for "the fearless direction, unsullied by saṃsāra's faults" — this is nirvāṇa, for the sūtra declares "the peaceful nirvāṇa." As for "pointed out" — it means "indicated." It connects with the phrase "what else did he not do for others?" As for "the remainderless" — this is the intended meaning. As for "with intent for benefit" — whoever possesses the intent for benefit, that one has intent for benefit; the meaning intended is that the intent is for the benefit of others. As for "the compassionate one" — it means one who acts with compassion. As for "I would do" — it means "I would do." As for "what was not done that he would have done" — this means that he did it; the meaning is "he performed every act of benefit for others."

Now, if one objects: "Since the Blessed One is skilled in boundless virtue, how is it that he did not act with intent for benefit toward non-virtuous ones like Devadatta, or toward ones of little virtue such as ourselves, by giving them his own virtue?" — it is for this reason that the master spoke the two verses beginning with "If these Dharmas could be transferred."

If these Dharmas — powers, fearlessnesses, and the rest — could be transferred to another's continuum, then, without question, you would have bestowed them upon all, drawing on Devadatta as the occasion; and as the Protector of beings, you would unmistakably have proclaimed to beings that here there is no other agent who causes one to wander in saṃsāra — rather, it is one's own karma alone that does this.

As for "if it could be transferred" — the word "if" is joined with the sense of that conditional. "Transfer to another's continuum" means to convey it into another's stream of being. "These Dharmas" are the powers, fearlessnesses, and so forth, as explained previously. "Without question" means certainly. "Devadatta" is one who causes great harm. "Drawing on" means having taken as the occasion. "Bestowed upon all" means having arranged it for everyone. Because transfer is not possible, therefore "the Protector of beings" and so forth — this is the reason. Because he acts beneficially in this way, calling him "the Protector of beings" is a form of address. He has unmistakably declared in this manner: "Here, in saṃsāra, there is no other agent — it is one's own karma alone that does this." "Unmistakably" means without doubt. "Beings" means all people of the world. "Proclaimed" means directly proclaimed with words; yet because transfer into another's continuum is not possible, it is the understanding of the meaning of the Dharmas. Why? Because here there is no mutual agent. Otherwise, you would certainly have been able to transfer your own Dharma to you all — this is the condensed meaning.

During the bodhisattva's stages, the Blessed One's healing of sentient beings was shown as a praise of the perfections. What his activity was, dwelling after having attained the rank of the Sugata, has been explained previously. Out of compassion for future sentient beings as well, the two verses beginning with "with compassion for the worlds" are explained thus:

With compassion for the worlds,
he taught the sacred Dharma upon the earth for a long time,
and raised up many excellent disciples
capable of benefiting the three worlds.
And the assembly of those directly to be trained —

"Down to Suvarṇavarṇa" means "having been tamed down to that point." The word "for a long time" is a connective in meaning. "Upon the earth" means the human world. "The sacred Dharma," being the scriptural teaching itself, is joined with the phrase "taught for a long time." He established it in one place

after another for a very long time, and because he declared, "My teaching, taken up by gods and humans alike, shall remain without decline for five thousand years."

"With compassion for the worlds" does not mean for his own sake, but because he intended to act as a healer for beings of the future. "Many excellent disciples" refers to those whom the Blessed One raised up, beginning with the great Elder Kauṇḍinya and the rest. How, then, did he raise them up? Because he cultivated the noble element within their very streams of being. Or alternatively, since the elements are not the intended meaning here, "raised up in great number" is to be understood in connection with "excellent disciples."

"With compassion for the worlds" is what caused him to remain steadfast in the teaching. Of what kind? Capable of benefiting the three worlds — that is, the three realms — where "benefiting" means: capable of conferring the characteristic of attaining higher rebirth and liberation.

Furthermore, regarding the line "And the assembly of those directly to be trained," the assembly of those directly tamed is just that — the assembly of those directly tamed. There are two kinds of taming: taming by śrāvakas and taming by a buddha. Among these, those tamed by the Blessed One himself constitute the assembly of those directly tamed. The assembly directly tamed by the Blessed One extends from the noble Kauṇḍinya (the first to know all) down to Suvarṇavarṇa. This Suvarṇavarṇa refers to one who had gone forth; at the very end, when the Blessed One passed into final nirvāṇa, he was established as an arhat. Those up to and including that one were directly tamed, and their taming placed them in the fruits of arhatship and so forth.

Now, "whatever remaining debt to sentient beings you may have" — the vajra meditative absorption consuming the reliquary body like sesame seeds — "whatever remaining debt you may have" implies by intent: there is not even the slightest remainder. "Of sentient beings" means "for the sake of sentient beings," and is joined to "whatever remaining debt you may have." Here, because sentient beings have been established in the sacred Dharma, the absence of debt is declared. The absence of debt is to be explained in terms of the division of the form body.

For the line "thus, by the vajra meditative absorption" and so forth is joined to "you have not cast it away in vain." Because the entire body, without remainder, was consumed into powder, the absorption alone is the vajra — it

is by that vajra. "Like sesame seeds" means: in the manner of a division into parts the size of sesame grains. "The reliquary body" refers to what arises from his own body. "Consuming" comes to mean "mingled with the activity of signs and causes."

By consuming the reliquary body, one demonstrates that the austerities were not cast away in vain — like an accountant showing the reckoning of a place. And finally:

Even at the end, you did not
cast your austerities away in vain.
The form body and these Dharmas
were enacted solely for the benefit of others.

"Not casting austerities away in vain" is the activity of benefiting others to the utmost. "Even at the end" means not only relying on aspirational prayers, but also in the period just before the time of final nirvāṇa. "Not casting away in vain" means that even at the time of final nirvāṇa, nothing was cast away in vain.

Therefore, at the time of final nirvāṇa, worldly people would make images from the relics, thinking, "Even though you have passed into final nirvāṇa, this will lead us to higher rebirths and liberation." It is a scriptural transmission that the Blessed One himself, through the power of meditative absorption, held the relics. Alternatively, having established the sacred Dharma and having taken up the relics, there is no debt incurred — it does not become a taking on of something owed — for, as was stated: "The form body and these Dharmas were enacted solely for the benefit of others." In that phrase, "benefit of others" means the needs and purposes of other beings. "Solely" expresses certainty and exclusivity. "Dharmas" means the sacred scriptures. "The form body" means the body itself.

And so it is said:

To this world so hard to trust,
you displayed the passing into nirvāṇa.
For that reason, you entrusted the dharmakāya entire
to the most excellent of your sons.

"Hard to trust" means lacking in faith. "To this" refers to the beings of Jambudvīpa. "Passing into nirvāṇa" means not merely a provisional occasion, but the final nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. "Displayed" means

shown — it connects with "you." The very words "the form body and these Dharmas were enacted solely for the benefit of others" are now to be explained: "For that reason, you entrusted it to the most excellent of your sons" is an elaboration. "That" is a proximate reference. "For that reason" carries the sense of "on account of which." "Sons" refers to the noble Ānanda, Kāśyapa, and others of that kind. "Entrusted" means having entrusted it — it means: "When I have passed into final nirvāṇa, Kāśyapa, you must carry out the work of the teaching." And having charged the monk Ānanda, saying, "When I have passed into final nirvāṇa, you must uphold the teaching," he then passed into final nirvāṇa. "Your dharmakāya" is the sacred scriptures — all of it, without exception, in the division of the twelve branches. And:

Having shattered the form body like sesame seeds,
you passed fully into nirvāṇa.

"Like sesame seeds" means that the form body was shattered in fragments no larger than sesame seeds, and you, O Blessed One, passed into final nirvāṇa — that is, you attained final nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. This explains once again what was stated earlier: "The form body and these Dharmas."

This completes the explanation of the praise entitled "Praise Without Debt," which is the thirteenth chapter, and which also presents the benefit brought about through the eightfold classification.

Now, wishing to gather up the praise in summary, the excellent causally endowed fruit of benefit is to be explained again:

How wondrous is the abiding, how wondrous the manner,
how wondrous the qualities, how wondrous the body —
in the Dharmas of the buddhas
there is nothing that does not inspire great amazement.

Abiding as a cause of benefiting others, even while having attained mastery over final nirvāṇa — that is what "abiding" means. "How wondrous" carries the meaning of "amazing." This expresses the excellent fulfillment of benefit to others. That abiding in the work of benefit is so because of being endowed with the intention of great compassion — and to explain this: "How wondrous the manner." "Manner" means conduct, which here has the sense of intention. This indicates the excellent fulfillment of the result. "How wondrous the body" — because it is adorned with the major marks (lakṣaṇas) and minor marks (anuvyañjanas). "How wondrous" — because it functions without obstruction.

"Qualities" refers to the powers, fearlessnesses, and so forth. This, too, indicates the excellent fulfillment of the result. Or alternatively, "how wondrous" — because they increased over three incalculable eons and are boundless. "Qualities" refers to the perfections and the like.

This indicates the excellent fulfillment of the cause. Therefore all of these are to be explained as wondrous. In the line "as for the qualities of a buddha," the particle "as for" carries the sense of commitment or assertion. The qualities of a buddha — fearlessness, great compassion, and so forth — are to be connected with the phrase "there are none." "Any" means some other quality among the qualities of a buddha. Therefore, one possessed of all wondrous qualities is described thus:

Bestowing benefit, beautiful to behold,
With the activity of the three bodies calmed,
Look upon those of unbearable ignorance
Who bear hostility toward you, free of anger's cause.

"Bestowing benefit, beautiful to behold" is the elaborated explanation. Whatever manner of bestowing benefit exists — from aspiration all the way through to complete nirvāṇa — that is "bestowing benefit," and it is to be connected with "you." Because adorned with the major marks, "beautiful to behold" is beautiful to behold. Because body and speech have abandoned afflictions together with their habitual tendencies — the afflictions that produce physical and verbal actions rooted in aversion — the activity of body and speech is calmed. As for those who are hostile toward you who are free of the cause of aversion — those hostile and malicious ones — this is to be explained by what follows: "look upon those of unbearable ignorance." The word "look upon" is a verbal suffix of the kind generated in worldly usage; it applies to an action that has become manifest and is engaged in with single-pointed focus. "Ignorance" means nescience. "Unbearable" means wrongful, improper. Therefore, to begin with, it is those of confused wisdom who are hostile — and for such a self possessed of wisdom, the benefit is this:

An ocean of merit, a precious treasury,
The source of qualities, the collection of Dharma —
Those sentient beings who bow down before you:
It is excellent to pay homage to them as well.

In the line "the source of qualities, the collection of Dharma," and so forth: "merit" is virtuous action, which, being like an ocean, is immeasurable.

"Precious" refers to the powers, fearlessnesses, and so forth; "treasury" is a treasury of jewels, because it is inexhaustible. "Dharma" refers to loving-kindness, compassion, and so forth — those qualities not shared in common with śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas; "collection of Dharma" is the collection of Dharma. Thus, through Maitreya himself, the one who has become the source of all qualities becomes a field of merit. "Whatever sentient beings" means living creatures. "Before you" is to be connected with "you." "Who bow down" means those who perform the act of bowing. "To them as well" refers to those sentient beings. "Excellent" means it is something excellent. What is that excellent thing? It is said: to pay homage — that paying homage to those living creatures is something supremely excellent — and thereby reverence toward the Teacher is indicated.

Now the praise that does not fully reach its object is to be explained:

O Protector, though your qualities exceed what I can measure,
I seek them with my own limited capacity,
And therefore, on account of the fear that is present,
It is as though a blade cuts into my heart.

In the line "O Protector, though your qualities exceed what I can measure," and so forth: "exceed" is what exceeds. "You" refers to you yourself. The qualities have been explained earlier. "Protector" is a term of address. "Limited capacity" means ability — it is to be understood as referring to the capacity of wisdom. The particle "though" introduces another meaning. "I seek" means "what there is in seeking." "My own" refers to the one who offers the praise. "Therefore" means from that cause.

As for the phrase "on account of the fear that is present" — it is connected with the phrases "unable to fathom the Tathāgata's qualities" and "the reason I seek with my meager capacity." Having incurred the fault of falling short of the Tathāgata's qualities and committed an offense against them, one therefore has fear — and so it is on account of that fear. As for the phrase "It is as though a blade cuts into my heart" — what must be understood as implicit is: "I do not offer praise because the one to be praised" — meaning, one does not offer the praise. The phrase "as though a blade" connects with "is present." It is not that one refrains from offering praise out of satisfaction with the Tathāgata's qualities; rather, and this is the brief summary, it is because one fears the absence of fear — that is, one is afraid of not having the right kind of fear.

If it is asked, "If the Tathāgata's qualities are immeasurable, who then is able to offer praise?" — the answer is given in the verse:

Your own essential nature
Has valid measure, yet is inconceivable.
That which cannot be taught, and is also beyond enumeration —
It is you yourself, I think, who know it.

As for "that which cannot be taught, and is also beyond enumeration" — this is the extensive elaboration. "Has valid measure" means it cannot be fully determined — because not even a single one of the powers of his qualities can be comprehended. Since it cannot be counted even by the numbers beginning with one, it is also beyond enumeration, for the qualities are without limit. Since it is not an object for any sentient being other than a buddha, it is inconceivable. "That which is taught" means an example, an illustration. "That which cannot be taught" means it is without example — that is the meaning. "Yourself" means by oneself. The word "self" carries a sense of certainty. "By yourself" means not by the foremost of the śrāvakas, and not by the pratyekabuddhas. The word "self" is a synonym for one's own name. For example, certain people in the world say: "I myself shall go to the village" — meaning by one's own self. As for "your own" — this refers to the essential nature of the dharmakāya and the essential nature of the form body. The word "you" conveys certainty. What certainty? Some people say this: that in other world-systems as well, buddhas — Blessed Ones — arose simultaneously with the son of the Śākyas, and that they extensively knew one another's qualities. In order to refute that view, the certainty expressed here is: it is you, the Blessed One Śākyamuni, yourself who knows your own essential nature — others cannot even touch the hem of it. This corresponds to the sūtra passage that says: it is impossible and there is no occasion for two Tathāgatas of the same period — a former and a later — to arise in the world at the same time. Therefore, you alone, through self-knowledge, are worthy of veneration — not the śrāvakas and the rest — for we are like maggots in filth, so what need is there even to speak of us?

And therefore, concerning you:

Though the waters of a great ocean have not been exhausted,
They still utterly calm the burning torment of beings.
Just so, though but a fraction of your qualities has not been proclaimed,
I abide with my heart supremely gladdened.

As for the phrase "but a fraction of your qualities" — a fraction of the qualities is a fraction, meaning the mere tip of a single hair of them, meaning something exceedingly small. That you, the Blessed One, have not proclaimed even that — means it has not been praised — so how much the less all the qualities? Likewise, "supremely" means in an exceptional way. "I" refers to oneself. "Gladdened" means delighted. "Abide in my heart" means present in the heart. To the objection, "How can one be gladdened when only a fraction of the qualities has not been proclaimed?" — the reply is given beginning with the phrase "though they have not been exhausted," and so forth. "Have not been exhausted" means have not been fully drawn upon. "The waters of a great ocean" refers to those waters. "They still utterly calm the burning torment of beings" — they become calmed, and the word "just so" gives the reason. Therefore, by praising even a fraction of the qualities of the Blessed One — whose great ocean of qualities is immeasurable —

I am supremely gladdened in my heart.

This is the summary. Now the dedication of the fruit of the praise is to be explained.

By the fruit arisen from this virtuous act,
born of the confidence that arose through faith in the Sage,
may the minds of beings, stirred and churned
by the red tempest-wind of evil thoughts,
come to rest in peace.

"By the fruit arisen from this pure act" — this is the extended form. "Fruit arisen" means "by the fruit that has come forth." "This" refers to what has come from the Praise in One Hundred and Fifty Verses. "Virtuous" refers to the virtuous action that is virtue in the essential nature of speech.

What sort of virtue is it? It is said: the phrase "faith in the Sage" and so on means that the confidence arising from faith in the Sage is wisdom, and what has arisen and come forth from that — that is "confidence arisen through faith in the Sage," and it is "by the fruit arisen from that virtuous act." "Evil thoughts" refers to attachment, ill-will, and the like. Because through these the mind is scattered among objects, they are "the red tempest-wind." Being stirred by that is "stirred and churned by the red tempest-wind of evil thoughts." "May the minds of beings come to rest in peace" — the intended meaning is: "may the minds of all persons come under their own dominion and thereby become arhats."

In this way, with the distinction of cause and fruit, this is the commentary on the Praise in One Hundred and Fifty Verses.

By explaining this praise of the Sugata (the Well-Gone One, an epithet of the Buddha),

whatever virtue I have thereby obtained —
may it serve to pacify the suffering of beings
and may they become Sugatas.

This completes the Commentary on the Praise Called "One Hundred and Fifty Verses," composed by the monk Prītiśrīghoṣa (Joyful and of Pleasing Voice). It was translated and revised by the Indian preceptor Śrī Śraddhākaravarman and the translator Śākya Lodrö, and was definitively established.

Translator's Notes

- The opening attribution names two individuals involved in the translation: "Ravamma" (འཕགས་པ་ལྷ་མོ་), an Indian paṇḍita whose name is somewhat obscure in transmission, and the Tibetan translator Śākya Lodrö. The text being introduced is a commentary on Candragomin's Śatapaṃcāśatikā-stotra, a hymn of one hundred and fifty verses in praise of the Buddha. "Phyogs glang po," literally "Directional Elephant," is the standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit name Candragomin, but as the text itself uses this epithet in an introductory verse rather than as a proper name in the commentary body, it is rendered here according to its documentary meaning; a note is warranted that this refers to the Indian scholar-poet Candragomin.
- The verse at the close renders a stanza that appears to be in an older or slightly irregular meter. The translation renders it as faithfully as possible to the grammatical and doctrinal sense; the phrase "summit upon summit, beyond all grade" reflects the Tibetan's image of qualities being completely undivided and at the absolute highest level, without degrees of lesser or greater.
- The closing verse "If one has a mind at all" is cited here as a pointer toward intelligent self-interest as the motivation for taking refuge — an argument that distinguishes purposeful rational beings from animals whose capacity for ethical discrimination is too limited for genuine refuge. This is a standard Indian commentarial move found in Mahāyāna treatise literature.
- The phrase rendered "beating him like a sugarcane stalk" (bu ram gyi shing dang 'dra bar brdungs pa) uses the comparison of sugarcane being crushed or beaten, which is a classical Indian simile for severe physical assault; the translation captures this.

The king referred to as "Ajātaśatru" is identified in the Tibetan as ma skyes dgra, literally "the Enemy-at-Birth," which is the standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit Ajātaśatru; the passage also glosses him parenthetically as Bimbisāra's son, which I have incorporated for clarity.

The passage about Pilinda's son (gnas brtan pi lind kyi bu) and his cursing or commanding the Gaṅgā is an allusion to the legend of Pilindavatsa, whose habitual tendency to address others as "outcaste" (vasala) even after arhatship is a classic illustration of residual habitual tendencies; this is precisely the doctrinal point being illustrated here, though the Tibetan text as given refers to the son of Pilinda rather than Pilinda himself — a possible transmission

variant worth noting.

- The passage is a scholastic commentary, likely from a śāstra tradition explaining a praise text about the Buddha's qualities. The verse quoted near the beginning appears to be attributed to or about Pilinda's son from the preceding passage, explaining that his cursing of the Gaṅgā was a residual habitual tendency from a brahmin past life.

The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in the Tibetan — it breaks off mid-construction at "and —" which is consistent with this being a passage-boundary cut; the original text continues beyond what was provided.

The grammatical analysis of the Sanskrit elements "tra," "tri," and "ni" in the middle section reflects the text's etymological reasoning about the term "protector" (Sanskrit: tāyin or trāṭṛ); the Tibetan is analyzing Sanskrit etymology via phonetic approximations.

- The story of Ciñcā (Sanskrit: Ciñcamāṇavikā) refers to a well-known incident in which a woman aligned with sectarian opponents falsely accused the Buddha of making her pregnant. The commentary here treats Ciñcā as a female ascetic and draws a structural parallel: the non-Buddhists' slander was exposed as self-generated and ultimately discredited.

The famous simile of the blind sea turtle and the floating yoke is canonical, appearing in the Saṃyutta Nikāya among other sources. The verse here compresses this image together with a reflection on the rarity of human birth, the impermanence of life, and the urgency of using the tongue to offer genuine praise rather than remain silent or engage in self-deception.

- The phrase rendered "suspected of an opening for karma" follows a complex commentarial gloss in which "opening" refers to the vulnerability created by non-virtuous karma co-present with the virtuous karma that produced the human birth. The translation tracks the commentary's own interpretation rather than the verse in isolation, as the text itself is commentary on a verse.

The simile of the crow and the tāla fruit is a traditional Indian image for near-impossibility, used here to intensify the turtle-and-yoke simile from the preceding passage.

- The final sentence "The explanation is this" renders a phrase that in the Tibetan closes with a colon-like connector indicating the commentary is about to continue; the passage breaks off here mid-explanation, and no further content was provided to translate.

- The phrase rendered "the syllable 'dam' is to be understood as 'conceptuality'" reflects a grammatical gloss on a Tibetan particle used in the root verse; the precise syntax of the original particle analysis is somewhat compressed but the general sense is clear in context.

The passage "this is a scriptural passage" translates lung, which here indicates the author is citing or referencing a canonical source to support the aspiration described; it may refer to a well-known passage from a sūtra rather than a direct quotation from within this same text.

- The bodhisattva name rendered "Crest-Jewel" corresponds to the Tibetan Nor bu gtsug can, a figure from Jātaka literature whose Sanskrit name is likely Ratnaśikhī or Ratnacūḍa; the exact Sanskrit is not established with certainty from this passage alone.

- The "King Śrī-dala" story and the "King Śivi and the dove" story are well-known Jātaka narratives. In the Śivi story the text describes the king weighing his own flesh on a scale to balance against the dove; this detail is rendered faithfully.

The half-verse quoted — "The purity I have attained is unsurpassable awakening" — appears to be cited as a familiar gāthā from another context; its incomplete quotation (described as "half a verse") is preserved as such in the translation.

- The phrase rendered "beings" in the final verse gloss — referring to vultures and flesh-eating creatures — reflects a specific narrative context in which the bodhisattva's body is offered and scavenged, a classical Jātaka-style scene. The text treats these creatures as pitiable precisely

because they act under the compulsion of afflictions; the compassion is directed at the afflictions driving them, not at condemning them. This reading is doctrinally standard in Mahāyāna patience literature and follows the logic of the Śāntideva tradition.

- The phrase rendered "not just once but many times" translates the verse opening literally meaning "not on just one occasion" and the closing commentary confirms it means "many times." The Jātaka reference to the six-tusked elephant alludes to the well-known story of the bodhisattva born as a six-tusked elephant whose tusks were cut off at the request of a jealous queen's hunter; this is cited in parallel with the tortoise Jātaka as examples of the third mode of patience. The young nāga with the white topknot and the episode of King Candraraja giving his head to the fierce brahmin are standard Jātaka references that appear in several Indian commentarial sources.

- The phrase rendered "the primordial wisdom of exhaustion and non-arising" (zad pa dang mi skye ba'i ye shes) is a technical Abhidharma and Mahāyāna term for the arhat's or buddha's final wisdom; in context it here characterizes the dharmakāya or the stream of the Tathāgata at full awakening. The commentator appears to gloss "perfect awakening" (rdzogs pa'i byang chub) in terms of this specific kind of wisdom, which is doctrinally significant.

- The phrase rendered "from root to top" translates a term meaning literally "from the beginning to the summit," carrying the sense that the bodhisattva's distinguished qualities are uninterrupted throughout their entire extent. The two dhyāna categories, "dhyāna of entering equipoise" and "dhyāna of establishing what is reasonable," correspond to standard Abhidharma classifications of samādhi by function; the precise technical referents of these two categories may vary by commentarial tradition.

- The passage contains a grammatical-philological digression about the reading of a particular Tibetan phrase, glossed against the possibility of a vowel-sandhi reading borrowed from Sanskrit (the ātaṃ citation). The author dismisses this and defends the Ācārya's reading, "thugs la bzhag pa" ("held in mind"), as a case of word-junction resembling, but distinct from, vowel transposition. The Sanskrit example given, durṇaya, supports this grammatical argument.

The story of the Blessed One exchanging his body for a verse of Dharma from Śakra disguised as a yakṣa is a well-known jātaka motif; the verse quoted here closely parallels versions found in several Indian sources.

- The Jātaka of Dematā is likely a specific birth-story (jātaka) featuring a character named Dematā; the exact story is not identified here but the reference is to canonical exemplary past lives. The phrase rendered "with diligence alone as your companion" involves a deliberate contrast with material supports such as elephants and horses, clarifying that the Blessed One's achievement rested solely on inner effort rather than external resources. The phrase "the far shore" for "pha mthar phyin" follows the literal image of crossing to the further bank, cognate with the meaning of pāramitā.

- The phrase rendered "you fashioned yourself supreme" translates a construction meaning literally "you caused yourself to be fully produced or created," carrying the sense of self-cultivation to full perfection — understood here as the Tathāgata's wisdom being fully realized and internalized. The commentary's gloss connects this to the tathāgata's gnosis being "assimilated" or "penetrated," which is the doctrinal sense preserved here.

- The repeated phrase rendered "accumulated and ever-accumulating" translates a doubled verb form used to convey intensification. The bird-grasping-fish image is cited as an analogy for this intensified, continuous accumulation; its precise source is not specified in the text.

The reference to Rāhu follows the classical Indic cosmological tradition in which solar and lunar eclipses are caused by the demon Rāhu swallowing the luminaries, here glossed simply as "a planetary demon."

- The phrase rendered "the place of the great waves" translates a somewhat compressed expression that in context likely refers to the Buddha's declaration of his supreme station or to the assembly in which he teaches; the exact referent is slightly ambiguous but the general sense of a supreme or majestic setting is clear. The northern continent Uttarakuru is implied by "the northern land of Uttarakuru" in the Tibetan circumlocution, and has been supplied for clarity. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, as the text continues beyond the provided excerpt.
- The grammatical gloss on "unmoved by all phenomena" references an Indic grammatical framework in which the text analyzes the instrumental construction as a sixth-case-type (genitive) relationship with the object of action. This is a scholastic commentary parsing the verse's syntax and need not detain a general listener; it is preserved faithfully but may sound technical in narration.

The passage about the goddess nun moving the earth alludes to a canonical account, likely from the Vinaya or a related source, of a bhikṣuṇī with great powers who, by perceiving the earth as small and water as vast, causes the earth to tremble. The exact source is not identified in this passage.

- The seventh lunar phase described as "the essence of the lunar division" and connected with "a gathering of persons" is a somewhat obscure astronomical and calendrical reference. The classical Indian autumn moon, particularly at the seventh day of the bright fortnight, was proverbially associated with clarity and coolness; the commentator appears to be citing a technical classification of lunar phases. The exact doctrinal or literary source for this specific enumeration is uncertain and has been rendered faithfully without smoothing.

The final verse presents a philosophical point that is developed in what follows: the text here distinguishes awakening from nirvāṇa as the referent of the "precious Dharma," which is a doctrinally significant move, likely reflecting a Mahāyāna commentary that treats full omniscient awakening as something beyond mere cessation.

- The verse attributed to Dignāga ("Yet that too and you are not the same...") is a citation from Dignāga's own hymn of praise; the ascription in the text is to Phyogs kyi glang po, the Tibetan rendering of Dignāga's name. The passage treats this citation as a gloss on why no analogy truly holds for the Blessed One.

The final verse's third and fourth lines ("that patience in a verse relying on a distinguished station holds no special wonder") are somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the sense is that patience shown in a context where one has the power to overcome adversaries easily is not especially marvellous. The translation follows the most natural reading.

- The phrase rendered "Kāśyapa the Perfector" renders ཀཤམ་པ་འཇཉག་པོ་, which likely refers to Uruvilvā-Kāśyapa, one of the three Kāśyapa brothers subdued by the Buddha's miracle at Uruvilvā. The epithet འཇཉག་པོ་ is unusual and its precise referent is not entirely certain; it may be a textual nickname or epithet for this figure.
- The phrase rendered "Kāśyapa the Perfector" follows the preceding passage's established rendering of this epithet and is maintained here for consistency. The final sentence breaks off mid-passage in the source, corresponding to an incomplete clause in the Tibetan; the translation renders what is present without supplying the missing continuation.
- The phrase rendered "attached to his cave" at the opening is a continuation of the Ānanda passage from the preceding segment; the cave-dwelling ascetic imagery refers to Ānanda's manner of practice. The exact referent of the sentence's grammatical subject shifts mid-paragraph as the commentary moves between describing Ānanda and then praising the buddha — this is characteristic of the commentarial style and has been smoothed in translation

without alteration of meaning.

- The phrase rendered "close placements of mindfulness" refers to the four applications of mindfulness (*smṛtyupasthāna*); the text specifies three, which may reflect a contextual grouping within the commentary being cited, not the standard fourfold schema.

The verse near the end breaks off mid-sentence in the source passage; the translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

- The story of King Rūpasāra and the painted image of the Buddha is a narrative found in Indian commentarial literature; the Sanskrit name Rūpasāra (Essence of Form) is reconstructed from the Tibetan རུ་པ་སྐལ་ཤར།. The identity of the "cliff-city" king (རི་གླིང་གི་རྒྱལ་པོ།) is not further specified in the passage. The term སྨན་བྲོ་འདུག་པོ། here rendered "nourishing condition" is a somewhat technical phrase; སྨན་བྲོ་འདུག་པོ། likely refers to a proximate material condition sustaining beauty, and the precise nuance is uncertain.
- The term rendered "Viṣṇu's power" translates the Tibetan name Khyab-'jug, the standard Tibetan equivalent of Viṣṇu (Skt. Viṣṇu), used here as a simile for supreme lordly excellence. The comparison is to the renowned might and magnificence of that deity, not to any doctrinal identification with him.

The phrase about the "uṣṇīṣa on the crown" renders gtsug tor, which technically refers to the cranial protrusion regarded as one of the thirty-two marks of a great being.

- The phrase rendered "long held in compassion's embrace" (yun ring thugs rjes bsdsams) literally means "bound / held firmly by compassion for a long time" — the image is of compassion as the force that keeps the Blessed One tethered to saṃsāra on behalf of beings rather than withdrawing into nirvāṇa. The translation preserves this nuance.
- The phrase rendered "as though an inconclusive sign-inference had been made regarding qualities" translates a dense logical idiom. The Tibetan reads "ma ning gi rtags kyi sbyor ba byas," literally "having made the application of an inconclusive sign." In classical Buddhist logic, a "ma ning" or "inconclusive" sign is one that fails to establish its thesis. The commentator's point is that without resolving the hesitation over which quality to praise first, the homage would remain logically indeterminate — hence the verse poses the question openly rather than asserting an answer. This is a specialized pramāṇa reference and the rendering in the body is necessarily somewhat free.

The verse line "glag shig thod nas bgyid par bas" is slightly elliptical; the rendering "seizing every occasion to act" follows the commentary's gloss that compassion acts upon finding its opportunity.

- The story of the gandharva king Atimuditā (Tib. shin tu dga' ba) and the Blessed One cutting the lute strings is a narrative illustration not easily traced to a single canonical source; this is a well-known story in Tibetan commentarial literature used to illustrate skillful compassion that appears harsh on the surface. The figure's name is given in the text as "shin tu dga' ba," meaning "Very Joyful One," rendered here as Atimuditā as its likely Sanskrit equivalent.

The final verse's phrase rendered "showing no tenderness toward your own support" is somewhat unusual. The Tibetan reads literally "without affection toward one's own basis/support," interpreted here as the Tathāgata treating his own body and personal circumstance without attachment or solicitude — an expression of selfless compassion. This is a contextually significant point worth noting.

- The torma offering context: a torma is a ritual cake offered to protective or wrathful spirits such as yakṣas. The image here is that the bodhisattva, like a torma, has been scattered in pieces across the four directions for the benefit of others — a striking self-sacrifice metaphor drawn from jātaka literature. The phrase "conduct of women" throughout reflects a

commentary that uses the analogy of a devoted woman's conduct as a figure for compassionate perseverance; the "excellent" versus "not excellent" conduct of women is a formal distinction within the text's argumentative structure, not a general gender judgment.

- The verse fragment at the very end of the Tibetan is left incomplete as it stands in the source text; the translation renders only what is present. The image of something "ablaze" and dwelling in darkness is a well-known passage from a sūtra on the perils of saṃsāra, possibly echoing Pāli parallels, but the text breaks off here.

- The story of Devadatta and the name Ambaṣṭha requires a brief note. Ambaṣṭha here is presented as the son of a slave-woman of the Śākya clan, and the Blessed One's pointed speech to Devadatta is being cited as an example of speech that, though apparently harsh, is neither truly unpleasant nor affliction-driven — it is compassionate in intent. The precise sūtra source for the Ambaṣṭha anecdote as quoted here has not been identified with certainty; the passage likely derives from a Vinaya or narrative collection.

The final sentence of the passage is syntactically incomplete in the source text and trails off mid-construction; the translation renders what is there faithfully and breaks where the text breaks.

- The phrase rendered "Garuḍa, king of the sky" translates "nam mkha' lding," which literally means "sky-soarer" or "sky-bird," a common Tibetan epithet for Garuḍa. No gloss is inserted in the verse itself to keep the verse clean, but the prose commentary makes clear the referent.

The final sentence breaks off mid-thought in the Tibetan, which appears to be a continuation passage; the translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

The commentary's grammatical remark about "the suffix following words such as 'tree'" refers to a Sanskrit grammatical point about the comparative particle, which is somewhat technical and has been rendered in plain functional terms without attempting to reconstruct the Sanskrit grammar lesson in full.

- The name "Kūṭaka" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "khu ta ga" — the Sanskrit original, if any, is uncertain; it may refer to a specific people or tribe mentioned in Buddhist prophetic literature.

The list of five vocal qualities (voice endowed with five qualities) is a standard Indic enumeration found in various Buddhist sources; the text does not here name all five, so they are not spelled out in the translation.

- The verse attributed to the Blessed One addressing the fish is a narrative exemplum embedded in the commentary. The image is vivid and the translation follows the Tibetan closely; the fish's speaking "by the power of the Blessed One" is a standard hagiographic motif. The term rendered "cataract" for rab rib (literally, a film or obscuring layer over the eye) is the traditional gloss and fits the medical metaphor of "medicine for all beings" that structures this ninth division.

- The verse "Your mind, unobstructed toward all" is a citation of a stanza being commented upon; the commentary then proceeds phrase by phrase. The technical term rendered "wisdom of aspiration" translates a compound meaning primordial wisdom arising from aspirational prayer, likely referring to praṇidhānajñāna, one of the wisdoms attributed to a buddha or arhat.

The phrase "nirvāṇa with remainder" refers to sopadhiśeṣanirvāṇa, nirvāṇa attained while still possessing a physical residual aggregate, as distinguished from nirvāṇa without remainder attained at death. This distinction is doctrinally significant in context.

- The "sūtra of the simile of the siṃśapā leaves" refers to the Siṃśapāvana-sutta (Saṃyutta Nikāya 56.31), in which the Buddha holds up a handful of siṃśapā leaves to illustrate that what he has taught is only a small fraction of what he knows — specifically those things that lead to

direct knowledge, full awakening, and nirvāṇa. The reference here is consistent with that canonical teaching.

"Peluka" (Tibetan: pe lu ka) likely refers to a specific non-Buddhist sect or teacher; the exact identification is uncertain. The "yellow-robed sages" are probably Brahmanical ascetics, and the "naked ones" are Nirgrantha Jains.

The final verse's last line is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the rendering "it would come down to abiding in it" reflects the sense that the listener, even if he found fault with the teaching in theory, would ultimately be unable to do other than remain within it, given the immensity of the Buddha's sacrificial endurance for beings' sake.

- The verse attributed to the Blessed One about the burning head is a paraphrase of a well-known canonical passage found in the Pāli Saṃyuttanikāya and parallels, urging practitioners to prioritize seeing the four noble truths above all else. The commentary renders it as a direct quotation rather than a citation by title.
- The etymological gloss on "tīrthika" in this passage is unusual: the text interprets the Tibetan "mu" in "mu-stegs-pa" as meaning "shore" or "limit," and "stegs" as "to reach" or "complete," deriving the term's sense from the idea of entering a teaching like approaching a ford or shore. This is a standard Tibetan commentarial etymology for the term, not a mistranslation, but it is scholastically specific and has been rendered explanatorily in the body without distorting the doctrinal sense.

The passage cites a sūtra directly in discussing the one who practices the four bases of miraculous power abiding for an aeon — this is a reference to a well-known passage in the Mahāparinirvāṇasūtra tradition regarding the Buddha's potential to extend his lifespan, here applied to practitioners. The allusion is kept implicit in the translation as in the original.

- The householder "Anāthapiṇḍada" is the standard rendering of འཆིགས་བྲོ་དང་འཁྱུར་བཞེས་པ།, literally "giver of food to the protectorless," the well-known patron of the Jeta Grove. The text uses this figure as an illustrative example of how merely hearing the word "buddha" for the first time can inspire immediate faith and aspiration.
- The name "Pharva" for the renunciant (Tibetan: རལ་ཏུ་བློན་པ་མཉམ་པ་ཡིས་, rabtu byung bar 'phar ba yis) is uncertain. The text reads literally "a renunciant named Pharva" or possibly "a leaping renunciant." This may be a proper name or a descriptive epithet; the precise referent is unclear without a Sanskrit parallel. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, so the translation likewise breaks off at that point.
- The phrase rendered "a cart whose very nature is wood" translates a simile where the Tibetan uses "a cart of the nature of wood" as an analogy for the Tathāgata being "of the nature of merit" by reason of possessing abundant merit. The precise intent of the analogy — presumably that wood is the essential constituent of a cart, just as merit is the essential constituent of the Tathāgata's greatness — is somewhat compressed in the original and has been rendered as literally as readability allows.
- The "garlands of fingers" is an allusion to Aṅgulimāla, the notorious murderer who became an arhat through the Buddha's guidance. The "fierce king" who offered sand is a well-known Jātaka reference, likely to King Aśoka in a previous life, the gift of sand yielding the fruit of future liberation. The fire-worshipping ascetics (Jātilas) and Kāśyapa likely refer to the Kāśyapa brothers, the three groups of matted-hair ascetics who became disciples of the Buddha at Uruvelā.
- The name "Śuddhodana" is rendered from context; the Tibetan says "his father Śuddhodana's birth" in reference to the familiar narrative of the bodhisattva's birth causing all kings to send gifts to his father. The phrase སྐད་ཀྱི་ཕུ་ཚེ་ཤིང་ལྟ་བུ་ལྷན་སྒྲུབ་པའི་ཕུ་ཚེ་ཡིས་ is somewhat elliptical but clearly refers to the circumstances surrounding the birth of the one whose father was Śuddhodana.

The verse fragment at the end breaks off mid-sentence with "of the tamer of persons," which is consistent with the source text ending mid-stanza; the next passage will complete it.

- The passage identifies Ānanda mid-commentary in a somewhat abrupt syntactic turn, where the Tibetan shifts from the general analogy to a specific example involving Śāriputra. The sentence addressed to Ānanda functions as a vocative mid-exposition, consistent with the commentary's source text being framed as discourse to Ānanda. The example of the noble Śāriputra's arrangement of the non-Buddhists and assembly at Śrāvastī appears to refer to a specific narrative episode, likely from the Vinaya or a related āgama source, which the commentator treats as well-known.

- The name rendered "Supraṭiṣṭhita" (Tib. སུཔ་རྩི་སྤྱོད་ཅི་མེད་) is a literal back-formation from the Tibetan; the Sanskrit proper name for this rag-washer of Śrāvastī in the Vinaya narratives is typically given as Supraṭiṣṭhita or Upaṭiṣṭha in different sources. The identification here seems to align with Supraṭiṣṭhita.

The figure "Śrīgupta" (Tib. སྤྱི་གུཔ་) is a well-known adversary of the Buddha in Vinaya narrative tradition; the rendering follows standard identification.

- The phrase rendered "you have become like an enemy to yourself" describes the Blessed One's self-abnegating compassion: he disregards his own wellbeing entirely, which from a worldly standpoint resembles the behavior of an enemy toward oneself, yet this very quality makes him a protector for others. The doctrinal point is that what looks like self-harm is in fact supreme selflessness. The commentarial reading is clear, but the paradox is intentional and worth noting for listeners.

- The passage on the conduct of divine coupling lists five modes of union traditional to Indian cosmological literature: pairing together, embracing, holding hands, laughing, and union through gaze. The last of these is a well-known Indic convention whereby celestial beings of the highest divine classes are said to unite merely by exchanging glances; this is not a metaphor but a doctrinal cosmological claim.

The phrase rendered "freedom from fault with respect to season" and the accompanying gloss about calm water and the first day of the month is compressed and somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan. The comparison appears to draw a parallel between an auspicious calendrical moment and a standard or normative time, suggesting that the Dharma is offered without regard for whether a moment is specially auspicious or not. This reading is contextually plausible but the exact referent of the comparison is not entirely transparent.

- The verse attributed to the seven Brahma-class goddesses contains the phrase "ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་" which I have rendered as "the limit of one born of Añjaśiva," taking Cangśes as a name or epithet; the precise identification is uncertain and may be a proper name deserving further philological investigation.

The passage's structure interleaves root verses with auto-commentary; the transition markers such as "this is the elaboration" and "this is the condensed meaning" are commentary rubrics preserved as prose to maintain the TTS-ready format.

- The name rendered "Kokālika" (Tibetan "Kun khro") is a conjectural identification; the Tibetan literally means "all-anger" or "completely wrathful," which is a known epithet or alternate rendering for Kokālika in some commentarial traditions, though the identification is not certain.

The phrase "food that has been soaked" (bshos phal pa) refers to simple, softened or pre-soaked grain, the ordinary food of the poor or of wandering ascetics; this is the standard commentarial gloss and is doctrinally important as indicating voluntary austerity.

The narrative example at the close is truncated here in the source; the translation faithfully renders only what is present.

- The passage contains two proper names for the same text: the Tibetan reads "Kauśāmbī" and then gives what appears as a textual or toponym variant rendered here as Kauśāmbī throughout. The phrase rendered "sent off into the wilderness at the point of a blade" is somewhat ambiguous in the original; "at the point of a blade" is a reasonable reading of "lag can," which can mean "one who has a weapon or instrument in hand," though the commentarial context suggests a forceful expulsion. The phrase "city in its early-morning glow" renders the dawn-city image that contextually explains the merchant's spiritual assessment. The phrase "without stopping to look back" renders the idiom of urgency in the original.
- The phrase "dab phi dab phi" appears to be a transliteration of some non-Tibetan dialect or perhaps a conventional textual representation of a foreign or barbarian tongue; its precise identity is uncertain and not recoverable from context alone.

The phrase rendered "fit for verbal honor" translates "tshig gi mchod 'os," which the commentary immediately glosses as meaning "servant" in the sense of being under another's control; the apparent paradox is intentional and reflects the commentary's interpretive move.

The reference to Indra at the end is based on "lhas byin" which literally means "god-given" or "Devadatta," but in context the commentary seems to use it as a standard example of one who causes harm; the identification with Indra or Devadatta is ambiguous. Given that "lhas byin" is the standard Tibetan rendering of Devadatta, this may refer to the Buddha's famously troublesome cousin rather than Indra, but the passage is compressed.

- The name rendered as "Pūraṇa" for རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ is a provisional identification; the Tibetan literally means "the completor" or "Pūraṇa," likely referring to Pūraṇa Kāśyapa, one of the six famous non-Buddhist teachers. The identification is contextually plausible but not explicit in the text.

The householder's name རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ is the Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit Śrīgupta; the feminine form རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་མེད་ simply means "Śrīgupta's wife," not a separate named figure.

- The verse attributed to the Blessed One after the Bhāradvāja episode is a well-known canonical passage found in several Pali and Sanskrit sources; the rendering of the simile as "fine dust thrown against the wind" is interpretive but consistent with the text's image of dust being thrown upward and falling back.

The name Śrīgarbha rendered for རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་, literally "Śrī-hidden" or "Śrī-garbha," is a stock example; the commentarial tradition identifies this as a figure tamed by seeing the truth of suffering, though the precise narrative is not elaborated here.

Aṅgulimāla, the notorious serial killer tamed by the Buddha through loving-kindness, appears here under his epithet རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་མེད་, meaning "like Aṅgulimāla" (literally "garland of fingers"), which is rendered by name for clarity.

- The verse on generosity and conflict is terse and somewhat compressed. The central image appears to be that generosity and fighting require the same readiness of will at the decisive moment, so that a warrior who can be bold in battle can equally be bold in giving; the stanza is an upāya-argument aimed at the proud householder Vīra. The exact referent of "King Ajātaśatru and others" in the list of those who were fierce and then made gentle is taken from the commentarial tradition and does not appear spelled out further in this passage.
- The proper names rendered here as Bhadraka, Kāśyapa, Nandika, Ānanda, and "the Licchavi rice-dealer" reconstruct Tibetan forms bzang ldan, 'od srungs, dga' bo, kun dga' bo, and bre bo zas. The last term, literally "one whose food is measured by the bre measure," is a common epithet for a Licchavi figure; the identification is contextual. The grammatical note on the verb form for "satisfaction" taking its sixth position reflects an Abhidharma-style parsing of the

Tibetan verb construction and is preserved for doctrinal fidelity. The monk "Padma" and the figure "son of Nanda" are names recovered from context; the underlying story is a known canonical episode but the exact source sūtra is not identified in this passage.

- The sūtra quotation embedded in the commentary cites a brahmin woman who, after receiving graduated teachings on generosity, moral discipline, and the higher realms, directly realizes the Four Noble Truths while seated. This follows the standard Pāli and Sanskrit formula of the "graduated discourse" found in multiple āgama sources. The phrase rendered "suited to her position and rank" translates a Tibetan expression meaning that her mental faculties were properly established and in accord with her station, implying readiness for the direct realization that followed.

- "Dabhe Dabhe" is a proper name occurring in the Tibetan as a phonetic rendering of an Indian name and likely refers to a figure in the narrative context of Śrāvastī. The precise identity is uncertain, but it is treated here as a name rather than an epithet.

"Dribe" is likewise a phonetic name for the perfumer figure; the Tibetan reads "dri ba shin tu snyan pa'i nga rgyal bsam pa can" — literally "a perfumer with an intention of great pride" — so "Dribe" is the individual's name and his profession is perfumer; the translation reflects this.

The sixth verbal form referenced in the commentary is a grammatical note about Sanskrit verbal inflection applied to the Tibetan rendering, indicating that the phrase "at the present time" governs the verb in question; this is a standard grammatical gloss in Indo-Tibetan commentarial style and has no bearing on the doctrinal content.

- The phrase rendered "accepted particle of assertion" for "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□" describes a grammatical connective expressing that something is taken as given or conceded — here indicating that the beginninglessness of saṃsāra is an agreed-upon premise rather than a fresh argument. The rendering follows the commentarial logic accordingly.

The gloss on "Śāriputra" for "Śāradvatīputra" follows the standard identification: "son of Śāradvatī" is a patronymic epithet of Śāriputra.

- The final verse is left incomplete in the Tibetan as translated here — the passage breaks off mid-verse, and it is clear this is a continuation that would run into the next block of text. No reconstruction or completion has been attempted.

The sūtra quotation embedded in the passage concerns Māra's six sense-objects as occasions of temptation; this is a standard canonical passage found in the Saṃyukta-āgama tradition, here cited in its Tibetan recension.

The name "Legs-sad" is the Tibetan name of the elder (possibly corresponding to the Sanskrit Svāgata or another monk of similar narrative); no Sanskrit equivalent is supplied in the passage, so it is rendered as given.

- The phrase rendered "Devadatta is one who causes great harm" reflects the Tibetan commentarial gloss on the name Devadatta, explaining it etymologically or functionally in context as a figure who causes injury, rather than as a neutral proper name. The passage treats Devadatta as the paradigm case of an extremely harmful person toward whom the Buddha nonetheless could not transfer his own virtuous qualities, thus illustrating that karma cannot be transferred between persons.

The final verse is incomplete in the source text as given, breaking off mid-line; the translation reflects this.

- The passage quotes what appears to be a scriptural statement that the teaching will endure for five thousand years without decline — a well-known motif in Indian Buddhist literature concerning the duration of the Dharma. The exact source of this citation is not identified in the passage itself.

The figure Suvarṇavarṇa, whose name means "golden-hued," appears here as the last person directly tamed by the Blessed One before his parinirvāṇa. Some traditions identify this figure with Subhadra, the last direct disciple of the Buddha; the name used here is a variant or epithet, and the identification is noted for context rather than resolved with certainty.

The "vajra meditative absorption" consuming the reliquary body like sesame seeds refers to the tradition, found in several Indian sources, that the Buddha entered a final vajra-like samādhi at the moment of parinirvāṇa, which consumed his physical remains into fine particles — the relics distributed afterward being the fruit of this process. The commentary's point is that this act was itself a final gift to beings, demonstrating the inexhaustibility of the Buddha's compassionate activity.

- The passage contains a scriptural transmission note regarding the Blessed One holding his own relics through the power of meditative absorption — this is a relatively unusual doctrinal claim but is rendered faithfully as stated. The verse "having shattered the form body like sesame seeds" refers to the traditional account that the Buddha's relics were distributed in the form of tiny fragments; this is rendered literally in keeping with the source.
- The phrase rendered as "a blade cuts into my heart" translates a somewhat compressed construction meaning that fear cuts into or oppresses the chest or heart, evoking the image of an instrument pressing painfully against the breast. The rendering follows the doctrinal-poetic sense of the passage, where the praiser acknowledges that the praise falls short and this inadequacy causes a kind of anguished humility.

The line "the activity of the three bodies calmed" reads in the Tibetan as referring to body, speech, and the activities of the three kāyas; the commentary specifically discusses body and speech, suggesting that "three bodies" here may be a compressed reference to the threefold activity of the kāyas as manifested through body and speech, rather than the three kāyas in their full technical sense. This is noted as a minor interpretive point but does not significantly alter the doctrinal meaning.

- The phrase rendered "because one fears the absence of fear" reflects a compressed and somewhat paradoxical Tibetan construction. The commentarial point appears to be that the poet is not refraining from praise out of contentment, but out of a proper reverential fear of the consequences of inadequate praise — a fear, in other words, of being without appropriate fear. This reading follows the text's own gloss but the syntax of the Tibetan at that point is condensed and elliptical.
- The monk's name, rendered in Tibetan as "Dga' byed sñan pa," is a Tibetan calque of a Sanskrit name best reconstructed as Pṛtīśrīghoṣa or a close equivalent; the precise Sanskrit original is not preserved in the colophon and the reconstruction is approximate. The Indian preceptor's name, Śrī Śraddhākaravarman, is a transliteration of the Tibetan phonetic rendering and is standard for this figure known from other Tibetan canonical colophons.

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.